Open Your Heart {a Catradora AU}

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/37579336.

Rating:
Explicit

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings, Graphic Depictions Of Violence, No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Finn | Adora/Catra Child (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Original Characters, Silver, Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff and Smut, Eventual Smut, Depressing, Fluff and Angst, Freeform, Alternate Universe, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Lesbian Adora (She-Ra), Lesbian Sex, Marking, Slow Burn, MILFs, Catra has a kid, Mating Cycles/In Heat, Canon LGBTQ Character, Mild Language, Angst and Feels, Warning: Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Minor Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra), Mentioned Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Sorry Not Sorry, Hordak - Freeform, warning, Character Death, Minor Character Death, Blood and Injury, Blood and Gore, Blood and Violence, Blood and Torture, Psychological Torture, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Panic Attacks

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English

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Open Your Heart {a Catradora AU}

by CatradoraSimp16

Summary

Catra is wild in this AU, Adora is a commander. it's not technically the original She-ra universe here. My oc Silver is mentioned but doesn't have too much of a huge impact of the story, not like my other stories have been.

Chapter 1

Flashback

"Aaahhh! " Teeth bite down and a magicat yells. A tongue licking the spot soon after.

"It's okay. It's okay. " Blue and yellow eyes look into her partner's blue ones. An apologetic but sincere look on her face. Catra smiles a little before licking the spot some more.

Silver tilts her girlfriend's head towards her and kisses the feline on the lips.

...

flashback

...

...

.....

"Do you promise to be mine forever, Silver? " Catra speaks softly, nuzzling into her nape.
"I promise. No matter what happens, I promise with my whole heart. " Catra purrs at the confirmation, her tail wrapping around the wool band on her newly wed wife's wrist. The magicat sighs in contentment.

...

Flashback

Thump, thump

Thump, thump

Thump, thump...

Catra replays their promise in her mind, nervous as she waits.
A door opens, a healer in green wraps greets her.

"Congratulations, it's a girl. " she says rather solemnly. Her blows furrow in concern, pupils shrinking to pinpricks in her mismatched eyes.

"But....? "

The healer noticeably sags and sighs as she hands the feline her daughter.

"But... Silver didn't make it through the delivery. I'm so sorry. " Catra's hand starts trembling as a tear escapes. She looks down at the blue eyed and surprisingly blonde kitten in her arms. Noticing the white patch on her head. And the five freckles on her cheeks. Stripes prominent on several parts of her body.

An imprint of the magicat she just lost.

Thump, thump

Thump, thump

...

...

flashback

"**AAAAARGH!** " Catra yells shoving every bit of paper and items on her wooden table. Sobbing uncontrollably as she swiped at the wooden walls of her hut. Gashes now deep in them from her claws.
'She didn't deserve this! ' Catra was grief stricken, tears pooling on the floor as her body shook, her back against the wall.

She heard a mew and a yip in the next room and sniffled. The mewing soon turned into the crying and she tried to wipe her tears. Silently padding over to the next room. On her hand woven

crib had the name Moonshine on it. She and Silver both made it. Made every single thing she now possessed.... Alone.

Catra picked up the crying kitten and softly sang her a lullaby. All her racket must have woken the poor baby up.
As wet, blue eyes drifted off to sleep again, Catra sighed. Smiling just a little.

"I promise, I'll be here for you no matter what." Catra pressed her forehead against the kitten's, feeling a tiny drowsy hand on her cheek as more tears fell.

...

...

....

{6 years later- present day}

Catra and a kit crawled on all fours through the woods. Sometimes magicats preffered to walk on all fours while they hunted or are just being their being their playful selves. But today she wanted to hunt alongside her daughter yet again.

As they moved, Catra had to rip her eyes away from Moon. Her memories and thoughts of the past 6 years flooding back in all over again. She wouldn't say they were bad however, her daughter would never be a burden to her, it's just.... She always sees her mate in her daughter's eyes.

Moonshine never knew her mom and it just made her even more sad at the thought. Maybe she should finally move on and find a mate or something. Moon deserves to have both her parents around.

A memory flooded back in. A promise she made long ago, causing Catra to shake the idea of remarrying. She made a promise, she belonged to her wife and no one else.

A sudden strained creak catches Catra's attention and she goes rigid, her ears twitching around. Moonshine also stops and listens, staying close to her mother incase of danger.
The grown woman growled as she tried to pick up the sound's origin. Also making sure her kitten stays low as possible.

Her ear flicked again and a sudden pinch to her side snaps her focus downwards with a surprised whimper. As she looked down however, her pupils shrunk as they focused on a gold arrow piercing her side. Moon looks horrified yet just as surprised as she was. Catra gave a reassuring yet urgent look to Moonshine, hoping to get her to safety. But as she tried to move, the pain worsened.
The sudden movement and the blood loss makes Catra's head spin, she starts grabbing for anything she can brace herself on but simply collapses. Her vision going blurry as her thoughts rush out completely panicked.

Everything started getting overwhelming for the feline. The birds were singing way too loud, everything seemed to echo, her heartbeat tried to compensate for the blood loss, pounding in her ears as her breaths shallower out.
The feline felt Moonshine pulling at her ear with her mouth like she did when playing, but this time it wasn't all fun and games for the two. Catra growled and whimpered weakly trying to tell the kitten to hide. But stupid sounds were the only thing she could think of mustering right now.

~~

A while away from the two magicats. A blonde woman and a brown skinned boy sat in the bushes.

"I told you to hold your fire! " Adora whisper shouted, scolding Bow.
"I'm sorry! I saw the deer and my fingers slipped! " Bow whisper shouted as well. Apologizing almost profusely to his commander.
They were out hunting for the village, Adora being the head hunter or 'commander' as they like to call her and Bow being one

of the top archers in the squad. Because of the lack of their breakfast today, they were sent out by Angela to get a deer back in under short notice.
Hence why they were in a bush in the middle of the Whispering Woods.

"I told you to hold it! That didn't look like a deer! " Adora scolded the boy yet again.
"What else would it be? There's only deer around this part of the woods. " Bow grumbled folding his arms.
"I don't know but at least let us make sure! " Adora growled, still rather upset for the breach in orders as she stormed off towards their capture.

~~

As Moonshine kept tugging on her mother's ear, she heard the bushes rustling. Whoever it was that shot Catra were coming for her. So in turn she dashes into the nearest bush and hides herself, trying to calm her shivering and her spiked fur.

Catra sees as Moonshine hides, a relieved breath leaving her mouth. Whatever happens she wants her kitten to be safe.

Just as two blurry figures emerge from the bushes, their voices garbled and distorted, she notices a blonde woman with an Archer and finally passes out.

"Bow! I told you it wasn't a deer! You shot a woman!" Adora tried her best not to panic, but was failing miserably.
"Oh my gosh, I'm sorry! Glimmer is gonna have my head if she finds out about this! " Bow sobbed behind the blonde.

Adora looked around, "there doesn't seem to be anyone else around though... "

Adora scanned the woman for any more damages and to make sure the arrow hadn't hit any major vital organs, also crossing her fingers and hoping they didn't kill her. She was breathing, that had

to be enough. That's until she noticed the ears and the tail. She felt as though a tank just dropped on her...

"She's a.... Magicat?! "

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Pfft Adora calm down girl >W<

"She's a.... Magicat?! "

Bow hears Adora's remark and lifts an eyebrow.
"What's a magicat? "
Adora glances at him in disbelief before summarizing.
"I thought they were a folk tale like mermaids. No mermista is NOT a mermaid. " Bow dropped his hand and closed his mouth at the stare she gave him.
"I didn't think they'd be real. " Adora looks at her in awe. Her mind snapping her out of it as she double checked the spot that had been pierced through.

A small, blue, woolen band caught Adora's eye and she remembered the book she read.
"She has a family... " Adora's eyes were now downcast as she looked around yet again, hoping to find one of them at least.

Bowsighed, "we should bring her back to camp. We don't have the equipment with us and to be honest she needs the medical attention right now." Adora nodded to the boy and kneeled closer, carefully scooping the feline into her arms, bridal style.

"You should go on ahead, inform Angela about what happened and find a private tent for her. " Bow saluted at the blonde who chuckled as he ran off ahead.
Adora could feel the weight of the feline against her leather armor and the fur against her undershirt. Blood slightly soaking into it as she tried walk as carefully as she could.
But still.... She could help but glance back at that spot. Hoping.

~~

As she arrived to the village, Adora was met with some nurses who aided the magicat onto a flatbed. Onlookers were shooed away by some guards and it was clear that Bow got the message across.

"Adora, you're back. " The blonde turned to see the regal figure of their leader, Angela.
"Yes ma'am. Can I ask a favour?" Adora saluted then stood at ease.
Angela gave a nod for her to continue and waited,
"I would appreciate it of only a selected few are to tend to the magicat woman. Only a few of us know how to take care of her, her needs, what might happen when she wakes up etc. "
"When you say 'a few of US's, you mean you, don't you, commander? " Adora looked away slightly.
"Y-yes ma'am. "

A nurse came over, "the arrow has been removed ma'am, her fur seems to be dried with the blood however. But the wound has been tended to as much as we could. "
Angela looked to Adora who had turned to the nurse, looking at her with the worry that coursed through her own head.
"If I may, ma'am... Can I tend to the magicat? I'm willing to do anything to make up for this mistake. It was our fault and someone has to take responsibility for it. " Adora turned to their leader, Glimmer coming up behind her mother.

"but Adora, if you take this job you'd have to give up your position as hunting commander." The pink haired general informed. It was a basic rule, take someone else's job you'd have to give up your own, no matter your rank or status.

"Then I resign my position. Bow is head hunter, he can take my place till she's better." Adora firmly stated, planting her feet with a determine factor to her voice.
"Are you sure you're willing to take full responsibility for this magicat, Adora? Anything that happens to her and anything she does will be pointed at you. " Angela tried to reason, making sure it was what Adora really wanted, knowing the consequences.

"Yes. Full and complete responsibility. " Adora wouldn't want to admit but, brining her here she felt the most guilt she's ever felt before. She wanted to make it right, no matter the cost.

"Well then, your badge? " Angela held out her palm, gesturing to the gold wing pin on Adora's belt. Adora sighed handing it over, she felt like a part of her life just got stripped away. But she convinced herself, it was her choice, she made this sacrifice.

"So dang noble huh? " Glimmer remarked seeing her friend's brow creased. Adora chuckled as she looked at the tent then back to Angela.

"Go on, I'll be putting guards around here so no one will come around with their curiosity about a stranger in the camp. "

"Just don't make it too dense, please. When she wakes up I don't want her feeling like a prisoner. " Adora pleaded and Glimmer nodded, confirming the request.

Adora smiled thankfully and jogged over to the tent, to tend for the magicat. All the nurses leaving as it wasn't their duty anymore. All damages were accounted for and deal that with, the most they can do now is wait and change bandages often, or clean her fur etc.

~~

Moonshine was on her way back to her villiage, running on all fours and trying not to forget the conversation she heard about 15 minutes prior.

Switching to two legs the skid to a stop in the chief's hut.

"Grandpa!"

"What is it Moon? " A grey magicat looked at his granddaughter with the surprise of the sudden intrusion.

As Moonshine caught her breath she failed her arms around as she tried to speak.
" these.... These humans... They got.... Mom got shot... With an arrow..... *Huff Huff*..."

"Hold on slow down Moon, slow down. "

Moonshine finally caught her breath and fixed her short ponytail before relaying everything that happened and the conversation that took place.
Her grandfather, Oak, had his fingers to his chin.
" you can stay with me for now, but Hide? "
"Yes sir. " An orange magicat stepped forward. Rather normal civilian-looking, since he was just a scout for the chief.

"From what I heard, this seemed like an honest mistake. But I would like you to head into their camp and make sure this is the case. Don't make yourself known, just observe and report back to me. "
"Yes sir. " Hide answered.

"Moon, like your mom has told you, magicats are peaceful. But... If there's a threat to them only then can they partake in the war. "
"I've never heard that part. "

"Oh and Moonshine. " The kitten perked up an ear.
"You are allowed to go along with Hide, you may learn valuable traits for the tribe some day. " He beamed with pride. It wasn't finalized but he seemed to like Moonshine so much, that he would make her chieftess as soon as he passes on. Considering Catra didn't want to do it.

~~

Moonshine stuck close to Hide, making sure she could keep up with his speed. To be fair, her mother was Catra, so speed wasn't a problem when you gotta keep up with her while hunting.

They were already near the clearing, several guards arguing with curious civilians. Just then they already knew which tent she was

being kept. As Hide led them around the back, the same blonde woman from earlier entered the tent, Moon's eyebrows nitting protectively.

Hide nipped her tail and she was focused soon again.

They saw a small window type, thing behind the tent, supposedly for natural light to filter through. So they peeked through that, able to hear through it as well. Cat hearing and all that.

~~

Adora saw the limp body of the feline and sighed. This was her fault and she knew it. The guilt weighed her down.
Noticing the state of the bandages, Adora grabbed the other roll they had nearby and a scissors too.
Cutting off the used bandages, she took a wet cloth and tried to be as gentle as she could with the woman's fur. Cleaning the spot once again.

She noticed that the magicat also let out a subconscious whimper and flinched, immediately Adora went to her face and cupped her cheek, "it's okay, it's okay... I'm here, it's okay. " she had no idea what made her say something like that but, it seemed to calm the magicat so much with the pain and her expression relaxed once more.

Adora wrapped the feline's torso in fresh bandages, watching her expression carefully and comforting her when needed.

As she tightened the bandages and cut the last bit, Adora kept repeating that one line that calmed her. The blonde took the nearby chair and sat close to her, there was something about this woman that was drawing her in and she couldn't understand it. Just as a thought came to her mind she looked at the wool band on the feline's wrist.
"You have a family, I can't- I shouldn't get too attached to you... " Adora combed through the magicat's mane. It was soft, and wow was it amazing!

Attachment is a tricky thing to get rid of, especially with Adora, Bow could tell you about how she cried after SwiftWind jumped in front of her when a deer charged at them. Poor Swifty took the blow. The canine didn't make it and Adora bawled her eyes out as a response.

Outside the tent, Hide held a sort of sympathetic look. But the depth of that look, Moonshine couldn't understand, at least for her age. There was something about the way Adora interacted with Catra that told Hide millions.

~~

Back at the villiage, Hide gave his report, actually whispering his findings in the chief's ear.

"Huh, seems like it was an honest mistake. No worries. Also, I'll keep that observation in mind, Hide. " He winked at the scout who huffed and rolled his eyes.

"Moon, according to what I just heard, I can say that it's safe enough for you to visit. The blonde one seems to know her way around our traditions and species. And she seems very compassionate as well. It's your decision if you want to. "

Moon still didn't trust the humans, but.... She was definitely worried about her mom, so she'd think about it.

~~

Adora thought of the fact that she might have to give Catra a bath somehow. Maybe a wet cloth? Something's gotta work right?

It's still the first day but hygiene is important nevertheless.

Adora had a bowl of warm water and a cloth. She was seriously unsure if she should do this. The book she had never mentioned any other form of washing besides using their tongue. If that was the case she was definitely surprised as to how neat and tidy the feline was in general.

Putting the bowl and cloth nearby she sat in her usual spot. Only the guards know how often she checks up on the magicat. Admittedly like 50 times a day. But it's her responsibility and pretty much the only thing occupying her day now. So she's getting bored fast. Visiting is the only thing she likes doing, since it let's her stretch her legs a bit.

Adora heard a whimper from the magicat before her, seeing some beads of sweat on her brow. Putting the back of her hand to the feline's forehead she gasped.

A fever...

The blonde grabbed the bowl and poured out the warm water, replacing it with a much cooler version before rushing back to her spot. Adora soaked the cloth into the water and wrung it out as much as she could, then dabbed it at Catra's head. The stressed whimper and pained whines died down slowly, but the panting continued.

At least the cool cloth was helping her.

~~

Catra was out cold, but she could still feel the fever plaguing her body as it healed slowly. She felt a cool cloth to her forehead and she relaxed.

A pained and frustrated whine made it's way forth as Catra burned up. Silver had a wet cloth nearby and was dabbing it on her head, cooling her down.
"It's okay, it's okay, I'm right here, it's okay. " Silver purred trying to comfort her mate.

Catra's tail flicked as she twisted from the discomfort.

"It's okay, it's just a slight fever. You're gonna get better soon, don't worry. "

That voice.... Soothing her...

Silver passed the cloth again, dabbing it at her ears making her purr as it comforted her some more. She painted but a pain that wasn't there before made itself known and she hissed loudly.

"Hey, hey, easy... Easy. Take it easy. You're okay. "

"...You're okay" Silver purred soothing her fretting.

There was something about the way that Catra reacted to the reassurance that made Adora think, maybe she can hear her.

Just something about it, made her heart grateful for the simple fact that she was comforting her and it was working.

It was something alright.

A memory.

Chapter 3

Birds sang as the sun rose at dawn, Adora already on her way to tend for the magicat. Adora being the early riser as she was, this wasn't gonna be a problem in future visitations. Right?...

The blonde had a book with her this time, the one she used to carry around as a kid, '*Mysteries of Magicat*s" it was called. It was the book she got all her knowledge from. Wedding rituals, engagement bands, how they keep themselves clean... And even mating and heat cycles tbh.

Adora thought while she tended for the magicat this morning she could grab an early breakfast and reread this particular book, just incase she overlooked anything.

So, as she stuffed a toasted slice of bread into her mouth, holding it, she repositioned her chair quietly and sat, before taking the bread out of her mouth, a bite missing as she chewed.
Adora wondered how hungry this feline would be when she woke up, wondered *what* she would prefer to eat even.
So that was the first thing she looked for in the table of contents. Eating habits.
Even though it was just the second day, Adora wanted to be prepared.

While scrolling to the page number however she glimpsed the chapter on baths and paused, her bread halfway to her mouth of which was also halfway opened.

Maybe she should give it a try today. After all, she wimped out yesterday...

Adora gobbled up the rest of her bread and marked the page she was going for originally, she went over to the sink, got the warm water and the cloth from yesterday which was on the mattress near Catra. Remembering the fever, Adora checked her temperature.

It was almost back to normal.
The blonde sighed quietly and got the cloth, dipping it in the warm water before trying to figure out where to start.

She opted for all the places she could see. Considering Catra just wore a leather/fur version of a tank top and shorts. She took notice of the knife sheathed on her hip, hod she not noticed this before?!
Adora unclipped it and placed it on the table nearby. The sheath was a dark leather with some pieces of metal here and there, the handle of the knife wrapped with thin versions around metal, with some bone pieces.
Out of curiosity, Adora unsheathed the knife, a small shing echoed in the tent.

The knife was clean, shiny, she could even see her reflection in it. The blonde made the mistake of putting her finger to the blade to see how sharp it was, no doubt the cut her thumb in the process. She shoved her thumb into her mouth and eased the minor sting. She guessed the metal in the sheath was to keep the knife sharp everytime it was removed.

Pic:



Getting rid of her distractions, Adora focused on the task at hand, making sure she didn't have anything that would get in the way.

Checking the bandages conditions, she furrowed her brows. They seemed like they needed changing, she could change those in the meantime as well,

While Adora got her job started she had to shake rather intrusive thought out of her head, the task turning much harder than it was originally thought to be. As she changed the bandages she looked at the time, it was almost midday? Already? Time sure seemed to fly with her focus elsewhere.

~~

As Adora returned from lunch with Bow and Glimmer (of whom teased her relentlessly), she wondered when *exactly* the magicat would wake up.

Catra groaned, her head swimming in disorientation. As she tried to open her eyes, she got an instant head ache because of the light in the room.
Catra stirred some more, as memories from what happened the previous day filtered in. She remembered getting taken by the two individuals that basically shot her. If they shot her for her fur she wouldn't be waking up right now, so she assumed they had other intentions planned for later.

As Catra tried her best to sit up with her weak limbs she heard the sound of cloth shifting and more light filtered in, making her hiss in discomfort.

As her mismatched eyes adjusted, her ears twitched picking up the sound of a small gasp.

"Hey, you're awake... " the blonde exhaled as she came closer. Her voice seemed familiar, she was the one that took her but... Something else about her made her familiar. Her voice....

Catra hissed trying to back away from a possible threat, but winced harshly as her side throbbed with sudden pain. Blood seeping into the bandages and being soaked up by her fur in the same area.
"Hey, hey, it's okay, take it easy. You're hurt. "

No shit Sherlock....

Adora came over, her hands bracing near Catra's body incase she needed her help. Catra growled and hissed some more. Trying to settle in a position that didn't hurt, but that was definitely hard, all things considered, the arrow pierced all the way through her side when it hit.

Catra's eyes caught a glimpse at the book on the desk next to her as she mved away from Adora, she read the title and her hissing died down a little. She developed a sensed of curiosity and wariness, but..... A smidge of... Trust?

Adora recoiled her hands when Catra made a last growl, her pupils shrinking and focusing on her.
"It's okay... " Adora tried to reassure her, a bit downtrodden at the sudden aggression.

Catra whimpered the pain growing tenfold, Adora's brows furrowed in concern as Catra's chest heaved, and the bandages started getting noticeably redder.
Tears dropped from Catra's eyes, the pain spiked compared to when she first woke up and it burned like hell!
She felt like someone was trying to rip her fur off. And so, she was crying. She was showing involuntary weakness in front of a threat.

Adora noticed the tears and slightly panicked, realizing that it was possible that Catra reopened the wound with all the haste. Catra still had tears seeping through her eyes and she laid down and her claws scratched the mattress, but she kept her eyes on the blonde as she shuffled around.

"It's gotta be around here somewhere.... " Adora mumbles to herself, digging through a draw. Catra heard something rattling as Adora celebrated and rushed over with a glass of water.
"Here, I know you have no reason to trust me but, if you take this it'll get rid of the pain, at least for a few hours. " Adora took out a pill and opened her hand to Catra. Catra panted, watching the pill then back to sincere blue eyes.
"It's okay, " Adora reassured the magicat.
"Uh, *do* you know how to take it though?.... " Adora asked gingerly. Catra hesitated but shook her head, she wanted the pain to go away so she'd do anything right about now.

"Oh. Sooooo, when you put this in your mouth, you gotta wash it down with the water to swallow it. Trust me the taste isn't nice when it melts on your tongue though. " Adora gave a nervous chuckle, her palm still opened in front of the feline.
Catra passed glances to her hand then back to her once more, she was uncertain but if the blonde was a threat.... She couldn't see it. At least not right now.

Catra attempted to sit up, and whimpered as Adora helped her. She tried to do as the blonde had previously instructed, putting the small capsule into her mouth and drinking the glass of water soon after. Admittedly, Catra struggled at first but managed to swallow the pain killer.

Within the first few minutes she could feel the pain fading away. The magicat sighed in relief, before remembering that Adora was there, her ears then pinning back as she huffed her thanks and avoided the gaze burning into her head. This entire time, Catra hadn't spoken, simply made noises, she didn't want to speak, not yet, her throat didn't feel like it would cooperate anyways.

Adora backed away, she could understand that the feline needed space right now and offered it to her.

"Hey... " Adora said softly as she stopped at the entrance of the tent. Catra's ear perked up, listening.
"I'm going out for a small bit, maybe get some more bandages. Is

there anything specific you want? "
Catra thought, her tail curling close to her legs. Her stomach growled and she cursed it in her mind. She had to speak whether or not she wanted to.
"Food... " She managed to croak out, her voice extremely horse even though she just drank water. Her voice hadn't been used in a while to be honest.

Adora smiled a little and nodded. Food. Easy peasy right. She just read the book again anyways.

Catra watched as she left, and touched her bandage, her hand shaking slightly. She snarled and pinned her ears back, flopping down to her good side with a minor wince. She curled her knees up to her chest and put a hand behind her head, her tail swishing idly behind her. She worried about Moonshine, if they found her, if she was safe. But the way the blonde one interacted with her, hinted that they knew nothing of it. It put her mind at ease for now. Maybe when she's healed she can go back to the village. All things accounted for, she couldn't get very far without reopening that wound again. At least not for a long while.

Catra sighed, cleared her throat from the stuffiness it felt and waited. She hasn't eaten in about 36 hours, she just hoped Moonshine was able to get home and eat something.

Rolling onto her back, Catra saw the book on the table and picked it up. Scanning through the pages, the book seemed to be really old, almost as old as her. Just as she barely glimpsed a name on the back page she slammed it shut and turned back onto her side into her previous position. Adora pulled open the curtain to the tent a few seconds later.

Adora saw Catra's tail idly swaying behind her, her hand behind her head as she laid on her good side, her ear facing upwards as she stepped in.

"I brought food! I didn't know what to bring so I brought a whole chicken, and some more water. " Adora announced as she stepped

in, beaming as Catra sat up and sniffed the air.

Adora laid the giant plate onto the mattress and Catra sniffed it. She's still wary of the blonde after all.
Catra, sure that it was safe to eat, then takes a claw and slices off a leg with ease. Adora staring in awe, gulps.

~~

While she ate, Adora explained what happened, apologizing profusely for their mistake and being sure to tell her that she wasn't being kept prisoner, and that there were just lots of nosy villagers around.

While recounting the story of how she gave up her commander position, Catra's ears perked up in surprise, Adora's eyes following them as she tried not to giggle.

She didn't think someone could be so selfless all at once, for a stranger nonetheless. The feline could almost hear the remorse in Adora's voice as she continued. The guilt, even the need to make it up to her, it was very admirable honestly. It made her smile as she kept eating and replenishing her strength.
One sentence however made her pause in every movement she was making.
"- I decided I should take care of you till you recovered completely... by myself. I came in here and changed your bandages, took care of your fever and calmed you down when you were fretting in your sleep. It was the least I could do-"
Catra's ears flattened, that voice... The pain.... The burning.... It was all a fever? It was all this woman taking care of her?

But Silver?.... Then that was a memory....
It wasn't real- of course it wasn't.

Catra felt a tear pricking at her eye and shoved it down.

"Wait- you took care of me... Alone? " Catra rasped out, her ears drooping lower. Adora stopped speaking and nodded. She seemed

glad to hear Catra speak. Catra didn't know what else to think of it. She felt her cheeks heating up and avoided the blonde's gaze.

As Catra finished her food, she winced a little. She's still in a bit of pain, Adora put the plate away and helps her lay down.
"Hey, can I stay here for the rest of the day?" Catra looked to the woman, then nodded. It was okay. She wanted to ask about the book at some point anyhow.

The rest of the evening, Adora asks her small questions, confirming some facts she knew from the book. It was a nice feeling, for both of them. Catra was able to speak with someone instead of wallowing, and Adora can finally get her questions answered and compliment how cute her ears were. Catra blushed and looked away at that moment.

At dusk Adora finally leaves. To her own house maybe.
Catra finally getting a chance to lick herself clean after a long time.

Later that night however, the painkillers wore off, and the night got cold, causing her both pain and discomfort. Around midnight, a familiar scent caught Catra's attention, her head slowly rising to see reflective blue eyes but the flap of the tent.
"Moon? "
A mew came in response as her kit came closer, hopping atop the bed and hugging her carefully, and keeping her warm that night. She's safe.

Chapter 4

Chapter Summary

Catra being Catra also Adora gets a glow up, art not mine this time, cover is mine however



Catra informed her daughter about her condition that same evening, reassuring her that she was safe and that she would return home as soon as she was healed.
"Can I visit every night though? " Moonshine asked and Catra

nodded, purring as she nuzzled her. She was extremely happy to hear that Moon could handle herself at just 6 years old. She taught her well.

Moonshine was able to keep Catra warm for the rest of the night, the extra body heat warming the wound at her side.
But that warmth was only temporary as her kitten left at dawn.

Adora came by that morning, right on time. Just....she noticed Catra's shivering as soon as she entered, her being awake seemed to make her more responsive to the cold wind. Catra's tail was curled into her side, her body also curled close, which made the pain worse in her side, with the angle she has to stay to keep warm.
Catra was immediately awake when Adora entered however and she tried to sit up as much as she could.

"I... I need the pain killers again. " Catra winced and held her side. Her fur still a little frizzed from the cold.
"Are you cold? " Adora asked concerned. Catra shuddered again and growled, "what gave it away?.... "
"Did the blanket not help?... "
"No... " Catra looked away as Adora took out the pills. Adora hummed, maybe she can tell Angella about that later. She didn't want the feline to freeze to death out here.
As Catra downed the pills, the room grew quiet. So the blonde decided to break the ice for the day.

"Did you sleep well, despite the.. Uh... Everything for the first time. " Adora gestures with her hands to basically the entire room.
Catra stopped and thought, addmitedly she did, until her kit left, taking the extra body heat with her.

"Yeah.. I guess, it's super quiet out here though... "

"Is it not quiet back in the woods? " Adora raised a brow in question. She hasn't exactly slept in the woods so she wouldn't know.
Catra shook her head, "there's always the crickets or...something."

Or a soft lullaby...
She'd never mention singing her kit lullabies at night, nor Moonshine, not until she was ready.

Catra learned a song long ago, around 8 years ago. When she had just met Silver they sang each other to sleep when they snuck out from home. She was around 18 that time.

A small sentimental smile crept along her features and Adora misread it,
"You miss it huh? The woods? "
Yeah... She missed something alright... Someone....

Catra gave a confirming nod and Adora hummed.
Adora looked at Catra's eyes, mismatched but...beautiful, but then the blue band on her hand caught her eye as the feline raised her hand to sip some more water. Her heart broke and she teared her eyes away.

Catra caught the disappointed gaze from the blonde as she turned away. She couldn't figure out what that was about, it puzzled her.

Catra pinned her ears back and dared to ask. But as soon as she opened her mouth, Adora spoke.
"Do you have a family?... " Catra's eyes widened. She shifted slightly.
"Yeah... Whatever I have left of it... " she looked to the mattress and sighed. It was a touchy topic but yesterday she said she'd answer whatever question the blonde had, unless she snapped with how sensitive it was.
And she has snapped, Adora had moved to touch the band on her wrist and Catra had snapped at her, they were left in a silence together until, Adora brought food for her to make up for crossing a line. But that was in the past, she didn't want to deal with the guilt right now.

Adora scooted closer, Catra fiddling with the blue engagement band.
"Do you want to talk about it?..." Catra's ears dropped and her

gut twisted she was about to snap but she held it back. With a strained calm temper, she replied with,
"No... At least not yet? " Her eyes pleaded up at the blonde, trying to get the point to her. Her family is generally a touchy topic, so calm down with those questions.
Adora nodded but still attempted to get closer, wrapping her arms around the feline and daring to hug her.

"Take your time, however long you may need, it's no rush. I just guess I feel bad from basically kitnapping you. "

"D-did you just say *kitnappin*g? " Catra thought she heard it wrong. Adora chuckled nervously and recoiled.
"Too soon for puns? " she made a sheepish grin.
"Yyyyup."

~~

It was close to noon and Adora left Catra to take a nap. A cat nap, hehe. She giggled as she walked. Well.... More like skipped. You couldn't blame her, she loved spending time with the magicat, it's all so surreal and exciting. Figuring out how to read her expressions and seeing the way her tail moves, it's all so exciting!

Taking a quick stop at her room, Adora removed her armor, come to think of it she doesn't need it, she's just visiting that little tent everysingle day, not avoiding getting run over by a wild boar.

Which, mind you, has happened...

Adora shuddered at the memory. Her back was sore after that encounter, she never wanted to go through that again.

Adora looked at herself in her mirror, she seemed fine with just her long sleeved, white undershirt and her long grey pants, her black combat boots just always made the cut. And she owned several.

Looking over her hair, she groaned, having her hair in her ponytail bothered her these days, it was always getting out of hand to be

honest.
She took a pair of scissors and braced herself.

~~

On her way to the village leader, Angela, who was also her adoptive mother, she got lots of..... Looks. It was kind a unnerving.

The guards almost didn't recognise her and stopped her, only to fumble as she pointed out who she was.
Glimmer and Bow were no different when they saw her, busy rubbing their hands through her freshly cut hair. As of now, instead of that signature ponytail, she made an undercut.... She couldn't muster up the courage to cut the entire thing.
So she still had her poof and ponytail, but now an undercut with some markings.

(I am in love with this image, how could I not?!)



"I am loving the new haircut!" Glimmer squealed, elbowing Bow who had to control his excitement. Bow cleared his throat, here we go again,
"Bow, we got to save enough excitement for that magicat Adora has been harbouring. She's gonna pass out when she sees it. " Adora rolled her eyes and walked on.
"I need to see Angela, it's about the cold. " Adora explained as the duo ran up beside her.
"Well, she's free for now so let's go! " Glimmer dragged Adora by the arms to her mother's workspace.

~~

"The coldness of the night seems to be causing a problem with the pain, ma'am." Adora informed and Angela put a hand to her chin.
"We have the rest of the week to wait before we can move her without hurting her, she should be healed by then. When that time comes of course, you can move her to your chambers, with you. So if anything goes wrong at night you'd be right there to assist. " it sounded like a reasonable plan for now. But a week? Catra might as well go into a fridge.

"There's no way to do it sooner? " Angela shook her head at this. "It'd damage the wound, and it'll prolong the healing process. " Adora sighed.

"Thanks for your time. " She gave a nod and left. How else was she gonna figure out how to keep her warm?...

~~

When Adora arrived at the tent, she saw Catra reading her book and the feline clicked her tongue, closing it.
"So... Your name's Adora Grayskull huh? " Her tail swayed to the side, she seemed a bit different, the nap probably did some good for her.

"Yeah, I almost forgot. "
"Your name? " Catra smirked, teasing the blonde.
"N-no, I forgot to mention it-" she rubbed behind her neck, "and forgot to ask for yours... " her cheeks tinted slightly.
Catra chuckled lowly, "it's Catra. "
Adora's smile widened. It was a nice name, unusual but cute nonetheless. The blonde cleared her throat, coming to sit nearby.
"Last name? " Catra's ears shot up. Right. Last name too. Ugggh the embarrassment.
"M....."She turned away mumbling her voice trailing off.
"What?" Adora chuckled she didn't think Catra would be so nervous about something like a last name. Catra grumbled, her ears falling back.
"Meow Meow... " she sighed avoiding the blonde's eyes, burying

her face into her pillow. Adora's eyes widened and she cooed. "That's adorable! "
"No it's nooooot! " Catra whined regretting her existence.

"So Grayskull, like the legend? " Catra short back before Adora could continue her baby talk.
"Oh yeah! You know it? "
"Pfft, who *hasn't* heard the legend of She-ra? Apparently we got this whole thing on the walls saying she helped the tribes a long time ago. Or something like that. "
" Yeah! I heard she had great hair though..." Adora groaned in jealousy.
Catra laughed and Adora was caught off guard. It's the first time she heard Catra laugh like that, it was adorable, she smiled to herself and blushed a little.
"Oh come on Adora, you got just as amazing hair, and I'm sure just as much muscle. " Catra teased bopping her poof.

Yes, Catra had noticed her new hairstyle. She had a momentary heart attack when she walked through the tent but settled for bringing up her name instead. Great distraction of you asked her.

Adora's cheeks flushed and she pouted looking away.

"She's platinum blonde, I'm a dirty blonde... " she folded her arms grumbling.
"Oooo don't let the girls hear that~" Catra called, Adora has told her about her love life when they talked. Telling her how everyone drools for her but, they just weren't the one for her. Catra guessed it was a nice place to tease her about it. Get her to laugh about it instead of sulking over being single forever.

Adora flushed crimson at the innuendo and playfully shoved the feline of whom was on the verge of rolling on the ground at this point. But she settled for pressing her head against the buff girl's shoulder.

"I have never seen this side of you, you are cruel. I'm leaving! " Adora playfully scolded Catra and shoved her again, attempting to

get up. Catra chuckled,
"Wait no! I'm sorry hahaha! It's ahahaAHA! " Catra couldn't contain it, the look on Adora's face when she pointed it out was enough to keep her wheezing. She reached out and grabbed the blonde's palm, keeping her from leaving.

Adora gasped and looked back at their interlocked hands, Catra's laughing also dying down to register what she was doing. Adora's face was crimson, her mind was on over drive. Catra finally processed her actions and pulled her hand away and looked anywhere but at those eyes, her ears pinned down.

Adora noticed the way Catra just distanced herself from everything, her laughter gone, her ears dropped and her tail curled close to her body as she avoided her gaze. So she sat back down next to her and nudged her shoulder with hers,
"Hey... Ready for 21 questions? " Adora changed the topic, she liked answering the questions as much as asking them anyway. Catra chuckled smiling a little, "yeah... "

~~

5 day passed by quickly, Adora always tried her best to keep Catra smiling and showing her fangs with laughter instead of malice. Every night, Moonshine came by and she was able to sing to her again. She was left with the pain killers near her pillow so as soon as the pain came back she could take another.

Moonshine nuzzled into her mother, purring, still awake.

Saying that Catra hasn't purred in so long would be a complete lie, she found herself purring when she thought of the blonde that always cared for her, when she stepped out for food or anything random Catra asked for to test just how much she was willing to do for.
For example, Catra had asked Adora to bring her a dried Femur bone of a hog with a flute. Adora surprisingly didn't question it and took all day to round up those exact items. It left Catra beyond dumbfounded when she was handed these items by the

disheveled woman who had a bright proud smile on her face. As soon as Adora left to get cleaned up, Catra heard that rumble in her throat as she looked down at the items in her hands. But she shut it off as soon as she realized what made the sound.

She would never let herself get attached.

..

....

Leaving would just hurt her.

..

...

"Momma can you sing for me? " Moon nuzzled closer, smashing her ear on her mother's face. Catra purred.
"Sure kitten. Which one? " Catra spoke into the silent night.
"The one about the silver moon, was it? " Moonshine especially loved that one because it had the word Silver in it, so she associated it with the mother they never got to meet. Catra told them about Silver but, they'd never actually get to experience it for real.
"Really? " Catra wanted to make sure.
"Yeah... Everytime you sing it, it's like... I feel her here with us... " Catra's eyes widened and she run her fingers through the kitten's fur. Magicats being a rather superstitious species wouldn't mind believing in stuff like these. Things like the elders looking down on them, loved ones guiding them. Pfft, even Catra believed it. Her father told her, her own fair share of stories when she was a kit after all.

Catra took a deep breath steadying her emotions for this. What Moonshine had just told her, changed the meaning of the lullabies for her a bit.

Daughter of the moon - by adrisaurus (lyrics):
https://youtu.be/eSxkMwKF8Ks

..

...

Catra sighed and started her soft song.

Silver light
She turned her face up to the starlit sky
And on this night began to wonder why
She knew that soon the day would come

Catra looked up to the roof of the tent.

Born to be
An heir of beauty and serenity
Into this world she entered quietly
To her surprise she was the one

Moonshine shifted looking out the small window at the stars, the moonlight seeping through.

Destiny was close behind her
Phantom of borrowed life
And the sea was a reminder
Mirror of given light

Catra felt Moonshine shuffle closer and burrow her face into her neck, a small sniffle before some purring. Catra felt her fur raise, her eyes stinging slightly.

Then one day
The sign she'd waited for in signs of grey

Traversed a winding road and came her way
She'd found the love she'd hoped she would

A memory of the first time they met came to Catra, Silver's eyes that same day they bumped into eachother.

But she knew
That she had promises to stay true to
A dormant daughter of the silver moon
And all at once she understood

A memory of Moonshine's birth crossed Catra's mind. That moment... She was gone. She promised....

Destiny was close behind her
Phantom of borrowed life
And the sea was a reminder
Mirror of given light
From the sky she watched the life
she'd known she would leave behind
Said goodbye and gave her people
life through her sacrifice

Catra was actively crying now her voice cracking through the last three lines. Moonshine was fast asleep in her mother's nape, ear pinned back and curled in on herself.
Catra sniffled, her ears pinned back as she looked out the small window. She squeezed her eyes shut and took a staggered breath, swallowing thickly and trying to calm the way her fur rose into the still night air.
Catra ran her fingers over her kitten's fur and soothed her thoughts.
She considered Adora but... Sniffled again...
A vow is a vow....
"A promise is a promise... " She exhaled into the air, curling into her kit and trying her best to doze off.

Chapter 5

Chapter Summary

Catra gets to try walking around again.

Chapter Notes

Okay yes I actually did research on getting shot. Apparently it takes around 8 days for the blood cells to finally start healing the wound and fighting the bacteria there, but at this time they can start moving about, I believe. Because most of the pain will be gone.
Don't come for me if I got something wrong, pleaseeeee uwu

Adora's on her way there the usual time, only that morning she especially has a pep in her step and her chest puffed out. She was finally able to try moving Catra to a much warmer place today. Plus if Catra was able to handle it, she wanted to spend the day with her, walking around the village, giving her a tour of sorts and letting her meet her two best friends. Totally **NOT** a date, hehehe...

When the blonde pulls open the flaps, she noticed Catra was still sound asleep. The blanket bunched around her waist as she slightly hugged the pillow under her head. Taking a few steps closer, Adora admired her, watching the rise and fall of her calm breaths and the small thrills she gave through her exhales.

A part of Adora's knew that Catra was aware of her entering the tent from the start, and that she trusted her enough to stay asleep and off her guard. She smiled as a small thought came to her mind.
It took little convincing for Adora to slip herself next to the sleeping magicat. Adora hovering her hands close to Catra's shoulders, unsure as if to hold her. A small thrill got her attention, Catra wrapping her hands around the blonde and snuggling into her nape with a small purr. Adora almost short circuited at that,

but she returned the gesture by holding her close and keeping her comfortable.

It wasn't long before the softness of Catra's fur calmed her to sleep. It was just **SO** soooooooft! Adora definitely wasn't complaining.

About an hour later, Catra's eyelids fluttered open, the strong scent of Adora filling her senses. Catra blushed at first but simply let herself relish in the vanilla scent. Burying her face deeper into the source, and closing her eyes. She let herself purring, just this once. Adora was asleep so she figured she wouldn't notice.

Oh how she thought wrong....

Upon feeling the rumbling of Catra's chest Adora woke up, her cheeks blazing up as soon as she felt Catra nuzzling into her even more, seemingly awake and doing it on purpose.
But even the fire in her cheeks couldn't stop the grogginess of her voice.
"Pfft, are you purring, kitty? " Adora made a smug grin combing through Catra's mane. Adora hasn't heard Catra purring before at least not in front of her.

Catra's eyes shot open once more and she pushed the blonde away in attempt to escape. With Catra now looking away from the blonde she gave a forced growl.
"No! You're hearing things!"
Adora smirked, "you liiiike meeeee~" she wiggled her eyebrows mockingly and Catra huffed.
"I do noooot! Stop being so full of yourself! " Catra smooshed her hand against the blonde's cheek, attempting to push her away.
But Adora only giggled, snorting in the process.
"Hehehe*snort* you so like me, " Adora giggled as Catra kept pushing her away, the dark blue blanket falling off them both.

Catra scoffs, denying it, "pfft-wha-you were in my bed anyways! What's ***your*** excuse?! "
"How could I not? Your ears twitch when you sleep, it's cute!

Alsoooo I didn't see ***you*** complaining~" Adora shot back smirking even wider. Catra got herself tied up with that one.
"I am **NOT** cute!! " She tried to escape her cheeks tinted, as Adora reached for her and scratched behind her ears making her purr betray her.
"See? Cute! " Adora beamed and Catra folded her arms, the both of them now sitting next to each other.

As the laughter died down, Adora kept watching Catra, her tail subconsciously wrapping around the blonde's ankle. She really likes having Catra around to be honest, it makes her happier.

"Hey, Catra. You free today? "
"Um, isn't it obvious? " Catra dead panned.
"Just making sure, causeeee I got plans for us today! " Adora beamed and looked for a reaction.
Catra dropped one ear, signalling her confusion. Where was this going?
"Okay, so. First off, we're gonna move you to my room, it's much warmer there, secondly, I was hoping you could meet my friends aaaaand then I was hoping we could spend the rest of the day together, simply just.... Touring the village I guess? " Catra listened on, her interest was piqued. She wouldn't mind having a change of where she slept, being closer to a calming scent? Even better.
Just.. Moon... She'll have to leave a note for her so she won't panic.

"I'm in! " Catra nods at her, her tail swaying.

"Great! Ready to try walking? "

Right... Her injury.

Catra visibly flinched and Adora rushed to the rescue,
"We can take it easy, no rush. I'll be right here to help. "
Catra took a deep breath and sighed. Holding her hand out, Adora grasped it, if Catra were to fall from either reopening the wound

or because of the lack of using her legs, she was gonna be right there to help her.

Catra counted to three in her head, taking another deep breath before easing herself off the mattress. Honestly she did this before, to the excuse of a bathroom and back, but she always held onto something the entire time, without Adora around to witness the humiliation and her rushing for pain killers. Now was different, she had to try doing it without holding onto anything, like learning to walk all over again. Easy right?

Adora stayed close, Catra not noticing when she let go of her hand, of which was still in the same position, Adora's hovering close by. Catra took a step... Then another, almost buckled over and Adora right there waiting to catch her, but then she took another and another. Catra chuckled to herself, smiling. Adora clapped and smiled as well, causing Catra to notice the lack of touch from the blonde. Catra's smile grew and she laughed looking over to Adora.
"How long did you let go? "
"Since you started. " Adora smiled to herself, Catra shaking her head fondly.

Grabbing Catra's blanket, Adora hung close to the feline as she led the way out the tent, holding up the flap for her to pass. Adora noticed Catra's height for the first time. She was about 3 inches shorter than her and of course Adora teased her about it.
"Hehe shorty. " Adora stuck her tongue out and Catra glared back at her, her ears pinning against her head. Her tail gave her a thwap against her calf and Adora chuckled walking behind her, then bumping her hip into Catra's. Who in turn, bumped her back just the same.

~~

As Adora creaked open the wooden door to her bedroom, Catra took notice if her surroundings, the entire building in which she slept seemed to be connected to another huge one, who had the time to build this?!

Catra even had time to notice the windows Adora seemed to leave open even when she left. The blue curtains she had flowing calmly with the breeze, the rising sun starting to peek through. Radiating upon her large, fluffy, rather pink bed at the center of the room. At the foot of the bed there was a large, black bear skinned rug, rather fluffy one at that.
Catra's claws almost got caught in the furry rug as she stepped on it. Looking around some more she noticed a dressing table with a mirror, several sets of antlers on the walls, trophies no doubt.

Moving over to the dresser, Catra ran her claws carefully over the wooden top. Adora sitting on her bed looking on.
"You like it? " Adora asked, referring to her room.
"Yeah, it's much nicer than mine, I'll admit. " Catra huffed smirking and looking up to the roof. Watching how it was done. Maybe get some tips for her own house.
"How in Etheria did they make this? " Catra woahed some more, her eyes falling on the blonde.
"Pfft, it's too complicated honestly. The entire village pitched in, and Angella supervised the entire thing. Took about 6 months I think. " Catra's ears perked up.
"Only 6 months?! Just by looking at it you can guess about a year at most. " Catra went over to sit on the mattress as well, making a small oomf as she sunk into it slightly.

"Ugh, it's super soft. " Catra held onto the blonde for balance.
"Lots of chickens paid the price. " Adora snorted, "they shall be missed. " she put a fist to her heart.
"You're such an idiot. You know that right? " Catra held back a giggle.
Adora scoffed, stuck her tongue out at the feline and got up.

"Picking where you're sleeping yet? " the blonde flopped down on her usual spot on her bed, stretching but trying not to get too comfortable.
"What offer's on the table? " Catra simply leaned backwards on her elbows.
"Up here with me. But you can pick wherever you want, no pressure. " Adora rushed out the last part, chuckling nervously.

Catra contemplated this for a bit,
"If it's okay, I'd take the floor. I don't wanna intrude. " she said remembering this morning. She heard Adora let out a disappointed 'oh'.
"Okay, now that that's settled... " Adora got up handing Catra her blanket and going towards the door, "we got a lot to do today. " she smiled brightly.
Sometimes Catra wondered what she hid behind that smile. She always seemed happy, no one could be this happy... And she's sure, not even someone as kind and selfless as Adora can.

~~

They were currently walking through the village market. Adora bought her a really nice strawberry and Catra was in love with it! So she got 15 more.

Adora saw a different shine in Catra's eye as she moaned over the juicy strawberries. She liked seeing it.
"Adora! " Catra called out and Adora walked into a pole with a grunt. Adora held her head and groaned.
Catra laughed and asked if she was okay, Adora smiling and chuckling along.
"What's got you so distracted? Hehe. " Catra inquired.
"Hey lovebirds! " Before Adora could respond Glimmer came barreling into her hugging her tightly.
"Hey! Ugh, we're not lovebirds, Glimmer! " Adora grunted as she reciprocated the hug then attempted to pry her off.
Catra chuckled, "who's the sparkly one? "
"Oh Catra this is one of my best friends, and well half sister, Glimmer. "
"Glitter, got it. " Catra clicked her tongue eating another strawberry. Adora chuckled and gave a wide smile as Glimmer groaned at the nickname.
"It's Glimmer. " the pinkette tried to stay polite.
"That's what I said Sparkles~" Catra teased nonchalantly.

Bow walked up to them and Catra froze slightly. Adora grew worried at Catra's sudden quietness as Bow introduced himself.

"Catra?.... You okay?.... " Adora asked stepping in front of her. Catra finally pried her eyes away from the arrows in his quiver, focusing on the blonde's touch instead. Adora noticed her tail hugging around the bandage and the way her pupils shrunk to pinpricks and gasped softly.
"Bow... Your arrows.... It's-- "
"Say no more my friend. " Bow saluted in understanding and left to put them somewhere safe.
"Hey, hey, it's okay. " Adora cupped the feline's cheek, her ears pinning as she looked up into grey-blue eyes.

It's the first time this has happened, it's like Catra felt it go through her all over again, felt the pain she had to go through the past week just resurfacing in a memory. It scared her...

"Come on... Breathe... " Adora tried to help her calm her thoughts down. Glimmer and Bow watching the interaction with just as much worry. Catra followed Adora's breathing,

in....

Out....

In.....

She sighed, her tail wrapping around Adora's leg, grounding her.

"That's it. You're okay... " Adora smiled, her eyebrows pinched with sympathy. Catra exhaled once more and hugged Adora, she needed that vanilla scent to ground her fully. Catra nuzzled into the blonde's chest and neck, Adora letting her do what she needed to. She hugged her back.

Glimmer whispered to Bow, "yeah something's definitely up. " Bow chuckled and nodded putting his hand to her shoulder.

Catra finally calmed down and Bow left his arrows behind as they walked on together, Adora staying close to the magicat.

"Best friend squad Cannonball? " Bow asked excitedly hoping to coax them into going into the nearby lake.
"No, Bow. At least not today, we're getting close to winter. It's gonna be freezing. " Glimmer said buying some blueberries for a cake she planned on making that evening.
"Besides, Catra might scratch our eyes out if we agree. " Glimmer joked and Catra gave a smirk.
"I would. " Glimmer blinked, she was just joking! Jeez!

Finally getting Adora alone, Catra wanted to ask her a question. Glimmer and Bow bickering about the lake behind them.
"Hey Adora?" Adora hummed smiling.
"Do you.... Do you have a crush on me? " Catra looked directly into her eyes and saw them widen a bit. Adora's face going crimson as she stammerer a little. Catra moved closer and Adora turned even more redder, she addmitedly didn't think that was possible with the tint she was seeing.
"Do you? " She tried again, but more of a whisper.
Adora opened her mouth but instead avoided the mismatched eyes staring into her soul and saw a strawberry farmer nearby.

"Hey! You can get more strawberries, I'm sure we'll get them for free this time. Yo! Peter!" Adora shoved her hands at her sides and marched off, literally. Her knees went pretty high. Catra chuckled at the silliness of it all. But then she sighed.
She got the answer anyways....

~~

That night, Moonshine passed by and almost panicked seeing her mother's bed empty and no guards outside. Sniffing around she got the usual scents. Her mother's and that same vanilla one that had tiny hints of cinnamon. A safe scent Catra told her.

While scoping out some more, the blonde kitten saw a small pink paper sticking out from under the pillow.
She took it and read it.

Moved to the big house. Follow my scent; tracking lesson.

"Yess! Finally getting to try tracking someone. " Moon has never tracked actual people before, so she assumed it wouldn't be as hard, just like tracking prey.
And she was right! She found her mother's scent almost instantly, and followed a trail all the way through the dormant village. She saw an open window where the scent was strongest and peeped through.

Catra was curled up on the rug, wearing some new clothes, they were a bit big, but they kept her warm nonetheless.

Catra's ear twitched, hearing a familiar grunt as something fell a small way by the window. She chuckled softly to herself and Moonshine bounded over to her and leapt into her arms. Regaining her composure, Catra put her finger to her lips signalling to be quiet. When she pointed to Adora on top the bed, Adora was still sound asleep, her hair spread all over her pillow as she tucked her knees close to her chest. Moonshine followed the direction her finger pointed and nodded with a small smile, hugging her mother again. Proud of the tracking lesson.

Moonshine snuggled up with Catra once again, and they both actually fell asleep much faster than usual. The warmth of the room pulling them both to sleep in seconds. The one thought on her mind as she fell asleep was the fact that she was falling for someone while she shouldn't, but that same person liked her back and she didn't know what to do, she didn't want her heart to shatter again. She's still picking up the pieces.

A tear slipped out her eye as she curled around her kitten in the soft bear fur beneath them.

She's getting too vulnerable...

Chapter 6

Chapter Summary

A visitation

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

"Catra.... " A familiar voice called out, echoing amongst a vast, void of darkness.
"Fluff? " Catra questioned in bewilderment, her voice also echoing causing her to join her ears back.
Someone stepped out into Catra's view. A silver-white pixie cut, bright blue eyes, a solemn smile and she was a magicat.
Catra ran to the person, hugging her tightly.
"How-..... I... " Catra couldn't form words, so she sighed and held tighter. Her voice not echoing as much.
Silver hugged back and ran her fingers through the taller girl's mane.

"I miss you... " Catra whispered, and nuzzled into her.
"I know, I miss you too." Silver sighed, "but we need to talk."
Catra's ears lowered as she tried to process how she was able to talk to her in the first place.
"I'm only gonna be here for a little while okay? But we really need to talk, you're asleep right now. " Silver informed her and Catra nodded, this was crazy but she's seen crazier... At least she thinks so.

"It's about Adora. " Catra's eyes widened, her ears pinning with guilt.
"I'm sorry i-"
"You should. " Silver stated firmly.
"W-what? " Catra asked, her thoughts halting in confusion. She put her hands on the feline's elbows.
"You need to move on Catra, it's been 6 years, almost 7. You can't

rob yourself of being happy again if you keep holding back like this. I know I made a promise to you once, I'm not saying we should just forget about it all."
"But-... Moon... " Catra's voice faltered, she was understanding what Silver was saying but, she keeps making stupid excuses.
"She needs both her parents, she's growing up, she's gonna need support. Much more than just you."
"But I don't think I can move on like that... " Catra felt the girl's palm on her cheek.

"I'm always with you Catra. The band, everything, has to be a memory you just hold close to you. I can't be with you, and you don't deserve to grieve forever like you've been doing." Catra sniffled as Silver spoke.
"You deserve love again, stop shutting everyone out. Your dad misses you. " Catra looked to the ground. She's avoided him a lot, but she let Moon go to him whenever she liked.

"You don't have to forget me, you don't have to forget the fun of it all. Just let yourself love again. Adora cares for you, she more than wants the best for you, she can give you even more than I could have. She can help you raise. Our. Daughter. " Silver emphasized as she pressed their foreheads together.
"I made a promise that you'll never be alone through anything, that I'd be with you through anything. Adora can keep it, it's not like I can magically come back to life and everything can be perfect again. So, promise me. "
Catra's eyes widened and she looked into blue.

"Promise me, you'll reopen your heart and be happy again. *Genuinely* happy. " Catra looked away, running the words through her head again, looking as if she was being scolded.
"Promise me, Catra. " Silver was getting serious about this.
The brunette sighed, and hugged the magicat that used to be her wife.
"I promise. " Silver smiled and hugged her back.
"If you want... You can let Moonshine wear the band. I don't want you to throw away the only thing that I left for you. " Catra nodded, running her fingers over the woolen string.

"I love you. " Catra spoke, hoping to never let her go again.
"I know you do, I love you too. We got married remember, if that wasn't proof enough I don't know what was. Besides, let's wait for bt he afterlife to figure out how we're gonna deal with it all. "
Silver chuckled and gave her a small pat on the back, purring.

Catra saw the world around them seemingly fading.
"Time to go, Kitten. Don't forget you promised. " Catra sighed, "I won't. I'll miss you, so much. "
Silver nodded but her ears perked up.
"Oh and by the way, I **am** always around when you sing our song. I'm glad Moonshine cares about me. All thanks to you." Silver waved as Catra broke out into a wide smile.

~~

Catra's eyes fluttered open, and she looked at the small blonde kitten still in her arms, sleeping soundly. She smiled remembering what seemed like an actual visitation from her wife. She recalled the promise and exhaled slowly before licking her kitten's ear, causing her to stir.
"Hey, time to wake up, squirt. " Catra whispered, looking at how the sun wasn't up yet, and glancing back at Adora now sprawled out on her bed. Still asleep.
Her eyes lingered for a minute as Moonshine woke up. The warmth seemed to have made her sleep through her usual internal alarm.

A small squeak emmiting as she stretched. Catra chuckled softly.

"Come one, time to go home. "
"Awhhhh but it's so warmmmmmmm" She complained and snuggled up again, Catra picked her up by her scruff and put her away from the source of warmth her mother provided.

"Nyooooo." Moonshine said rather loudly and Catra swiveled her head to Adora's still asleep body.
"Phew."
Catra resorted to picking up Moonshine and actually putting her

out the window.
"Ugh, fiiiiine. " Moonshine grumbled as she landed in the dirt.

As the kitten left, Catra turned back to the blonde and swallowed thickly.
She made her way around to the bed and crawled up onto the foot of the bed, to a place where she wouldn't get kicked and curled into a ball, tucking her tail close.

~~

At the crack of dawn, Adora's eyes fluttered open. Noticing the weight at the edge of the bed she craned her neck to see Catra laying there. She chuckled as Catra's tail swished and nudged her with her foot.
"Hey, what changed your mind? " Adora yawned and stretched her limbs, falling back onto her pillow. She knew Catra was awake, she would be making small mews in her sleep.

"I.... I'm just.... Lonely.. Or whatever. " Catra curled her body closer into herself. Adora noticed and pat the bedside next to her. "Come on, Catra. Come up here! " She coaxed and the feline wasted no time in crawling up beside her, a tint in her cheeks. She snuggled close into the blonde's nape, purring softly, kinda hoping Adora wouldn't notice.

Adora ran her calloused fingers through the feline's fur, her bicep under Catra's head as she laid on her side. Catra's brown tail hugged the blonde's leg and Adora smiled sweetly.

"If it's okay... I don't mind answering your question... " Catra's voice trailed off against Adora's skin.
"A-Are you sure?" Adora got caught off guard at that. She just hoped it was the same ones she was thinking about. Catra nodded shifting to get comfortable and took a breath, "ask away... "

"Well.... Tell me about your family. " Adora held a bit of resistance in her voice, she wanted to know, despite the fact that the answer

might hurt her in the process.

"Huh? Where do I start? Hehe. " Catra scoffed.
"My dad is the village chief, my mom... Passed when I was just 15 years old... "
"Oh, I'm so sorry to hear that! To be fair I barely knew my parents, all I remember was a fire. " Adora tried to make the feline feel better but Catra simply chuckled.
"It's okay. Anyways, I.... " Catra faltered and Adora reassured her to take her time.

"There was Silver, my wife. " Catra paid attention to Adora's reactions. She froze slightly until she mildly panicked.
"Wait- *wa*s?! Is she-" Adora thread carefully, a bit *too* carefully to Catra's liking honestly. Catra nodded, nuzzling into the vanilla scent to calm herself, she didn't want to cry about it now. She made a promise.
All these stupid promises!
"I'm sorry... " Adora whispered, huggin her tight.
"Don't be. It was unexpected and just something that couldn't be prevented. " Catra sighed.
"How did she die?... " Adora wasn't sure if that was crossing a line so her voice shook slightly.
"She... She died after a delivery. "
"A delivery? " Adora got confused for a second.

Was it an ambush? What does she mean?

"I have a kitten, Adora. " Catra shrunk in on herself, she knew it was sudden but Adora needed to know what she was getting herself into especially if she really had feelings for her.

Adora was silent.

"I know you love me, but if that's not what you want..... " Catra's voice trailed on, but Adora cut her off before she could start spiraling.

"Wait- does that mean you like me too? " Adora whispered.

Did she not hear the kitten part?!

Catra nodded half expecting Adora to pull away from her hold, but she never did. She did quite the opposite actually, Adora's arms wrapped around her and held her firmly as she buried her face into the brunette's mane.

"If it's okay... I want to meet them. "

Catra, eyes wide, started purring as she hugged her back.

"It's funny because we've only known each other for about 2 weeks. " Catra started laughing and Adora chuckled nervously. "Hehe yeah, but I mean, I felt something the moment I met you. " Catra raised an ear in sudden curiosity, looking up into those blue eyes.
"I don't know if it's in another life-or what. But there's something about you I don't intend on losing. " Adora's brows furrowed as she looked into mismatched eyes, flicking back and forth between hers.

Catra purred, "huh... Fate has its weird ways. "

The feline's eyes suddenly flicked down to Adora's lips, several of her nightly thoughts returning. She licked her lips and the ex-commander definitely noticed, leaning closer.
Catra leaned closer as well, heat suddenly rushing to the tips of her ears and cheeks. Adora's hot breath warmed the feline's fur against her face, tickling her ever so slightly. Adora's lips finally closed the gap that separated them, a spark exploding almost instantaniously inside both their chests. Catra let out an involuntary moan at that and Adora pulled back, Catra chasing her lips. She hasn't had that in so long, it ignited something in her. Adora was a blushing mess, hiding her face in Catra's mane.
"Did-did that fluster you Princess? ~" The blonde simply blushed more and nodded, she couldn't say anything with how red her face was.

Catra ran a hand through the blonde's undercut, soothing her, or at least trying. It just made the blush worse.
"C-catra, that's not helping, " Adora stuttered.
Catra smiled and simply snuggled close to her instead.

"So uh... " Adora cleared her throat, " i-"
"First kiss? ~" Catra teased, cutting her off. Adora nodded letting out a small squeak, shoving Catra slightly.
"But T-that's not what I was gonna say, "
"Okay, okay, continue. " Catra chuckled.
"When am I gonna get to meet them? " Right, she didn't answer that one.

"Well, we can work that out tonight. " Catra said simply, sitting up and stretching.
Adora went crimson, her mind was in the gutter since the kiss, much less Catra's statement.
Catra leaned down and kissed Adora one more time, "no. We're not gonna do that, Princess~. Not until you're able to handle it. "
Adora pouted as Catra pulled away and got up to go to the bathroom, so they can both start their day instead of laying in bed all day.

Even though they wouldn't mind doing just that.

Chapter End Notes

> Yeah I know, who falls in love in about 2 weeks am I right? But yeah I slipped in the "another life" thing in there so no excuses.

Chapter 7

Chapter Summary

Lots of purring

Chapter Notes

Short chapter guysssss

Oomf

Catra pulled her eyes away from Adora's sleepy blue ones. Her previous lovestruck attention, focused on the slightly puzzled noise from by the window.
"I hate that stupid window. Now where-? " Moonshine thrilled as she saw her mom's tail dancing in the air on the bed.
"Moonshine? " Catra called in her usual voice, she didn't need to whisper, not anymore. Catra motioned with her finger for Adora to remain quiet and also flicked her nose so she could stay awake. It was pretty late after all.
"Mrrrp? " Moon kept her voice low, slightly confused as to why her mom wasn't doing the same.

"Can you come up here? Please? " The brunette curled her tail around Adora's calf. Her nerves getting the better of her.
The blonde sensed this and gave her a reassuring look, also trying to conceal her nervousness and curiosity. She was itching to turn around but she didn't want to scare the kitten away like Catra instructed, so she laid still.

Catra smiled noticing the breath that left the girl beside her. Tiny light limbs climbing onto the soft mattress, padding close and quiet. Eyes glowing in the dim lit room.
"Why -? "Moonshine cut her question short, seeing Adora's blue eyes opened, but still barely avoiding looking at her.
" I..... Need you to meet someone... " Catra sat up slightly, coaxing her kit closer.

Moon hesitated. Keeping her eyes on the blonde and crawling towards her mother.

Catra knew Moonshine was a feline who grew up skeptical about the world, questioning everything and was always wary about new people. At first she realized she got it from her. Catra's strange need to always think someone would break her trust and betray her.
So in turn she knew Moon might be a little scared or wary to see Adora awake for the first time since visiting, much less able to communicate with her.

"Moon, This is Adora... "
"She shot you. " Moonshine growled and Catra's eyes widened. She noticed Adora flinch, her eyes downcast, watching the bandage wrapped around the feline's torso.
"It was an accident.... " Adora sighed, finally speaking. Catra's tail squeezed the blonde reassuringly.
"I know, I know. And you've made up for it. " Catra leaned forward and nuzzled the woman slightly then turned back to Moon. Of whom was watching them interact, like a hawk.

Moonshine's ears flattened slightly as she looked away from them, her mouth still pursed.
"Hey.... " Catra tapped her Kit's tail. Moonshine's ear turned to her, signalling she was listening.
"I need you to try for me, okay? She's been working everyday to take care of me. Making sure I'm fed, dressed, clean and happy. I thought... Maybe it was time I introduced you to each other. "
Moon's ear dropped again, the guilt starting to sink in.

"I'm... I'm sorry, mama. " The miniature magic at leaned forward nuzzling under her mother's chin. Adora laying patiently as blue eyes turned to her, slit pupils relaxing.
"I'm sorry... " Moonshine apologized and Adora smiled sweetly telling her it was okay.

Adora took notice of her stripes and her freckles. Stripes around her small wrists and the tip of her tail. 5 freckles spread out on

her cheeks, 3 on the left and 2 on the right. The way she had a white patch at the front of her blonde hair, extra blonde tufts coming out her fluffy black ears. And the eway her claws retracted as she sat scoping her out just the same.

Adora's hand, out of reflex, started reaching out and Moon flinched causing Adora to recoil. Catra purred and the kitten relaxed taking a small breath and crawled closer, letting Adora touch her. Adora's hand instinctively went for behind her ears, scratching. Moonshine's pupils blew wide in an instant and she couldn't help the purr that rumbled in her chest, her head leaning into Adora's palm as much as it could go. The blonde chuckled and removed her hand, looking to Catra whose pupils were almost the size of saucers as she admired her. A small blush dusted across her 6 cute freckles.

Moonshine gave a small whine and crept even closer, wanting Adora to continue her scritches. As Moonshine insisted some more she curled up between the two women, Catra purring as she curled her tail around the both of them, and Adora running her fingers through both their manes. They lay like that for about 15 minutes, in complete silence before Adora spoke.
"She's amazing. " Catra perked an ear and chuckled, "oh I know. "
"You're *both* amazing~" Adora leaned and kissed Catra's ear, making her blush profusely. Catra huffed, her kitten fast asleep.
"Just go to sleep, Adora. " Catra shuffled closer, burying her face in Adora's nape.

"This is *not* because I like you. " The blushing and affection was getting her defensive.
"Riiiiiight, like you didn't kiss me this morning~" Adora whispered.
"Ugh, shut uuup. " Catra's ears fell back as she whined, snuggling closer and trying really hard to hide her blush.
"Okay okay. I'm done. " Adora sighed holding her close.

Silence....

"To be fair, it was you who kissed me so... " Catra trailed off proving her point, making Adora chuckle, yawning.

"Okay you win, Kitten. "
"I hate that nickname... "
"Nah, you secretly like it, your tail gives it away. " Catra scowled at that, trying to stop her tail's swaying. Then she snuggled back close and purred, pulling them both to sleep as blunt nails scratched at her head.

Chapter 8

Chapter Summary

Catra and her gay panicking....

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra touched her side as Adora removed the bandage. Moonshine sniffing the area and whimpering, looking up at the both of them. Catra winced and recoiled her hand.
"Be careful with it, it'll be a bit tender and swollen but it's scabbing over so it's doing okay. " Adora reassured, running her fingers through brunette locks. Catra looking up at the blonde with admiration and Moonshine gave a worried look.
"Hey, how about we give Glimmer and Bow a visit? It might do you some good. "
Catra purred and nodded, looking to Moonshine attempting to reach her arms out.
"Wait.... Can I lift her?" Adora asked suddenly, trying to predict Catra's intention. Catra's actions came to a halt at the blonde's request.
"Yeah, if she wants-"
"I can walk myself yknow?... " Moonshine muttered and Catra chuckled lowly.
"But *do* you want to?"

Moonshine huffed, and walked over to Adora tugging at her pant leg with her ears pinned back in embarrassment.
Adora looked down to the kitten tugging at her and couldn't hold back the adorable noises and baby-talk that came out of her mouth.
"Awwwh, you want up-y? " Adora hooked her hands under Moonshine's arms and lifted her. Moon's eyes could've rolled out of her skull as Adora continued babbling nonsense to her, causing

the kitten to regret her life choices, so she slightly pushed the blonde's head in attempt to escape her prison.

Catra never did that with her. At least not in any time where she would remember it forever. Maybe when Moonshine was 1 or 2, never after that. She had a reputation to maintain. Besides, if Moon didn't remember it, she wouldn't be Overly craving it like those other kits Catra happened to notice.

Catra chuckled under her breath, and attempted to get up. She winced, with a slight limp. Adora's baby-talk ceased as she noticed. Moonshine's gaze drawing to her mother with just as much worry.

Catra raised her hands, reassuring them that she was fine. Because she wasn't wearing the bandages anymore she was able to feel it much more now. It actually stung a lot, aaaand was starting to scratch too.
"Hey, Adora, it's itching... " Catra gave a sort of warning tone.
"Oh, wait lemme help. I got short nails. " Adora offered and tried to maneuver her way to the magicat, with a smaller one in her hold. But she was buff so it wasn't a big deal. Hehe.

Catra turned so Adora could get the right spot and lifted her shirt for the blonde. Adora, thinking nothing of that fact, unlike Catra's racing heart, let the feline point out the spot. Sticking the tip of her tongue out, Adora used her blunt nails to scratch that particular spot.
Catra winced a bit and Adora eased on the pressure. It wasn't long before Catra started purring as the itch subsided. But Catra's purring got louder and her tail started wagging the more it went on, and Adora found this *very* amusing.

Adora snickered as she stopped her, rather awesome (as Catra would put it), scritches.

"Oh shut up.... " Catra flushed and walked off towards Adora's wooden chest in the corner.
Digging through she searched for something warm, to cover her

healing wound and hide the blush running down her shoulders at the moment. She was so lucky she wore wraps under her clothing, else there would've been a different context entirely after a scratch like that.

Catra's mind strayed, her movements moving slower.

...

...

She bit her lip, a small breathy *"Catra~ ... "* Coming to mind, her tail frizzed a bit.

...

...

"Catra? " The brunette jumped, her thoughts rushing away as reality sunk back in.
"You okay?" Adora asked, a bit concerned and Catra fumbled for a random blue shirt, chucking it over her head hiding the darkest blush on her cheeks and ears. Catra internally scolded herself and grumbled softly.

"I'm fine. " Catra said bluntly, shutting the chest and storming off, ignoring the small pinch she got in turn because of her jerky movements.

Adora held Moonshine, a bit confused as Catra seemed a bit upset. Her eyebrows pinched as she internally panicked as to what might have ticked her off like that.
She felt a small hand on her forehead and chuckled, taking the little hand to hers and smiling a tad bit.

The blonde followed after the raging feline. Managing to catch up to her halfway to Glimmer's cabin.

Catra's embarrassment wouldn't let her stop walking however. The air was cold, her thoughts racing even further as a small chill went

down her spine and fluffed the fur there. Catra groaned, her tail lashing almost bushed out completely, she covered her face, stopping and letting out a frustrated noise. Her breath fogging up due to upcoming winter.

"Adora and her stupid hands! " Catra groaned, hoping the entire thing wouldn't cause her heat to rear it's head. She hasn't had her heat in years! And she doesn't intend on getting it back.
"Catra! " Adora called and her ear followed the sound as it approached, dirt crunching under leather boots.

Catra sighed, her ears falling flat against her head.

"Sorry... " She scowled as Adora came within earshot.

"It's okay. Let's just get to Glimmer's okay? " Adora gave a soft smile, giving Catra a side hug as they walked on. Moonshine, still in Adora's hold, watched her mother, trying to read her. To her surprise, whatever Catra was feeling was completely foreign to her. So she intended on learning. Hopefully it was a good thing, because she got lots of emotions, they were all muddled and that made it confusing.
Moon pinned her ear back and looked towards where they were heading.

~~

They were greeted by Bow. Of whom managed to get his eyes stuck on Moonshine in curiosity and awe. Glimmer came rushing by and her eyes fell on Moon instantly.
"Wow, you guys work fast-oomf! " Bow elbowed her and she groaned rubbing her side. Adora with a big blush on her face and Catra rolling her eyes.
They knew, yes, they had the whole of yesterday to let Adora rat it out while they hung out in the market.

While Catra froze her tail off...

"This is Moonshine. I was thinking she could stay while I'm here. " Catra informed. Bow cooed.

"Wait, so this kit is yours? "
"Yeah, remember I told you about Silver? This... Is our daughter. "
Catra gave them the full story not long afterwards.
Yeah, she bent her life story to her whim yesterday, Adora understood and respected that. Now she had to come clean about it. Like, how exactly she died.

Moonshine held out her hands to Catra, and the brunette took her from Adora, pressing their foreheads together. A usual form of comfort for the both of them.

"How old is she? " Bow asked and Glimmer started her baby-talk. Now Moon knows where Adora got it from. Adora grinning and agreeing with Glimmer on the side, as she took the kitten back into her arms.
"She's 6." Bow nodded, his eyes sparkling as he reached out a hand to Moonshine who was not having it anymore.

"Oh gods leave me alone! " Moonshine yelled, her tail bushing up. Everyone stopped and stepped back. Adora looked away, ashamed of herself. Seeing the light trace of a tear along the rim of her eyes.

"Hey, hey, hey. Don't cry. " Adora lifted a hand and wiped away the tear with her thumb, comforting her.
"Just stop with the baby-talk, please? " Catra looked on.
"Okay, we'll stop. Won't we guys? " Adora looked to her friends and they nodded, also ashamed.

Moonshine nuzzled into the blonde, who held her and sighed in apology.

~~

The rest of the day, Bow and Glimmer managed to turn Moonshine into a lap cat, to Catra's dismay. All the scritches were brain washing her bit by bit.

But there was something about the way Adora was watching her and flicking her eyes away when she looked to her. So the feline

sat next to her with her strawberry.
"What's with the not-so-subtle glances Adora? ~"

She was caught; her expression gave it away.

Adora exhaled looking to the group. They seemed occupied enough to not miss them for a few minutes.
Grabbing Catra's wrist, she pulled her out into the corridor, the feline letting out a surprised squeak.

"I know you're upset... " Adora said as Catra leaned against the wall.
"Upset-? " Catra started getting cut off.
"If it's something I did, I'm sorry. " Adora apologized looking to the ground.

Catra's eyes widened as she realized what Adora was speaking about. The hurt expression on her face as she stormed out the blonde's room.

Oh, Adora was still rambling...

"I'm sorry and if it's how I talked to Moon I-"
"Adora! " Catra held the blonde's face and she stopped speaking, her face still downcast however.
"I'm not upset. Not anymore. " Catra spoke calmly.
"But why *were* you upset?.... " Adora pouted.

"I.... " Catra's cheeks burned as she looked away. She swallowed, before reaching back up and tiptoed to kiss her on the lips. A gesture much welcomed by Adora.
Adora sighed into the kiss, wrapping her arms around the feline's hips. Their momentum shifting as Catra's mind went blank, causing her to now be pinned by the taller woman.
Reluctantly Catra pulled back and looked up into dazed grey-blue eyes.
"Because of.... You. Just you, every part of you that-that makes me need you. " Catra rushed out and Adora's eyebrows raised and she joined their lips together roughly.

Something deep in her wanted Catra on so many more levels right now and she could only show it, she couldn't say it. She *needed* to show it.
A soft rumble in Catra's chest made it's way forth as Adora dragged her hands up Catra's sides, being extra careful at the sensitive spot they had time to memorize. Catra made a soft needy whine and she broke away from Adora once more, the blonde going for her neck instead.
"Can... We go do this somewhere else? ~ mmmmm..... " Catra's hummed as Adora's hands found her tail, of which was being unwrapped from around the blonde's waist, onto her arm instead. She felt her hips buck as Adora used her delicate, calloused fingers to trail up her front and up her tail simultaneously.

"Adoraaaa~" Catra pleaded, her ears pinning back and her body heat rising. Shit. Her heat. Adora noticed her temperature rising and her eyes darkened remembering the book.

Adora joined their lips together and moaned into the kiss. Still pressing the brunette into the wall, her legs getting spread apart by a muscular thigh.
Taking a glance back at the doorway she thought.
"Wait, what about Moonshine? "
Catra squirmed, "she'll be fine, she's a tough kid. "

Says the one who didn't know her kitten was being dressed up with a tiara and eating cookies in the other room. And purring like an engine despite her humiliation.

"Okay... Let's go." Adora responded through a breath before she lifted Catra bridal style and they rushed off, Adora biting her lip hard as Catra attacked her neck for the time being.

Chapter End Notes

> Yes bishes! Finally, there is smut, and I decided to leave it on a cliff hanger to torture you hehehe.

Chapter 9

Chapter Summary

Smuuuuuut!

https://youtu.be/3sbDbtt-Wsw

Catra stumbled backwards, the back of her knees hitting Adora's bed. The blonde's hands bracing their fall as they smashed their lips together once more. Catra arched into Adora's hands, ignoring the small sting. Their tongues searching each other's mouths and their cheeks flushed.
"Adora~" Catra murdered helplessly against soft pink lips, her tail wrapping around a muscular thigh. Catra bit her lip, peeking up at grey-blue eyes that were basically staring into her soul.

Adora's smiled and dragged her hands down Catra's body, pausing and hovering over the feline's breasts.
"Is this okay? " Adora's asked, her voice barely above a whisper. Catra chuckled and unsheated her claws, dragging a finger down the woman's chest.

"Yes, princess... Be greedy.~ " Adora's smirked and kissed her neck, her body rolling against the smaller one beneath her, her hands pressing down firmly on Catra's tits. Catra groaned and tugged Adora's closer.
Adora's fingers tugged at Catra's shirt, and the brunette let her remove it. Admittedly, Adora was nervous as hell, she just followed the signs Catra gave her.

Hot breath trailed down Catra's neck all the way to her waistband and she whimpered, her hips bucking.
It wasn't long before Catra caught on to the ounce of hesitation she was giving off.

"Adora. Get up. "

"What-...did-did I do something wrong? " Adora rushed out, immediately responding in a panicked state. She got up, letting Catra position herself on her lap. Taking charge of the situation. She did have more experience anyways.

Catra trailed her claws down Adora's biceps, of which was earning small tears in the fabric. Adora whimpered and bit her lip, looking into the mischievous heterochomic eyes looking at her every move. Catra smirked and put Adora's hands on her hips, "keep that there. " she instructed and Adora nodded. Her drunken gaze following Catra's movements.

Catra was allowed to basically shred Adora's shirt off, and so she did, a sharp *rip* before the fabric fell loose.
Catra's eyes widened and she smirked a blush on her face.
"You don't wear anything underneath? ~" Adora blushed just as deeply and shook her head. Catra chuckled and stuck a fang out, her breaths getting laboured as she explored the blonde's skin. Kneading into plump tits and purring like an engine.

Adora muffled a moan and leaned her head back, Catra tilted her head forward, kissing and sucking along every spot that made Adora squirm. Catra hadn't retracted her claws, so her kneading left small pinpricks of blood on the blonde's breasts. Adora didn't seem to have a problem with this however, if anything it made her breathing come in a gasping crescendo much faster.
"*Catra~.....* " the feline's core fluttered at that moan, her ears facing the blonde as she leaned down to suck on her nipples. Earning even more gasps of pleasure and blunt nails gripping at her head.

Adora's legs started spreading, making room for the brunette now fixing herself between them. Sucking at her skin and licking every bit she could lay her hands on. Adora's head tilted back, her gasping much louder as Catra raked her claws gently against her back, coaxing her to lay down fully.

" princess? ~"
"Hmm? Ohhhhfuck..... " Adora felt a claw nick her abs.

"Do you want me to go further? Will you be able to... Handle it? ~" Catra nuzzled her cheek against Adora's propped up legs, looking her straight in the eyes.
The blonde thought for a while, her hair already coming out of her ponytail, and her eyes dark and deciding. But she could barely focus with Catra constantly kissing her stomach and trailing her hands all over her at the same time.

Adora nodded, and Catra gave a small smile, hooking her fingers in Adora's waist band and tugging her pants down. Catra smirked seeing how Adora was basically soaking wet for her already, and still making more. Catra laughed softly and fixed herself, holding Adora's leg and kissing down those, sweet, *sweet thighs.* Her nails pricking the skin and Adora arching into her touch on the verge of begging at this point. Her core was already getting tight.

Making her way to a soaking wet pussy, Catra nipped and bit close to the dripping source of Adora's pleasure. Seeing the blonde's hands gripping at her sheets already.
"C-catra.... Please... " She pleaded, hoping to get some sort of relief before she supposedly passes out.
Catra relented, licking a slow agonizing stripe up Adora's folds. Her tongue was rough, but not harmful in any way, so they didn't have to worry. Adora on the other hand made her worry about the neighbors. The moan she let out was *loud* to say the least.

But Catra simply smirked, enjoying both the taste aaaand the fact that she was gonna be Adora's first time. That idiot's gonna be in for a hell of an orgasm.

Catra dragged her claws under Adora's back, her eyes rolling back into her head as she spread her labia and sucked on her clit simultaneously. Adora could already feel the pressure building up, Catra nipping at the stuff nub and pulling her left hand back to herself. She collected some of Adora's slick, which happened to be be leaking out of her and eased her finger inside the blonde's warm cavern. Adora let out a guttural groan, arching and pushing her hips more into Catra.

The brunette kept her eyes on every move Adora made. Her pupils expanding with every thrust she did, that earned a deep throat moan in turn. And when Adora's voice started going higher and higher, Catra couldn't help but moan herself. She removed her mouth from Adora's clit and moved up to catch Adora's mouth in hers, almost shoving her tongue into the woman's mouth.
Adora moaned, tasting herself on Catra's lips, feeling the way Catra positioned her clothed pussy onto her bare thigh, and rocked along with her.

Catra pulled back panting and arching her spine, she inserted another finger into Adora's slopping pussy, which got a rough buck from the blonde. That was enough to hit her thigh upwards and straight into Catra's clit, her eyes rolling back as she gasped and moaned. Adora reached her hands out, holding Catra's hips and gripping onto her.

Catra hunched over the blonde, her mane in a complete mess as sweat plastered both their brows. The feline grinding and feeling Adora's fingers digging into fur, as she curled her retracted claws against her g-spot.

"AH~... C-Catra.... Please!. I-i need-" She didn't know what she needed honestly. She panted, her hair coming undone, blonde locks spread across the bed, Catra's hand gripping at the sheets near her head.

The magicat leaned down so their foreheads would be touching, her fangs showing and her breathing uneven. She moaned, her teeth clenched as she kept grinding.
"C-come for me, Adora.... Just let go... Hah... "
Adora squeezed her eyes shut and held onto Catra's shoulders as she came with a cry, a clawed hand rushing to cover her mouth because of the volume.
Catra's pumping came to a slow as Adora came, pulling out as soon as she fell limp against the sheets. She put the digits in her mouth and sucked up half of it, putting it by Adora's mouth afterwards with a raised eyebrow and a smirked. Adora opened

her mouth and lapped up her fluids, licking between every space she found, holding eye contact with the feline.

Catra whimpered and reached to pull her pants off hastily. Sitting back on Adora's thigh, the blonde putting her hands on her hips to keep her steady.
Catra kept grinding, her breathing picking back up like before, and her hips jerking with the way Adora tensed and untensed the muscle to tease her. Having her skin against Adora's like this drove her insane. Her ears pinning back and her tail lashing behind her, as the flush on her chest got hidden as it went under the wraps on her breasts. Adora smirked, reaching her hands up and removing Catra's wraps, immediately squeezing and pinching at her flushed nipples.

"Oh... Fuck.... Adoraaaa~" Catra's voice got lost in a high pitched...yowl? Adora's eyes widened at the sound and she rocked her thigh in time with Catra's hips. Her thigh was currently getting soaked with Catra's slick and there was a filthy sloshing sound emitting between their moans and Catra's cries. The feline's hands grabbed for the blonde's back as she sat up, Adora groaning as she sucked on Catra's sensitive bud, and played with the other.

Catra groaned, her voice rising in octaves as her claws pierced Adora's skin,
"Adora...HAH...I'm-I'm gonnAAAAAAHHHHH!" She came with a loud cry on Adora's thigh. Adora's hand had seemingly snuck it's way to the base of Catra's tail while she was giving her warning and it sent a bolt of electricity through her spine. Adora smirked against the magicat, wincing at the sharp pain in her shoulders from her claws.

When Catra stopped seeing white, she fell limp against Adora's body, huffing and spasming with a dull purring in chest.

Adora let out a relaxed sigh and laid down, letting Catra lay on her chest and regain her energy. Catra grinned like an idiot, her purring getting louder as she snuggled closer into the blonde's

neck, and gave small kisses along her shoulder.
"Wow.... " They both said at the same time and blushed.

"So.... First time? " Catra spoke breaking the sudden silence.
Adora nodded and hid her face in the brunette's hair, who hugged her close and listened to the way their heart beats synchronized.
"That was amazing.... " Catra sighed, feeling like a fluffy marshmallow.
"Your scream kind of gave me the impression that it was, kitten~"
Adora kissed the top of her head and Catra let out a loud purr.
"Let's just hope it wasn't louder than yours. "
"It was. " Adora chuckled and Catra flinched.
"Let's... Just hope Sparkles didn't hear us fucking. "
Adora shuddered and wrapped her arms around Catra's shoulders, the feline's tail wrapping around her waist.
"I seriously hope not. " Adora cringed and yawned.

"What about Moon?.... " Adora said groggily.
"Shit. We should get this place cleaned up." Catra said but there was silence.
"You're asleep aren't you?.... " she deadpanned. There was a snore and Catra rolled her eyes fondly, looking out the window. It was late anyways, so Glimmer nor Moonshine might come over. If anything, they played till they dropped.
Catra sighed and closed her eyes, letting Adora's heart beat lull her to sleep.

That's a problem for future Catra and Adora anyways.

Chapter 10

Chapter Summary

What are we?...

Chapter Notes

Sorry for not posting a chapter guys, lazy. Buuuuut I'm back!

"Adoraaa! - I'm gonna-" Catra winced as her head got pulled backwards. Adora's whispering close to her ear. Voice husky and daring, causing Catra's fur to frizz and a shudder to roll down her spine.
"No. You be a good kitty and come when I ***tell you to.*** *"*
Adora made another trust, her fingers gripping Catra's messed up mane.

Catra moaned as her spine got used to the new angle, her breath coming in puffs visible to both of them in the cold room.
"A-Adora..... ~" Catra purred, her walls clenching down on the shaft pumping deeply inside her.
"That's a good kitten~" The blonde smirked, leaning to kiss the feline's neck. Catra shuddered at the contact, cool breath against her warm sensitive skin.

The heat in the pit of her stomach rushed back and she begged.
"Adora- please..... Please... Ah~ I need to come! Please... FUUckkkkk~"
Adora's voice made a sort of growl as she heard Catra's pleas. Her teeth grazing the nape of her neck. The growing pressure growing unbearable.
Adora's grip tightened on Catra's body, her hips now slamming against Adora's, and her nipples getting abused by the blonde's fingers, daring her to cross the edge.

Catra cried out as she got pressed into the mattress, her voice muffled into the pillows.

"Good girl.... Ugh, good girl for me~.... You want this? Don't you, kitten? ~" Catra's eyes screwed shut, she couldn't hold back anymore and the woman above her noticed, leaning down and pressing her body close to her. Tucking a strand of brunette hair to the side, Adora's nibbled at Catra's neck.

Catra moaned, louder, her voice growing higher, her breathing coming in short. It was almost too much to hold back, the heat in her core still begging for more and trying to keep the extension of Adora inside her.
"Come for me, Kitten~" Adora whispered under her breath in her ear, sending her over the edge.
Adora's sheets tore as Catra's claws pierced through them, her tail lashing and her back arching almost painfully.

Sweet juices leaned onto Catra's fingers, a soft squelch as he chewed. Eyes blown wide as she daydreamed. Basically eye-fucking the blonde across from her.
Adora's was oblivious to that fact however, busy conversing with her friends, Moonshine playing with the dark skinned boy nearby. Yeah, it was probably inapropriate to be eye fucking her... Person, in front of her kid but, she just got off her heat and the last 5 days were heavenly. She had Adora to thank for that.

A purr rumbled as her thoughts and memories from the night before came back. Adora's mood visibly shifting upon hearing it.

'*Pfft, Adora's stupid ass smile can switch to a fucking daring smirked over night! Hehe wow. ~"*

Catra bit through the strawberry once again, noticeably slower and... More seductive this time around.
Glimmer shooting her a suspicious glare the feline didn't notice.

They'd visited Dryl a while back, managing to get a special toy from Adora's tech friend Entrapta. She's still learning but wow, Catra's glad to know her. That toy made her come so many times and had her eye fucking Adora for hours.

"Adora- hold that thought. Can you do something for me?" Glimmer still looked at Catra.
" uh, sure? " Adora quirled an eyebrow obviously confused.
"Flex your muscles for a second and raise your arms over your head. " Adora went to question it but Glimmer cut her off telling her not to ask questions.
The blonde did as she was told and Glimmer took notice at how Catra licked the strawberry and bit her lip, her claws extending slowly. As Adora's muscles tensed and rippled under her shirt.

"CATRA! " Glimmer yelled, her cheeks flushed with the realization and embarrassment.
The feline immediately jumped her fur on end as her focus shifted.
"Stop eye-fluffing Adora, your own kid is nearby! " Glimmer scolded, also managing to censor herself around Moonshine.
Catra flushed red, her ears pinning as she avoided Adora's questioning smirk. Bow took Moon away so she wouldn't hear anything she shouldn't and Glimmer continued. Without hesitation this time.

"I could see you undressing Adora with your eyes for the past hour! "

'It's been that long? '

"So... ? "

"**So?** Do that on your own time! We were supposed to be hanging out, instead your just sitting there staring her down like eye-candy! " Glimmer fumed, Adora reaching out to try to calm her down.
She made eye contact with Catra who got hooked on the gaze. It was dark, dangerous, smug and just....

A shudder vibrated through her body.

"It's okay, Glimmer. It's okay. We'll talk later. " Adora got up, not breaking eye contact and dragging Catra by her wrist, sending a

wave behind her as Glimmer complained.

"Adora? " Catra said, Adora had a neutral look on her face and it slightly scared her.
When she got pulled into a dark corner, her eyes started glowing, showing her concern as well.
"You.... Were thinking about last night weren't you? ~" Adora made a smug grin and Catra pushed her away. The blonde refusing to let her escape her place against the wall.

"I'm not letting you go until you tell meeeeee. " Adora grinned and held onto Catra, smiling giddily.
"Was I that good?... " Adora continued softly, Catra's movements stopping.

"Y-yeah.... " Catra made a dreamy smile, looking at nothing in particular.
Adora softened her grip and joined their foreheads together.
"I didn't think you.... Liked it.... "
"Are you kidding?! What made you think that? " Catra's eyes widened.
"You... You didn't talk to me afterwards. Just avoided me a little. " Catra blushed, she was guilty of that. She couldn't say a word, without embarrassing herself honestly. Afterwards, just seeing Adora would've made her squirm, or purr, or just giggle like an idiot, so she stuffed her mouth with strawberries instead.

"I just... Got nervous too easy... " Catra looked away, scowling she hated this.
"But eye-fucking me is a flex for you~" Adora smirked and Catra huffed wrapping her arms around the blonde's broad shoulders kissing her.
"What can I say, you're *extremely* attractive~" she purred.
Adora giggled and Catra paused.

"Adora, what are we?... " Adora stopped and looked into her eyes, keeping her hands on the feline's hips. She thought looking back up at her.... Adorable face omg.
"Girlfriends?.... " Catra replied unsure as if Adora would want that.

Adora's expression softened and she tucked her neck into Catra's neck.
"If you want that... " Catra hugged her close. Adora letting out a relaxed breath as she inhaled the magicat's scent.

They stood like that for a minute. Adora's face buried in Catra's hair, arms wrapped around each other against the wall.
"So... You're my girlfriend huh? " Adora smirked and Catra huffed, smiled and shoved her. Causing the snorts and giggles that followed.
"Don't let it get to your large poof, Princess~" Catra walked off a little.
"Pfft, you're the one who's daughter of the chief... Which makes **you** the princess. " Adora wiggled her eyebrows and Catra groaned, twatting the girl with her tail into Adora's arm and running off. Adora gaining her bearings after a few seconds before running after her girlfriend. Catra laughing as Adora attempted to grab her only to maneuver out of her reach and onto all fours. Bounding off as Adora yelled that she was cheating. Catra laughed.

...

Girlfriend huh?...

...

I think I like that...

Chapter 11

Chapter Summary

Catra and Moon have a small chat (short chapter)

Chapter Notes

What is going on with AO3 dude?! It's been giving me hell for almost 2 days! Been trying to send this chapter for about 15 minutes now! Idk what's up with the app, now why there's a different app, and ugggh stress!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra curled her tail around Moonshine. It's been about a month since and they had found a nice quiet place to sit.... On top of a building. Adora didn't accompany them since the brunette wanted to ask a question.

"Hey, Moon? " Catra got a thrill in response.
"Would you ever want another mom? " Silence.

Shock perhaps?

"Is it Adora? " Bright blue eyes peered up at her mother.
Catra blushed a little,"yeah actually. We've been dating for a few weeks but, I just wanted to ask you just in case. "

"She's awesome, I like her. " An image of Adora playing with the blonde kitten came to Catra's mind. She chuckled and smiled looking at the sunrise over the whispering woods.
"Yeah, she is. "

"CATRA?! " Adora called from below. Almost panicked that she couldn't find her.
When blue-grey eyes found them both atop her house they widened in horror.
"How the heck did you get up there?! Are you okay?! " Adora

started fretting and Moonshine's ears twitched, possibly imagining the blonde as her mother, which was weird to say the least.
To Catra's surprise Adora was attempting to climb to get up to her and she rolled her eyes fondly,

"Come on twerp. We should get down before Adora hurts herself trying to her up here. " Moon chirruped and leapt down off the side of the roof, holding on to a rope. Adora hadn't notice said rope and was now fuming with embarrassment as Catra landed beside her.

"Hey Adora~" Catra teased as her kitten leaned close to her purring.
"Hehe hey. Sorry I was worried. How did you get up there? Won't that hurt, using your core again?" Adora asked out of concern.
Catra chuckled.
"Nope. It's all getting better now, I can pretty much do everything like I used to now. " Catra scratched Moonshine's ear and got a rumble against her leg.

"Are you gonna be my new mommy? " Moonshine asked suddenly and Adora's eyes shot open realizing the question was directed to her. She almost looked behind her to confirm. Her face flushed crimson, matching Catra's. Scratching behind her head, Adora chuckled nervously.
"D-Do you want me to?"
Moonshine grinned and Adora's nerves calmed down. There was a new feeling in her heart now, it was so soft and warm.

Adora kneeled to Moon's eye level and she hugged her.
"I don't want to replace anyone, okay? I promise." Adora hugged her back. Catra's ears were flapping, she couldn't deny this was both heart warming and cute in it's entirety.
And thinking about Adora as her wife? Well, she loved thinking about that every night. It was no secret.

As they separated, Adora offered to go play with Moon and Catra allowed them to go of around. She had her flexibility back

obviously she wanted to go do shit on her own in the woods. Maybe she can bring back something for Adora as a thanks.

Chapter End Notes

I am so sorry for not updating everyday like usual I got through with an audition for Friendship is Tragic part 2. so I'm busy drawing stuff for the script. If you guys wanna check out part one you can find it on Scribbler Productions on YouTube if you're into My little Pony fanfic readings with lots of gore in it.

Chapter 12

Chapter Summary

A little gift

Chapter Notes

Sup? been a while huh? Sry bout the hiatus guys, just been everywhere all at once. So idk this might be another short one :)
No I haven't lost hope in this fic I just sort of forgot the details of what I was writing about lol, but I'm back, no fixed time one how much I update tho :(

Catra's ear flicked as she prowled in the bushes. Hoping to catch the sound of something small scurrying by. She really didn't want to come back empty handed from her hunt, Adora deserved to get something in return for all the trouble she put her through anyways.

chitter

Catra perked up. A mouse had just made a lucky mistake, it wasn't gonna be long before the feline sniffed it out. Staying as quietly as possible, Catra leaned over a small patch of brush, her pupils narrowing as they saw a small mouse cleaning his head and completely unaware of the predator above it. The magicat swiped him up with one swift motion, the wriggling creature scampering between her hands and she desperately tried to hang onto it. Little squeaks growing louder as she tried to keep her focus.

All she had to do was just....

Poke it. With. A. Claw. HA! she got it!

The little grey mouse made a small squeak before going completely silent. Mismatched eyes studied her find. She had to admit, her prey was actually kinda cute- NOPE- she had to get

this to Adora, she didn't have time for feelings over a... *cute* but *dead* mouse right now!

~~~

When the brunette got back to camp she was greeted by the sight of Adora messing with Moonshine's hair, only for the kitten to retaliate and ruin the blonde's golden pompadour. Catra put her hand to her pocket feeling her instincts spike for a moment. She loved this idiot, there was no denying it. She let a smirk cross her features as she walked towards their hut instead. She could just gift it to her there. Right?

Maybe hide it under her pillow? No too messy- what about on her dresser? She might freak out- ugh. She couldn't think of anything, her brow creasing.

"Hey! Catra wait up! " Came Adora's voice as she fretted. She came to a stop as the blonde ran up to her, it looked as though she sent Moon to Sparkle's or something. "Hey, you okay? You look upset." Adora put her hands to the feline's shoulder, examining her for any injuries.

"Did your side start hurting again? " That snapped Catra out of her internal questions because Adora was about to start going through every possible thing that could be making her upset in this moment. So, she just held her left arm and looked away embarrassed slightly.

"I uh-... Can we head home? I can tell you there. " she looked to her pocket but then to the people passing around them and heading to the market. Adora nodded, still concerned but led her to their hut.

How was she gonna tell her about this? Just show her a dead rat? Mouse- sorry *mouse.*

The blonde sat on their shared bed as Catra just... Stood there in the doorway, she was making this much more awkward than it needed to be. I mean- it's a gift... Just a gift.... Right?
~~~

Still rubbing the fur on her arm she started, "I uhh I went for a hunt-"

"Did you get hurt? " Adora asked firmly, wanting to make sure but her impatience getting the better of her. Catra flexed her fingers as she responded, "No, not *reeeallyyy...* "

"Catra." Adora's brows furrowed, she was getting a tiny bit frustrated. Catra walked to her and sat on her heels in front of her, the action made Adora's heart race for a moment as she watched her girlfriend fumble to explain.

Catra simply held out her hands, showing Adora the tiny scratches on her palms. Still somewhat fresh; they stung as Adora took them in her own, trying to figure out what the heck Catra was up to. "I went hunting so I can bring back something... " Catra trailed off but Adora thought it was a moment of sadness, not uncertainty. "Hey, it's okay if you didn't-" Adora dropped her hands and proceeded to cup the feline's cheeks.

"Let me finish. Please... " Catra looked into grey-blue eyes, almost wishing she could just spit it out already. Adora held her hands and nodded, promising to listen properly this time.

"I wanted to bring back something for, you. A gift or what you guys would call a prey. " She looked away, her hand leaving the blonde's as she backed up. Adora took a moment to process what was happening as Catra took out something from her pocket.

The feline looked at it for a moment, her pupils expanding as she smiled a little sentimentaly. But her instincts made her put it to her mouth and hold it in her teeth like an idiot. Still avoiding Adora's gaze she crawled over and watched as Adora automatically held her hands out, she gave a small purr and let go of the tiny object as it fell into the blonde's palms, her tail waving nervously behind her. Adora blinked as she watched Catra sit back with her ears down, taking a moment to watch what was in her hands.

It was a little mouse.

If it wasn't something being important to Catra she might've yeeted it right out the window, it was even a little wet too. But the more she looked at it, the cuter it seemed and even less gross. She felt sorry for the poor thing and it showed in her features. Catra however, read this as she didn't like it and was drooping even more.

"You- you don't need to keep it. I just-"

"Catra." The feline flinched. "Yes, it's sad. But... I don't hate it either. " That small statement made her ears perk up a bit.

she didn't hate it...

A small smile made her way across her lips as she purred loudly, letting Adora scratch behind her ear. The blonde then moved to get a small box of some sort, as much as she didn't hate it, she might have to start a small pet cemetery if Catra keeps this up.

hmmm, I might name him Benny.

Upon finishing her little task, Adora headed back over to Catra as the feline licked her small wounds. The tall woman taking her palms in hers and pressing her lips against them. Catra gave a small chirrup and smiled dreamily, snuggling up into Adora's frame and listening to her heart.

"I- I love you Adora. " The blonde's eyes lit up and she grinned.

"I love you too Kitten. "

Chapter 13

Chapter Summary

7 years huh? Some of us, only 5...

Chapter Notes

Hey *blep*
Love the feedback guys. Also I realized I'm lacking some angst, dw it's not too intense. I'm starting from Moonshine's POV this time!

Two blonde ponytails bobbed as the owners set out into the markets on another outing. Probably the 10th time this month haha. All requested by Moon and all escorted by a certain girlfriend of her mother's. She had a certain pep in her step this morning- like every morning- and it made Moon confused as to how she was such a morning person.

Either way, they were going for her favorites.

Blueberries.

While Catra liked strawberries beyond the stars, Moon had a tooth for the sour type. Blueberries. Adora found it great a kid her age was addicted to fruits, unlike some other crazy, little gremlins. Moon glared at a boy sticking his finger up his nose and cringed in disgust.

The air changed slightly as they searched through possible blueberries and strawberries to carry back home of course. Catra stayed home today, Moonshine knowing exactly why, Adora didn't question it however.

But right now she seemed really deep in thought as she watched the kitten pop a Berry into her mouth. "Moon? When is your birthday? " Her ears twitched at the question and her tail gave an almost nervous flick.

"It's.. Today actually. "

"WHAT?! " Adora yelped, completely caught off guard. The kit nodded, training her blue eyes to the befuddled woman.

"But don't you guys celebrate your birthday or something? Catra she-" Adora fumbled a bit confused as to why her girlfriend wasn't spending time with her kitten.

"Yeah we do, usually. Mom usually catches the biggest preys and bring them for me. And then we spend the entire day together." Something about Moonshine's voice at the end made her furrow her brows. What was she not telling her? She seemed sad.

"Do you... Miss the woods? "

"A little, but I don't mind. You're all pretty awesome.. " Moon's expression still remained the same though.

Adora looked toward a small fountain nearby where they can sit and guided the kitten there so they could talk out of prying ears.

Patting her lap, Adora lifted Moon so she could sit. Moonshine's ear dropped, she wasn't sure if she should say anything, since even Catra didn't know.

"You know, you can tell me if something's wrong, right? " Moonshine nodded, avoiding her gaze and thinking. The kitten sighed and her tail curled towards herself, she hoped she wouldn't get in trouble for it.

"You know what happened when I was born, right? " Adora nodded in confirmation and her gaze dropped.

"When mom thinks I'm asleep, she goes into her room and cries.... Every year. "

Adora felt her eyes burn, at the mention. It broke her heart on so many levels knowing that on a happy day for Moon, it's also a

devastating day for her, yet she tries as much as she could to make that day perfect for her kitten.

Moonshine tore her gaze away as they both fell silent. Adora raised her hand to her eye as she felt something escape.

"Mom doesn't know that I heard her. Can it be our secret? " Blue eyes pleaded. Adora exhaled and hugged the kit. "Yeah, I promise. "

~~

Later that day Adora went to her friends. She wanted to talk to Catra about everything but.... She didn't wanna come off to strong or anything, it was technically a sensitive topic for her, ESPECIALLY today.

Adora knocked on the large doors of Glimmer's house, and was greeted by Bow's bright smile. But then it feel upon seeing her conflicted expression.

"Hey what's up?" He asked, leading her inside where Glimmer sat doing paperwork.

"It's Moonshine's birthday today. "

"Awesome! But isn't that supposed to be a good thing? Why are you upset? " Glimmer turned around addressing her and seeing her expression.

"It's not entirely about her today, guys. "

They looked to each other, confused and concerned.

~~

Adora managed to speak with her best friends, get as much out of her system as she could, and even got as much advice as possible.

So now she was taking a handful of strawberries with her as she headed to her hut to speak with the magicat. It was almost dusk and she was sure Moonshine was spent and probably crashing at Glimmer's, after spending some time updating her mother on her eventful day.

Adora let out a breath and knocked on the wooden door, creaking it open a little, only to see Catra scrambling to sit up and wipe her eyes.

"A-Adora? Hey. " She tried to muffle a sniffle and avoided her partner's eyes.

"Catra... " Adora said out of empathy. Her voice trailing off as she felt her chest squeeze. As Adora walked towards the bed Catra turned away, her ears flat against her head. "I brought strawberries. " The blonde tried, bashfully, going into a pouch around her belt and presenting them to her. Catra's mismatched eyes looked to the fruits and up to Adora's kind eyes. She relented, taking them into her hands and putting one to her mouth, her tail shivering as the kindness made her emotions well back up.

"It's your Kit's birthday you know. You should've been with her today. " Adora still looked to the brunette, said girl flinching slightly.

"I know, but.... This year I just- she had you to keep her company... " Her voice trailed off as she made an excuse and ate another strawberry. Still refusing to look at the blonde for fear she might know she was crying.

"I know what you were doing, you know. It's not just Moonshine's birthday for you, it's also Silver's anniversary. "

A tear rolled down Catra's cheek as she stared into the mattress. Adora let out a breath and moved to hug the feline. Catra's voice cracked and she took a second to register the geasture before she buried her face into the Blonde's chest and gripped the fabric of

her shirt, finally letting more tears flow. While Adora shushed her quietly and slightly rocked them, she really wished she could just take all her grief away with all the pained sobs wrecking her frame.

"Your not alone y'know? " Catra sniffles into Adora's shirt. "I lost someone special too, it took Bow and Glimmer years to get me to move on. I still miss him. " Adora whispered, clenching her jaw at the last bit. She didn't want to cry, she needed to reassure Catra, not take the spotlight.

As Catra pushed her down to the pillow, she tried flexing her claws to calm herself, nuzzling into Adora's neck and croaked, "who was it? "

Adora's eyes widened and she turned her head a bit. If she continued she might start crying.... But it was for Catra, she could handle it.

"My best friend, my hunting dog, SwiftWind. "

"Y-you named your mutt Swiftwind? " Catra managed to chuckle just a little. It was working, slowly.

"Hey! He's not some *mutt*. " Adora tickled her a bit and Catra giggled her sobs dying down.

"*BUT* he was a hero. Else I wouldn't be here. " She Scritched behind the brunettes flat ear, which tilted with curiosity.

"We were out hunting, since Angela said we had a shortage of food. It was 5 years ago, I was a bit of an idiot back then, so I led the mission into the west part of the whispering woods instead of the east, thinking we'd have more luck there. " Adora related her story and Catra mocked her about still being an idiot.

But the blonde's mood shifted after her brief laugh. "We ran into a set of boars, and the biggest one started running straight towards me. I tried firing at it but it just aggrivated it more. Before I knew it Swifty jumped in front of me and I heard a few loud barks

before a really loud yelp. While I trying to get up, I saw that the boar had run off in a random direction, and Swifty..... It all happened so fast..." Adora's voice cracked, she felt the tears brimming her eyes.

Catra tried putting the woman's head into her shoulder as her breathing shook, "h-he didn't make it... "

"I'm sorry. For calling him a mutt. "

Adora sniffled and held her close, accepting the apology nonetheless. "It was pretty fast for me too, Blondie. " She attempted to lighten the mood for her. But Adora was already gripping into her shirt, shaking.

"After that I just- worked myself to the bone, never slept. I didn't want to see it in my dreams. It hurt so much. It took me the past 5 years.... Maybe more... " She sniffled.

Adora pried herself from the feline and looked into her eyes needing g to change back the topic, " I know you cry for her birthdays, I know you try so hard to make her happy so she wouldn't have to grieve with you. But you have the both of us now. We love you, Catra. "

Even though she didn't question how b she knew, Catra felt new tears brimming at her eyes, so she dove into the blonde and hugged her tightly. As her tail wrapped around Adora's hips, she whispered, "thank you. " Then came the purring, telling the ex-commander that she was gonna be alright as long as they were together.

Catra popped a strawberry into her mouth.

"You still have more?! "

"Shhh, don't ruin it, dummy. " Adora laughed, rolling them both into the deepest hug ever.

She was gonna be okay.

Chapter 14

Chapter Summary

"Guess who just got their job back! "

Chapter Notes

I wanna torture you guys now hehehe
Sorry not sorry

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra woke up with a weight on her chest. Literally. Loose golden hair, sprawled across her arm and limbs intertwined with hers. She purred, wishing it could last forever. A groggy 'mornin kitten' made her thoughts come to a halt though. She smiled sweetly at the blonde with the sleepy gaze. Adora pressed a small kiss to Catra's nose and nuzzled into her fur, yawning.

A loud knock came from the door and Catra groaned, Adora giving a small chuckle and a peck to soothe her.

"In a minute! " Adora called as she got up to get a shirt. Catra covering her bare body in case she was within view from the door. Her tail swished impatiently.

"Oh uh hi Angela, why the early visit? " Adora fixed a few wrinkles in her shirt as she stood in the small opening of the door.

"Yes, sorry to be a bother but Bow has managed to sustain a minor injury and he wouldn't be able to hunt for a while. And since winter is upon us I was wondering if you would like your position back. At least temporarily. " Angela inquired politely and Adora took notice of the small drizzle of snow falling from the sky.

She's gonna need an extra coat for this.

Ohhh that explains why Catra seemed extra fluffy lately...

"Adora? "

"Oh sorry. Sure, I don't mind taking the hunt for a while. " Adora chuckled and Angela gave a nod, handing her, her old wing pin.

When the village leader left, Adora shut the door and turned to Catra with a beaming smile.

"Look who just got their job back! " Catra laughed and ran to kiss her.

~~

"You're going alone? " Catra asked.

"Yeah I usually go with Bow since he's basically qualified enough but... Yeah... How are you not freezing?! " Adora shivered in her winter hunting gear. The snow had starting falling heavier and now there was a blanket of mush on the ground. Catra wearing simple long sleeves clothes made no sense to her, especially since she had to wear **layers.**

"My winter coat came in, Adora. " Catra chuckled as a fluffy kitten bounded up to her. Wow she was extra fluffy.

"Adora looks like a ball. " Moon laughed and Adora rolled her eyes teasingly.

"I should come with you Adora. Please? " Catra tried. Obviously she was worried. Bears weren't gonna be a problem during winter but there are other things to still look out for. Adora searched the feline's pleading eyes and caved.

"Fine. Come on. We don't wanna be late. " Adora started to hear into the thick forestry and Catra gave Moon's head a ruffle before following behind with a 'don't cause havoc' on her tongue.

It wasn't long before they were messing around and teasing each other like children, almost for getting about the initial task at hand. Adora was in the middle of noogying Catra when the magical stopped, ears twitching and she looked around with an intensity and stepped with precision. Adora settled for staying put and waiting. At least until the feline went around a tree and a few bushes and she was forced to follow her instead.

"Hey, what is it? " Adora whispered as Catra crouched low and watched over the hill and into a clearing.

"Deer, good enough for the village right? " Adora smiled at this and gave Catra a kiss on her ear. "You are the best, Kitten~"

Pulling out a new thing Entrapta had sent for them, a rifle, Adora looked to Catra for a moment and clipped on the silencer. "You can still cover your ears if you want to, I heard this is pretty loud. "

"Wait- so your plan is to scare all the other deers but only get one? " Adora thought about it for a bit. The cold stinging her undercut, she should've cut this in spring ugh.

"We gotta test it at least. " Adora pouted, wanting to try it.

"Fineeee." Catra covered her ears tightly and Adora grinned, steadying her hand and making sure it was loaded before aiming at the biggest one.

pew (silenced bang *snickers*)

Adora made a second shot for good measure and squinted as the deer yelped and fell to the grass, all the other deer scampering away.

"I got it! " Adora started scrambling into the clearing, Catra fumbling to catch up. The deer was HUGE, they were trying to figure out how they'd carry it back, the bag they had was way to small as they looked at it.

"Maybe I can put it on my shoulders? " Adora wondered and Catra made a twisted expression.

"You. Carry *that*?! " Adora nodded not seeing the problem. Catra pinched her temple but froze.

"Adora. Don't. Move. " The blonde froze as well and gulped.

Great some wolves managed to track them. And even better they delivered two apitizers and a course meal of a month's worth.

Catra started growling lowly, and turnt towards the opposing predators. "Adora-" Catra was about to tell her to get out of here but Adora cut her off in a harsh whisper. "No. I'm not leaving you. " Great.

Catra went down to all fours, she guessed she had to stay close to Adora and ward off about 10 wolves while protecting her. Especially since there was no changing her mind at this point. Catra heard Adora tap her rifle at got the message. "You shoot, I'll get as much as I can. Just- don't shoot me. " Catra gulped as Adora took off the silencer. She definitely wanted some animals to get scared now.

Catra charged at the closest wolf in her range, they were already surrounded and their growls were terrifying. She managed to kill one when she heard Adora's shot ring out. Her ears were ringing now, she was right. It was LOUD.

When another wolf lunged at Catra aiming for her neck, she heard a shot and it fell limp on her. See glanced to Adora who had a determined look on her face. She was good at this shooting thing. But the blonde didn't notice the canine preparing to pounce at her, managing to knock the rifle out of her reach and corner her. To her dismay Catra was a bit occupied with about 3 more on

her end. She couldn't speak, she tried to call for Catra but her voice shook instead. The wolf leapt at her and she raised her arms and yelped in pain as sharp teeth pierced her arms and fought.

"ADORA!! " Catra called but had to knock away some more wolves. She felt tears chilling on her cheeks as she tried to block the wolf from getting to her, blood soaking through her clothes. Adora had to admit, she never came across savage wolves before. Usually, she'd see a small family and they'd leave her alone, these were definitely hungry and not from around here.

The presence of another wolf came up behind her and she tried grabbing for her rifle in agonizing pain. She managed to grab it but the wolves had latched themselves onto her pant leg and was tugging at her, she flipped herself over, stiffly cocked the gun and shot at them both.

Catra was down to her last wolf, she heard as Adora's gun cocked in the distance but didn't have time to look over as a wolf came pouncing at her. She managed to duck in time and cut straight through his belly, but he slattacked one more time before collapsing into a pool of crismoson snow, just like the other 7 she had dealt with. She panted as she looked for the last one.

There was a bang and a thump right behind her. She turned to see the last wolf, dead, shot through the head. When she looked to Adora, th e blonde looked angry, blood was soaking her sleeves and her clothes were ripped, a trickle of blood on her forehead. Her expression changed to a relieved huff, then brief pain before she dropped to her knees, the gun falling to the snow. Catra scrambled to her as she collapsed completely. She started panicking beyond hell. She started crying, begging for Adora to wake up. But she had fallen unconscious, Catra rolled her over onto her back hoping to-

Hoping to what?

She didn't even know! She just didn't want to lose someone else!

She ripped the sleeves on Adora's jacket carefully and tore off the entirety of both her sleeves and wrapped her girlfriend's arms tightly. She frantically looked around, but Catra couldn't find anyone, obviously! She whimpered and looked to the blonde, her skin was getting paler.

Catra looked at where she was and back to the blonde.

"I'll be right back okay? " she pressed her forehead to hers and give it a small kiss, just before bolting East as fast as she could possibly go.

~~

Magicats were beyond confused to see a blur of someone dashing directly through camp however.

"DAD! " Catra cried, tears streaming down her face as she said to a stop in the middle of town and yelled. She scrambled to her hut, to the 'palace' but he wasn't there. The last place she tried was the graveyard and she spotted him at her mother's grave. "Dad.... " Her voice cracked and she dropped to her knees panting.

"Catra?! " he got up and rushed to her tired body.

"It's..... Please... Help her.... The wolves-" she couldn't see, couldn't make sentences with the tears coming out of her eyes and the sob shaking at her core.

"Hide! " The orange Tabby appeared.

"Get as much soldiers as you can, Catra can lead us. We're going on a rescue mission stat!"

It wasn't long before about 15 adult male magicats were running behind Catra to the clearing where she left Adora. She was

exhausted, but she didn't want to risk another set of wolves reappearing by he girlfriend's defenseless body.

Hide immediately recognized the blonde woman and gave instructions to about 5 of them. He purposely didn't give Catra any work because of her state. He even gave out orders for the deer to be escorted back to BrightMoon and for someone to tell the Leader what had happened and not to worry. Moonshine was there she could've confirmed their authority for them as well.

Catra passed out as they were back at the healers, blood soaking her thigh from a deep scratch.

Adora...

Please...

Wake up...

Chapter End Notes

Cliffhanger!!
Idk, for some reason it's kinda hard writing angst again. I mean I can't write much without going into heavy gore and blood and someone dies.... Like my 'it's definitely worth it' AU. 😂

Also I love wolves so no I don't always like to view them as viscous monsters. T^T but I made an exception for this chapter.
I like how they're slowly modernizing with Entrapta's help, like making hunting easier and oh idk 😉 Catradora fun-times.

Chapter 15

Chapter Summary

Damn these inner demons

Chapter Notes

Mentions of self harm (sorry with angst comes inner demons and torture) I've done this before with an OC of mines, yes it's in my 'it's definitely worth it' book lol damn that book is an entire horror story when I think about it, nothing but pain. What was I thinking?....

Anyways-
Chipped Catra vibes!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

A sharp shooting pain pricked Catra's thigh as she held Adora's hand. She hissed and clenched her thigh out of reflex but made the pain worse. She was sitting next to where Adora's lay on a cotton bed, -

Like she's been doing for the past 3 days.

Catra squeezed the blonde's immobile hand for comfort as someone came to tend to her still healing injury. Her ears have all but been up right for the past few days. They were actually flat down, her tail wrapped around her ankles as she either stayed by her lover or went to visit a few graves. She kept feeling like it was her fault.

That's because it is.

shut up...

Oh but you know it's your fault.

IT'S NOT!

tsk tsk tsk, think about it, kitten~ If you didn't tag along, Adora here might've gone in a different direction instead of following <u>you.</u>

...

yes, if you hadn't sniffed NorthEast, she might've lived.

She's not dead-

yet.

Just shut up. You don't know what you're talking about. I just found a deer for her. I didn't cause this. She would've went there anyways.

You're as stupid as you look, you know? I don't see what she sees in you, you're just pathetic, you could barely hold off a few mangy wolves.

Fuck off!

look at her! YOU caused this!

Catra spared a glance at the blonde. Her breathing slow and calm as she slept through her healing. She whimpered and looked to her hands instead.

maybe your right... I steered her in that direction... If I stayed behind she might've went another way and-

Catra imagined Adora's grinning proudly as she met her at the edge of the woods, a large boar over her shoulders as she gave a smug grin. The feline felt a tear prick at her eyes and she wiped it away, her tail now in her other hand as she wrung it.

she would be awake, not like this...

i just wanted to protect her...

look where it got you. Where it got *her...*

Catra sniffled and got up, heading out of the hut and sitting by the door. She curled her tail around her ankles and buried her face in her knees.

i just want her to wake up!

This pathetic attitude isn't gonna make it faster is it?

Catra shook her head and sobbed, not bothering to look up when other magicats walked past her shaking frame.

It should've been you.

Catra whined and her voice cracked as she looked to the grey sky, soft snow covering the ground beneath her, she gripped at her fur and dug her toes into it. It was right. It shouldn't have been Adora...

she didn't deserve this...

hmmm, now where have I heard that before?...

**"AAAAARGH! " Catra yells shoving every bit of paper and items on her wooden table. Sobbing uncontrollably as she swiped at the wooden walls of her hut. Gashes now deep in them from her claws.*

*'She didn't deserve this! ' Catra was grief stricken, tears pooling on the floor as her body shook, her back against the wall**

Catra's claws unsheathed and she squeezed her eyes shut and held her head, her mane getting abused as she tried to shake her memories out of her head. Her pupils shrunk to pinpricks as she

panicked, running to the first place she could think of- and it just happened to be the place she was avoiding- her own home.

She panted, her eyes scanning and her ears pinned in fear. Fear of herself. Her demons. Her memories.

Everyone suffers because of you...

Catra knelt and sobbed in her living room, her knees forcing her to crawl to her sofa, tears dripping to the floor, even as she dragged the item away from the wall. She looked behind the spot at the dusty wall, deep gashes in the wall covering the space where the claws on her feet had kicked. She scrambled to remove the painting she hung above it, watching the gashes her hands did.

A flash of blood dripping from Adora's arms made her fall backwards, she sobbed, more tears falling to the floor boards. Her claws dug into the wood and she dashed to her room. Her breath fogging up her vision as she fumbled for something under her pillow. But couldn't find it. Catra pressed her back to her wall and scraped at her fur and her head, droplets of blood leaking through her fur, as she sobbed loudly. Chunks of her mane dropping next to her as she just, yanked her demons out.

pathetic...

their sick voice echoed in her mind.

It was all. Your. Fault.

She was weak.... All she could do was surrender. She was at her lowest and everything was true. Because of her she led Adora into a wolf ambush, because of her Silver was gone. She wasn't strong enough to push past her own grief.

Why did they even stick around someone like her?...why did they even love her?

Catra's sobs shook her body as her tail curled around herself and she curled towards the wall in the dark, her eyes lighting up the cold ground.

You're just a wild animal!

Chapter End Notes

Not me feeling to cry writing this.
Why do I torture myself with angst? It's for the people! The peopleeeee!

Chapter 16

Chapter Summary

"Catra? "

Chapter Notes

Had a dream and just had to. Even though it wasn't dark, I wanted to stray a bit from the actual thing *wink wink*

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora was bound to something. Strange red veins branching around her bare shoulders and her face. She almost wasn't even Adora- anymore. Instead of her usual grey-blue eyes, they were blood red and feral. Catra probably should be scared but, she wasn't. For some reason, she wasn't. Adora gave a gutteral shout and tugged at her restraints but couldn't break free. It was like she was begging, pleading for something- anything.

Catra gave a disappointed gaze and grazed her claw against flushed skin.

"Tsk tsk tsk, you're being a bad girl you know? "

Adora sobbed, tugging even more. She couldn't take it.

"Catra please..... Stop. "

Stop? But why? Catra wore a look of confusion and she hastily looked to her hands to make sure she hadn't hurt her lover. Only to see blood on her hands. Her pupils shrunk and she gasped in alarm.

Catra backed up and hit her head on a desk, immediately waking herself up in the process as she heaved.

Another nightmare.

What she kept hoping was just her life wanting to have the blonde awake and in her arms again, always turned into some twisted nightmare. Catra shuddered and went to her bathroom. Looking at herself in the mirror she couldn't recognize herself anymore. She had lost weight, looked sleep deprived, had cut her hair to a pixie and just looked terrible.

She didn't want to go outside like this. But she's been avoiding Adora's room all week. It hurt to see her still asleep and unmoving. It scared her.

This time however she decided she was gonna suck it up and go to the blonde. And she did just that, her hand shaking as she sat and refused to look at her. Catra sighed, nurses sparing concerned glances at her own weak frame.

She didn't want it to be all awkward, her insides churned at the realization. What was it she saw other people doing? Talking? Maybe she can try that...

"Hey Adora. I'm... I'm sorry I never came to see you. I was just-" She laced her fingers with the blonde's. "Scared... " Her voiced dropped to a whisper. "I miss you, so much. I can't eat, I can't sleep in peace- I just want you back. " Catra felt her eyes burn so she squeezed them shut, gripping Adora's fingers.

"Please... Don't- don't leave me... Just stay. I-i love you more than anything, I'd do anything to hear your voice again. Anything. " Catra sniffled, resting her head onto the cot and curling her tail around herself.

"Please... *sniff* wake up, Adora, please. " She begged, her eyes puffy. Surprisingly her eyes created tears even though she barely stopped crying for days. She just wanted Adora back.

...

Everything was quiet, just a reminder that Adora wasn't awake and she was alone.

At least until she felt a grip around her hands, her head shot up so quickly it almost fell off her neck.

"Catra....? " A hoarse voice cracked, as grey-blue eyes struggled to reopen fully. Adora's lungs filled as she woke up, her head struggling to turn to the magicat.

"Adora? " Catra sobbed and leapt at the blonde, burying her face into her neck. Adora's hands wrapping around her almost instantly as she tried to hold back her own tears to no avail.

"Catra... " Adora sobbed as some nurses came around to inspect the commotion. Reporting to several others that the blonde one was awake.

"You're such a stubborn- *sniff* heroic, idiot! " Catra held her closer, slightly chuckling and reffering to the fact that Adora refused to leave her to fight the wolves. Adora chuckled and cleared her throat, "I know... I know! " She sobbed into the Magicat's pinned ears. Then she gasped and pulled back, "You cut your mane?! "

"Uh.. Yeah. It's been a rough few weeks. " Catra looked away, sitting on Adora's hips.

"W-weeks?... " Adora's eyes widened and she looked around, trying desperately to lubricate her throat. Until another magicat woman came to her with a cup of water. After about 2 seconds she pulled back from the cup wiping her mouth and asked for some more. As the lady left, her eyes trained on Catra, noticing the physical changes that occurred... And even hints of the mental ones.

"You okay? " Adora asked, putting a bandaged hand to Catra's cheek, and feeling a tear slip down it. She frowned as Catra shook her head and her face twisted in emotional pain. Catra leapt at her and started sobbing again.

"I thought you were never going to wake up... " She confessed and Adora hugged her tightly.

"I don't even know if this is real... " Adora's brow pinched, "it's all real, I'm right here. I'm here. " She rubbed her lover's back trying to comfort her, seeing her water returning. She held the cup in one hand and held Catra with the other, downing the liquid in one gulp and giving a thankful nod to the healer.

After a few minutes Adora managed to get Catra to calm down and the feline explained what happened after she passed out. But could pick up on the fact that Catra was hiding some details from her as she kept seeing her rubbing at her arms.

"Catra can I see your arms? " Catra's ears flicked and her eyes zeroed on nothing as she swallowed. Avoiding the blonde gaze and pretending she didn't hear her.

"Catra." Adora said sternly and Catra felt like a kicked kitten. Gingerly extending her arms to her lover. Adora looked them over and parted the fur, gasping upon seeing claw marks.

"Catra who did this to you? " She made a sound similar to a growl. The brunette avoided her gaze even more, stayin silent and almost afraid. Adora rubbed the girl's wrists, hoping to calm the both of them.

".... Promise you won't get mad? "

"Wha-"

"Promise."

Adora took a breath, "I promise. " Catra took a deep breath before she spoke, "I did. "

Adora's eyes widened in shock and she looked to the small wrists again. Healing cuts, some fresh ones, who knows how much old ones that had time to heal already. All she could do was wrap her arms around the feline.

"I'm sorry... " She whispered and Catra sputtered and pushed her away.

"*you're* sorry? For what?! It was my fault you were in this mess in the first place. "

Adora looked at her incredulously, "what? Your fault? -"

"I shouldn't have went with you! It's my nose that got us to go in that direction! " Catra started to tear up again and Adora reached for her face, rubbing circles with her thumb on the small Tufts of fur at her jaw.

"Catra, it was *never* your fault. Didn't you see we were going in that direction anyway? Do.... Do you know what could've happened if you weren't there...?" Adora's voice trailed off and Catra's eyes widened. She pressed their foreheads together.

"I never would've come home to you. Because of *you* I'm here right now. ***Alive***. " Catra sniffled and kissed the blonde. Oh how she missed those comforting words and her voice. She missed it so much. Tears found its way trickling down her face as Adora relaxed into the kiss with a satisfied hum. Her ears slowly rising back to it's long overdue position. Giving a final nip to Adora's soft lips, Catra pulled away and smiled up at her.

"I missed you so much. " A purr stuttered to life as she nuzzled into the blonde.

"Pfft, it's gonna take more than a few wolves to get rid of me. " Adora snickered and Catra's ears drooped slightly with worry.

"I'm kidding, kitten, I'm kidding. " She gave her a soft kiss and hugged her close.

"I'm not going anywhere. I promise. " Catra closed her eyes and purred.

"You're such an idiot. "

"Pfft, you're one to talk, begging me to wake up was low, even for you." Adora made a smug shit-eating grin and Catra shoved her away, folding her arms.

"Go back into a coma dumbass, I hate you. " Adora laid back down in her giggles, snorting as Catra spared a glance at her and smirked lovingly.

Chapter End Notes

My babies back together again *sniff* time for some magicat village montages.

Chapter 17

Chapter Summary

Bc someone mentioned it, I decided to do it. What about Moonshine?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The striped kitten sat on Glimmer's lap, her momma wasn't back yet, neither was Adora.... She knew something was wrong.

"Does this usually be so long? " Moon complained and Glimmer chuckled.

"Yes, sometimes longer. But I wouldn't be surprised if they got up to something in the mean time." Glimmer chuckled looking to Bow who had a bandage around his shoulder. He shook his head and facepalmed at her comment. But before Moon could ask a few magicat footsteps caught her attention. She knew based on the fact that a tail dragged on the ground. Only one magicat she knew dragged his tail because it was too long. Yes, his name was SnowLeopard.

Moonshine's sudden attention-snap to the snow covered woods made Glimmer and Bow look into that direction. Putting the kitten onto her shoulders, Glimmer caught sight of a white and black patterned person, leading 4 other cat-like folks, carrying a huge deer. She looked to Bow who struggled to shrug and they hesitantly approached the visitors.

"Sorry to intrude, miss but we have news for your mother. " I mean- not like no one didn't know who Glimmer was. She's the daughter of the Leader here, duh. "Who's asking? " Glimmer narrowed her eyes at the feline.

"Oh, Glimmer this is SnowLeopard. I know him! " Moonshine dropped her head in front of the woman's, and was now looking at her upside down.

"Really? " She fixed the kitten before she could potentially fall over.

"Yeah, Snow works for my grandpa! " Glimmer still arched a brow at him. He held himself up as though one of royalty. Probably since he spent so much time around a chief.

"What's with the deer though? "

"That's what we're here to discuss Ma'am. " His ear dropped slightly as he spoke and Moonshine looked at him with suspicion.

As Glimmer proceeded to lead them towards the main house, Moonshine glanced back towards the woods.

~~

"Are you sure? " Angela paced the room.

"Affirmative Ma'am. " SnowLeopard stood at attention, hands behind his back and his chest puffed out in respect. "Mr. Oak advises you not to worry. We have the best healers in the camp at the ready, they are being treated as we speak." Moonshine sniffled, hiding her face in Glimmer's leg as the sparkly woman stood nearby to the conversation. Glimmer rubbed behind the kit's ears to comfort her.

Angela paced some more, her breath shaking with worry.

"How long till they can return? " She looked to the magicat. He shook his head, "uncertain. The blonde one was unconscious when we got to her. "

Angela sat on her chair and shut her eyes, trying to think straight. She loved Adora's like her own daughter. Technically she was, she took care of the blonde her whole life. Adora loved Catra and that made her family as well. Hearing news such as this made her scared, especially since she lost her own husband in a similar situation.

"Okay, I hope to see their return. Thank you for coming to me and for bringing back their catch. " Snow nodded as he was dismissed.

~~

"Hey Glimmer? You awake? " Moonshine whispered and Glimmer nodded. The kitten slipping herself into waiting arms, then snuggling into the warmth.

"Do you miss them?... " Moon asked and Glimmer didn't answer.

"Yeah... I do, a lot. " Glimmer sighed and hugged the kitten closer. It's been almost weeks and they still haven't got any word about the duo's return yet.

Moonshine could feel her sadness, and wanted to change the topic a little.

"Hehe, how do you feel about being my aunt huh? " Moon giggled. Glimmer messed up the kitten's hair. "Means I get to call you my niece huh? You little trouble maker. I didn't think you'd sneak into the kitchens for cookies like that! " They giggled together and Moonshine playfully pushed away as tickles came her way.

Glimmer pulled back and looked at Moon with a sentimental look in her eye as Moonshine came down from her laughing fit.

"You're like her in so many ways y'know... " Glimmer smiled sadly and hugged the feline. Moon gasped and buried herself into the hug. Tears slipping out of the both of their eyes silently.

For a sister...

And for a mother...

Chapter End Notes

I really need to stop getting emotional about my own stories ugh

Chapter 18

Chapter Summary

Let's say Adora's tired of sleeping, she's had enough.

Chapter Notes

I am surprised that I haven't put as much smut into this as compared to the amount I usually do, like one every two chapters bc these bishes horny. And instead I put them like behind the scenes. What is wrong with me?!

Omg I gotta make this as kinky as possible to make up for it!
Lemme hope I can make up for it...
Omg it's a long one sry lol

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Meanwhile.....

Catra's eyes fluttered open as the night air raised her thick fur. Adora still idly tracing relaxing patterns into her shoulder. Catra hadn't let go of the blonde since she woke up, but Adora's didn't seem to want to sleep either. Catra's ear fluttered and she yawned, "Adora? " Bored eyes turned to her and Adora hummed in acknowledgement. "You okay? " She asked the feline quietly. Catra chuckled and nuzzled into her shoulder and tugged at her. She was still in a slouched sitting position and staring into nothing in particular. Adora complied with Catra's tugging and laid down fully, turning on her side and looking into the glow of the feline's irises.

"I'm supposed to be asking you that dummy. " Catra smirked.

"Yeah, I'm just.... Tired. "

"Then sleep. " Catra traced the back of her finger along Adora's cheek, a hand coming up to squeeze hers.

"No, I'm tired of sleeping. I slept for a long time I don't wanna go back to sleep again. " Adora closed her eyes and sighed. "But you should go back to sleep though, you need it. " Adora curled her hand around Catra's head and rubbed at her ears, smiling as a purr came forth. She was right, the night mares had kept her awake. Catra yawned. While she loved the fact that nightmares weren't gonna plague her anymore because Adora was awake and okay, she wanted the woman to *remain* okay, and that meant sleeping.

Maybe where they were wasn't comfortable enough? Back at her hut she had soft sheets and pillows.

Catra stretched and groaned as she sat up.

"Come on, we're moving. " She claimed and Adora raised an eyebrow in confusion.

"What- why? Where? " Catra looked to Adora's stash of clothes on a nearby table, folded neatly despite the tears in the thick fabric coat and the bite in her boots. She didn't want her to get frostbite out there...

Catra hopped off the cot and gathered the coat throwing it at Adora.

"Catra where are we going? "

"My place. Your boots are no good anymore and I don't want you to freeze on the way there."

"My boots-"

"Just wrap yourself up good. " Catra got a cup of water and drank it, she needed to be awake for this. She got on the ground and fully stretched her spine as Adora tried to wrap herself up in her jacket, mostly without question.

"How far do you live? "

"Not.... Far. " Catra stretched like a cat and her tail lashed, Adora staring a bit.

"Are you sure I can leave? " Adora asked as Catra came to her. "They took the bandages off, and your arm seems fine, so nothing's stopping you. "

"Except for the small shake it does. " Adora looked down sadly.

"Your muscle got torn Adora, it's gonna take time to get it's strength back after it healed. " Catra pressed a kiss to her forehead and went to the entrance of the hut, gathering a coat for herself.

"Come on, let's go. "

"Catra, I got no shoes. I can't walk on snow! " Adora fretted and stepped on the cold ground with her socks.

Catra rolled her eyes and waited for Adora to get closer to her before scooping her up into her arms. A small surprised yelp coming from the blonde. Yes, she's still got it!

What? She was totally guessing here!

"Hang tight. " Catra ordered and Adora nodded. Catra kicked the door open and a gush of cold wind blew in at them. Adora closed her eyes and gripped at Catra's fur, trying to grasp at some more warmth.

It wasn't long before they came in view of Catra's home, small, a bit unused and well, totally looked Catra-ish. Adora didn't know how to describe the overall vibe of it when she got carried in to say the least. As Catra closed the door behind them, she was put down, and she looked around the place.

Catra forgot she left the place in a mess honestly. She grimaced when she saw Adora looking around and paused on the wall in

front of them, formerly stripped of its covering and the sofa shoved to a corner. Catra walked off to her room, attempting to avoid any questions as Adora stared.

Adora however, held her wrist to stop her.

"Did you... " she couldn't finish her sentence.

"..... Not for you.... " Catra's voice shook. Instead she pleaded, "please, can we go. " Adora looked to her and swallowed, sighing and nodding. "Yeah. Let's. " Adora followed her into her room and saw small red stains in the corner and little pieces of hair. Not much though, she managed to clean the most of it. "Catra... " If she had ears they would be pinned down so hard at that moment.

Catra shook her head and just kissed her, to Adora's surprise. Trying to block out any questions she had, any concerns.

"I'm here, Adora. I'm okay, I'm fine. " Catra pulled back pressing their foreheads together and whispering. Adora still wanted to know but, she decided not to push any further for fear of Catra pushing her away. Adora's hand wandered and Catra purred as it trailed down her sides,

"Hey Adora, are you sure you don't want to go to sleep? " Catra smirked, looking through lidded eyes to look up at the blonde.

"I never want to sleep again. " Adora chuckled and leaned closer.

"Well.... I got an idea we can occupy our time with~" Catra purred and Adora smirked. "Just shut up and kiss me Catra. " Catra launched herself at Adora, locking their lips in a deep kiss. They haven't done this in weeks and for them, it was way too long. As their breaths puffed between them, Adora pushed Catra over to the soft mattress, supporting herself over the feline as she continued to basically swallow her tongue.

Catra moaned into Adora's mouth, the sudden increase in pressure of Adora's tongue against hers, making her mind swim.

Adora's clothed hips met Catra's and she bucked on instinct, causing the magicat to gasp and separate the kiss.

"You know, I really wish we had our little.. Toy~" Adora smirked as she leaned towards Catra's neck, kissing and sucking where she can; the brunette squirming under the attention. "Maybe we don't need it. What do you think.....Kitten? ~" Adora let out a satisfied smirk as Catra whined, trying to grind her hips against hers. She almost felt sorry for the feline, but, she missed this, so yeah, she wasn't gonna give in so easily.

Trailing a hand down Catra's sides, she tugged at Catra's shirt. Earning a brief nod as she helped her remove it. Lips immediately made contact with sensitive skin and Catra made a shaky moan, her hands going to Adora's hair. Catra wrapped her legs around Adora's hips and started grinding, despite the fact that they just started, she was getting desperate and Adora could feel how wet she was getting. The blonde hunter groaned as her undershirt rode up her abs, resulting in Catra's hips to grind onto her skin. The damp spot on her lover's clothes easy to feel.

"Adora, come on!... I want more... " Catra whined. Adora simply joined their lips together, both to shut her but and to distract her from what was coming next.

Catra's moans got muffled by Adora's mouth as she felt 2 thick digits slip under her pants and rub against her clit. "You're so wet for me, Kitten~" Adora whispered against her lips, joining them back together as she felt more of the magicat's warm slick coat her fingers. Catra purred, her breath equally stuttering as Adora proceeded to torture her clit with slow, soft circles. Her claws extended and she gripped blonde hair, trying hard not to pierce skin, but also trying to give her the message.

Adora groaned feeling Catra's hands gripping onto her, so she gave her some mercy. Slipping a finger into her quivering folds. Catra pulled back from the kiss and arched into the blonde. Her breast leaning into a now waiting hand, of which started to tug and roll her nipple as soon as it made contact.

"A-Adora.... " Catra moaned. Her legs parting further and her tail lashing on the bed. She could barely think straight with the way Adora was pumping into her and occasionally coating her clit with her juices, twirling it between her fingers before going back in and pumping.

"Ahn.... Ah... Ador-" Catra felt Adora's fingers push at her G-spot and she rolled her head back, her neck now exposed to the blonde's lips. ".. Such a good girl~... Such a good girl for me~" Catra's hips jerked into Adora's pumps, coaxing the blonde to put in the second finger. The second stretch making her moans overlap with purrs underneath them. Furry hips rocking in time with Adora's thrusts. Catra's pants growing short and her moans getting higher in pitch.

Adora smirked and stopped everything she was doing, Catra whimpering with the lost of stimulation.

"Adoraaaaa..... " she complained and Adora shucked the remaining clothes off of them both.

"Turn over. " Adora ordered and Catra blushed. Her ears tinting as she followed the blonde's orders. Adora lifted the feline's hips, noticing how much her slick shone in the dim lit room, and how it had started dripping while she stalled. Adora leaned close, pressing Catra's ass to her hips and leaned forward to whisper in Catra's ear.

"You like being such a filthy little kitten don't you? ~" Catra bucked backwards and she whined loudly, making Adora chuckle. Her hands parting her fur and gripping, teasing her endlessly. Catra's claws sliced into the mattress, Adora really needed to stop teasing or she was gonna lose it!

"Relax kitten, " Adora unexpectedly grabbed at Catra's hair and tugged her backwards, "or I'll leave you begging me to stop. " Catra whimpered, her face burning crimson, and her ears pinning. She felt her walls clench around nothing at the sudden aggression from the blonde, and she loved it.

Adora wasted no time reinserting her 2 fingers into the feline, both digits basically getting sucked back in and she smirked into Catra's neck, leaning her back over and keeping her hand fisted into her brown mane.

Catra moaned loudly as a third finger got pushed into her, her legs shook as she tried to hold herself up with Adora thrusting into her at a harder but jaw loosening pace. "You like that don't you? You like when I bend you over and pound into you like an animal. ~" Adora growled into Catra's ear, tugging her head back and marking her neck. Catra yowled at that, pressing her own chest to the mattress and fixing her ass high in the air at a better angle. Adora's eyes widened briefly her motions stilling as she basically watched Catra present for her.

Adora internally gasped, the book.

Magicats have a mating gland on their neck. They usually bite those to claim their partners. it is a common place of pleasure found right by the edge of the jaw, under the ear.

Where had she just sucked and spoken....

Right there....

Adora's eyes widened and she made something similar to a growl as the thrusted harder, her forearm on a bit of strain but she ignored it. The lewd wet sounds driving her at an almost desperate pace.

"Ohhh that's it...that's it, Princess. Fuckingggg *destroy* me~"

Catra let her touch that gland, and now that she thought about it, she got to touch it more than once. Catra trusted her, Catra *wants* her to claim her. Catra wants her. Loves her.

"ADORA....I'M-I'M- FuuuCK!!" Catra's claws unsheathed and she squeezed her eyes shut, her tail wrapping around Adora's wrist as she arched downward and spasmed, coating Adora's hand in white cum.

Adora panted, falling beside the limp feline and looking at how sweaty and messed up *she* made Catra. The magicat clung to the blonde's flushed skin, a tired and shaking hand coming up to wrap around her, while Adora licked her other hand clean in the mean time. When her hand was clean however, she got curious.

"Hey, Catra? " A hum that she wasn't asleep yet. "When do I.... Get to mark you? " Catra's eyes shot open and her ear flattened in embarrassment.

"You noticed?.... " Catra whispered and Adora nodded, "that book does wonders haha! " Catra chuckled at Adora's comment.

Catra thought for a little remembering the small mark on her other shoulder. She leaned closer into Adora's nape and nuzzled into it. Scenting her.

"Well.... Do you love me? " She asked nervously. A soft smile radiated off of Adora's lips and she hugged Catra closer. If that was even possible.

"More than anything. " She returned the nuzzling geasture and Catra purred softly, but noticeable.

"Can I? " Catra asked, her voice a whisper. If Adora didn't want this right now she was willing to wait. Besides, she loved her and she couldn't stand waiting longer anyways.

"N-now? " Adora pulled back to look at her.

"You don't have to if you don't want to-"

"Okay, go ahead. " The sudden answer made Catra's eyes widen.

"Are you sure? " Adora nodded and joined their foreheads together, "I... Trust you, Catra. I love you. If this is a way I can... Pretty much *wear* it, show it. I'd do it in a heartbeat. " Catra's purred grew in volume as she finished, and she rewarded the blonde with the sweetest kiss she could muster. Catra positioned herself at Adora's nape and took a deep breath.

"Hold onto me, if it's too much okay? " Adora nodded and wrapped her arms around Catra's back. Usually things like this was done during actual sex so it won't seem to hurt as much but since it was after, she had to build Adora up a bit again.

Starting by trailing her tail up between Adora's thighs and flicking it at her core, the blonde gasped but trusted Catra knew what she was doing. Continuing to flick her tail over Adora's clit and leaving feather light kisses on the spot she was aiming at on her neck. As Adora's breaths came in heavy, Catra rubbed circles on her shoulders with her thumbs, relaxing her.

"This might pinch a little, princess. Relax for me. ~"

Adora's voice cracked when she was about to tell Catra what her tail was doing to her. But she arched and whimpered as the feline spoke. "Almost there, baby. Just a little further. " Catra started applying pressure to the sensitive bud she kept tickling. Adora moaned loudly, right at the edge. It just took Catra's claws pricking at her sides for her to come, Catra immediately biting down as Adora screamed her name. Her body shuddering from the new feeling in her neck all the same. A second orgasm rocking her body seconds later. Her hands gripping onto her fur.

Lapping up a few droplets of blood from Adora's skin, Catra extracted her fangs from her nape. A brand new ring of her teeth on her lover's skin. Adora fell limp trying to catch her breath, but winced a little at the scar on her shoulder. Catra proceeded to lick the wound with her Kitten-licks, cleaning it and purring.

Adora feeling bold, asked Catra for her turn. The feline rolled her eyes but let her try nonetheless without all the build up. She had to admit, Adora didn't do a half bad job. She grit her teeth as Adora bit down on her nape with a strength she didn't know she had in that jaw. Catra sighed as Adora released her, but almost teared up when she felt tiny licks at her new scar. It wasn't as deep as a magicat would've done, it, might heal over soon too, but it did bleed a little.

"Pfft, you taste nice. I'mma eat you up. " Adora teased and Catra laughed, rolling her eyes playfully as the blonde yawned.

Catra then wrapped herself into Adora's arms and purred, chuckling when she heard Adora snoring as the sun rose. "Thought you were never sleeping again, princess? " Catra yawned, scenting Adora's mark as she smiled in her sleep.

Chapter End Notes

Am I forgiven?

Chapter 19

Chapter Summary

Unexpected visits.

Chapter Notes

Hmm, I knew I should've done this yesterday but here's a chapter for Pride Month!
Currently obsessing over a cosplayer, but she's in college and idk if I wanna be her or date her c damnnn I wanna get to know her but yeah... Tiny 17 over here.
I'm single and obsessed halp!

Catra was currently excitedly dragging Adora around her village. She had managed to get Adora some better clothes and nothing was stopping them from exploring together. Making memories.

"Adora come on! " Catra grinned impatiently at the entrance to one of her favorite cooks. Yeah magicats ate cooked things too, they weren't monsters. Adora chuckled, as she panted, finally catching up, her hands on her knees and frost exiting her mouth. "I'm here.... I'm here... " she huffed.

"Also....you so cheated. " Catra rolled her eyes, "it was barely a fair race Adora. But. A bet is a bet. "

She came up to the blonde and smirked, jabbing a finger at her chest, "you owe me~"

"Fine. Is this the place you picked? " Adora stood straight and looked at the exterior of the place. Big hut with a chimney, the aroma of freshly cooked meats drafting through the air.

"Woah... " Adora gasped and Catra smiled, "told you! " Catra grabbed her hand and dragged her inside, the duo giggling. As they sat at the stools a large magicat came to Catra an smiled,

"Catra! I haven't seen my favorite customer here in ages! " He let out a hearty laugh and Adora watched the interaction play out.

"I don't know Tom, have you seen her? "

"She can't be too far! " He laughed and leaned on the table, showing his gold fang. The tear in his ear visible now that he leaned into the light.

"Maybe two of your specials might jog my memory. " Catra glanced at Adora, still smiling. Tom chuckled, his cheery orange eyes twinkling.

"Anything for you Princess. "

As Tom left Adora smirked smugly. "He calls you princess.. "

"Repeat what happened here and I'll send you back into those woods alone! " Catra playfully shoved her.

"You guys are so tight-knit, how's that? "

"He's a friend of my dad's. Besides I've always loved his cooking since I was a kit. No need to let old habits die. " Catra smirked at the blonde.

Their food arrived not too long after, "Two of the best roast deers for the princess and her lady. " he mocked a bow and they tossed playful banter at each other once more before he left to tend to others.

Catra literally waited for Adora to take the first bite. And that first bite they'll both treasure forever. Adora had the brightest stars in her eyes and Catra almost reflected them back at her upon seeing her this happy. She was more than happy her girlfriend loved her favorite food.

"Hey, this is awesome!! " Adora spoke while chewing and Catra scolded her for it. Adora chuckled at her.

"Hey... How did he know? " Adora swallowed and looked at her softly yet curious as to how fast word travels in this new place. Catra smirked and leaned close to the blonde.

"He can smell it, Adora. The mark. " Catra saw the way the tint on Adora's cheeks spread all the way down to her thickly covered chest. She stuttered, "oh right... I-I forgot you guys can do that.. "

Catra leaned closer and nuzzled her cheek into Adora's neck and purred, Adora attempting to do the same in turn.

After they finished their meals, Tom came back with an ever present smile on his face, "So, how was it? "

"Amazing as always, Tom! I must say I missed it a lot. " Catra replied and turned to Adora, tilting her head to the magic at almost encouraging her to speak.

"Uh... I'll admit, it was the best I've ever tasted, thank you sir. "

"Oh please! Call me Tom! "Sir" pfft who uses those anymore huh? " Tom came around and pulled Adora into a headlock, laughing. Adora was caught off guard, but seeing the way Catra's pupils blew wide told her all was okay.

"Besides, my best customer AND her mate are always welcomed here. Hey, you play Rugby newbie? "

Adora's eyes widened, "uh... A little.. When I was a teen. Haven't in a while though. Just been hunting for the village since. " Tom seemed to tense at the hunter part but relaxed upon further understanding. He finally let go, but a smile still graced his lips, "well, maybe we should play some day! I'm ready to see what Catra fished out this time. Silver was really good at her music, I'll give you that. This magicat sure knows how to pick out the right ones! " He ruffled Catra's head and she giggled.

"Maybe some day, Tom. Do you got the bill with you? "

"Oh come now, don't be like that. Just because it was your girl's first try at my cooking I'll give it to you guys on the house, free of charge! " Adora stared in disbelief. Wow.

"Oh wow thanks dude. "

"Don't mention it! Now go! Go! I'm sure you guys are gonna be busy today! " He shooed them away and Catra laughed her squeaky laugh.

"It's not like that, Tom! " He winked at the comment.

"Never know with a smitten couple like you two! " He laughed once more as they left.

"He is like so awesome! " Adora smiled.

"Because you got away with your bet. You didn't have to pay a cent for it! " Catra shoved the blonde and she stuck her tongue out, ruffling Catra's ears in response.

"Hey why did he get so tense when I said that I hunt? "

Catra hesitated a little before responding, "Adora, a lot of us don't know hunting the way you do. " Adora raised a brow as they walked side by side. Catra sighed.

"Look, sometimes.... Magicats, we get hunted. By some stupid idiots who can't see that we're basically *people!* But it's rare to come across those people now a days, since hunting us became illegal, buuuut we still hear that other tribes get the invasions every blue moon, so to speak. " Adora looked at the people around them. Like really looked at them.

When they passed, a woman had hidden her kid subtly. It made her swallow thickly. Do they know she's a hunter somehow?

"Catra? Does everyone know? "

"They most likely saw your gun when we brought you back, the town's small, what's one person's business is everyone's. It keeps us all safe. " Catra's ear drooped a little as she looked around too.

Adora had a new question blooming in her mind, "were you....afraid of me when we shot you by accident? "

Catra nodded but held the blonde's hand to reassure her.

"If you hadn't shot me that day... We never would've met. " Catra glanced at Adora, purring and giving her hand a calming squeeze.

Adora stopped walking and pressed their foreheads together and closed her eyes, Catra automatically doing the same. It was instinct to her now. This simple gesture.

"You're okay thought, right? Nothing hurts? " Adora whispered worryingly.

"No, everything's okay, Princess. I promise. " Catra purred wrapping her arms around the blonde and nuzzling into the mark she gave her. Adora returning the hug tightly.

Catra's ear clicked, "*i still don't trust them. They're a hunter. Did you see that weapon?! "* Catra growled upon hearing other magicat's whispers. Adora probably sending something was wrong and comforting her, "hey don't listen to them, I love you, I would never hurt you. " Adora had probably caught some whispers near by and predicted that it's what she had heard. Judging by her defensive nature of course.

Catra purred but her ear clicked with another sound and she reluctantly pulled away from the comforting hug. She scanned the nearby bushes, which rustled so she got in front of Adora, a growl on her tongue. The blonde getting worried at the sudden change.

A tiny blonde flurry came out of the bushes and Catra's growl immediately stopped.

"Moonshine? "

"Mama! " The kit leapt into Catra's arms and nuzzled into her, tears seeping out of her eyes.

"Seems like someone missed you, Cat. " Adora ruffled at Moon's pony tail, the kitten purring.

"Jeez Moonshine, I told you to wait up! " Another familiar voice came through.

"Glimmer?! " Adora ran to hug the pinkette before she could even process who was hugging her. Her sister soon embracing her, as well as Bow who seemed to have tagged along.

"What are you guys doing here? " Adora asked as she backed up, Catra still holding Moon, who seemed to never want to let her mother go ever again. Might as well glue her there.

"Moonshine insisted she wanted to find you guys. Of course we weren't letting her go alone. So we tagged along. " Bow said, his hand unwrapped from his now healed injury, a pink scar on his bicep, seemingly a close encounter with stupid hogs. Those menaces.

"You guys have got to be careful too you know, a magicat kitten, could go unseen, you guys stand out like a bright pretty unicorn who thinks he's too fabulous to blend in. " Weirdly specific, but Cara had a point. Adora remembered what the feline had told her earlier and nodded. If the hunters were really out there no wonder they kept themselves so hidden. Even *Adora* thought they were just a myth at first.

Adora's attention snapped to a click behind Glimmer, and a chuckle, "Yeah, you guys are really terrible at being stealthy. But I must say, thank you for leading us here. "

Glimmer froze, almost just like everyone else did. Adora's mind was reeling as she tried to figure out where they got the gun. Only Entrapta made that for her. Unless someone else-

"Now, where were we...? " Adora managed to catch a glimpse of a red veil over the person's face, the person had a deep voice, but most likely a woman, it was filled with venom as she spoke, ordering someone else to tie them up and secure the magicats with specific stuff. Moonshine threw a soft whimper at Catra and the magicat's ears pinned, her pupils almost completely gone in fear. Adora swallowed nervously, she couldn't do anything or her sister would be dead in a heartbeat. She bowed her head in defeat; she'd have to think of something once they were all safe.

Shit, they were screwed

Chapter 20

Chapter Notes

Oh no, drama.
Also just to clarify, they were at the edge of the Village when the last event took place so only a few magicats got caught.

Things gonna get angsty again boo

Adora groaned as she sat up, her hands bound painfully behind her. Everything was black but there seemed to be a little light filtering through. That's when Adora realized she had a bag over her head and she could hear a the winnying of horses, whatever she was sitting in, jerking a little as they got carried through snow.

Adora heard the familiar, dreaded voice of the woman speaking up front with her partner, yet she dared to make sure her friends we're safe. If they're even with her to be honest. Adora felt a familiar gesture, a magicat tail wrapping around her ankle.

Catra.

It's almost as if Catra had read her mind, knowing she was gonna speak. A squeeze following the continued silence. Adora sighed, turning to where she believed the feline was sitting, and laid her head on a shoulder, the person doing the same.

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Several people came to the captives, taking the items off their heads and pushing them in separate directions. Adora immediately catching sight of Catra and calling out to her. The feline was wearing a muzzle and looked bruised, tears staining her cheeks.

"Catra! What're you gonna do to her?! " Adora growled at the guy pushing her away from her lover. The woman in the red veil came

to them, her hands held behind her back. She wore a blood red tunic and a black and white, striped cloak. Adora's eyes widening in horror when she realized what it was made of.

"Hmm, you're a feisty one, just like the older magicat." Sickly eyes looked over Adora's frame. The woman smiled deviously, "you can be a valuable asset to us. "

"Why would I ever want to do that?! "

"Oh, dear you won't have a choice. " A pale hand gestured to the guy behind her, "send her to camp, I think she'll fit in soon enough. "

"Yes, Shadow Weaver. " His monotone voice confirmed and Adora felt a jab to her back, forcing her to walk. She strained her neck to look back at Catra, the magicat struggling to fight off anyone who came near her or her kitten. Shadow Weaver, coming up to them and grabbing Catra by her short hair, before slapping her. Causing the feline to fall to the ground and Moonshine to cry. Adora gasped as she was shoved to keep walking, her boots crunching into the snow as she lowered her head and tears ran down her cheek.

As Adora had started worrying about Glimmer and Bow, the guard had stopped, as another came. "New recruit for the camp, Sargent. "

Was it just Adora or they looked the same.

"You can head back brother, I can take it from here. "

brother? Might explain the similarities.. But identical? Maybe twins?

Adora was left with the other well dressed guy. His expressionless face very unnerving. "What did you do with my friends? " Adora grumbled.

"They are in very good care. You won't be seeing them anytime soon. " He answered a small evil smile coming to his face. Adora's eyes widened and she felt her hand shake at the information.

"Where are you taking me? "

No answer.

"I said. Where. Are. You. Taking me! " Adora stood her ground. They were a small way away from the 'camp's, smoke rising into the air and some yelling could be heard.

He stopped, turning to her, his green eyes showing frustration.

"A special camp, where your skills can be sharpened. With your build I'm thinking you'd be pretty well here. " He walked on and Adora looked back. She could run right now, but that gun in his sling wasn't promising a safe return to her lover. Besides she couldn't possibly know how quick he was with it.

"I wouldn't think about it if I were you. " He sang and Adora huffed following behind him.

The camp was hell.

At least that's how it looked to the blonde.

It all consisted of military grade training. For what invasion, she had no clue, everything was peaceful around the villages she knew, no threat. It's like these guys *were* the threat.

Adora gasped as they stood at the entrance, several people training, being yelled at as they were forced to work in other areas. Carrying heavy coal into a metal building, and coming back out only to quickly go back in with another. If one slightly slowed down they were berated with insults and lashes.

A distance away, Adora could hear gunshots and she guessed more training. Some boys jogged past her and they gave tired and drained looks at her. Almost similar to pity.

Adora gulped as she was led to a group of cadets. The guy instructing them looking just like.... She looked to the guy next to her, then back to the entrance, remembering her other guard.

Clones! These guys can only be explained as clones!

She looked around at the others and she almost lost her mind.

"Brother."

"Brother. "

Adora was left there with little instruction and little conversation. She avoided eye contact with the cadets, not wanting to see the looks on their faces from everything that went on here. The clone looked her up and down and pointed at the gun nearby, most likely ordering her to try out the weapon as he untied her wrists.

Adora rubbed her wrist and nervously walked up to the gun. Picking it up and noticing the target a little way from her. She sighed, squared her jaw and took a few shots, all dead center. The clone watching everything about her stance, her focus, everything.

The clone hummed and had a small judging smile as he brought her over to the cadets.

"I think it's time to introduce your new force captain, cadets. She won't be trouble for us. Won't you, Force Captain? " He squeezed her shoulder tightly and Adora held back a wince.

"N-no, sir! "

"i can't hear you, Force Captain! "

"No Sir! " Adora stood at attention almost on instinct and shouted. The clone gave an approving smirk and responded, "at ease. "

Adora calmed down, but followed instructions. She knew this routine, she saw less brutal ones back at training for the guards. His held behind his back and marched to the line before them. "You all are dismissed. Return to your cabins, where you shall await further instructions. "

"Your name Cadet? " The clone stopped Adora.

"Adora Grayskull, sir! "

"Don't disappoint me Force Captain Grayskull, or I will dispose of you myself. " Adora inhaled sharply and nodded before being dismissed.

Chapter 21

Chapter Summary

Trigger warning on the bloody side

Chapter Notes

Listening to 'final girl' while writing this lol
And I also traumatized myself researching how people do these things so yeah, appreciate it.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

SLAP

Catra got tossed to the snow covered ground, a sudden pain in her cheek and her scalp. The sound of Moonshine crying nearby made her angry. She had easily seen the pelt the witch was wearing, the way it made Adora gasp, the way it was groomed and slung over her shoulders like a trophy. Catra growled in her muzzle.

"Let's look at what we got shall we? " Shadow Weaver grabbed at Catra's arms and looked at her fur, the feline attempting to pull away only to get other soldiers to hold her down.

"Hmm, your clearly one who've been into a lot of trouble... " Shadow Weaver inspected her fur and skin. Catra snarling in protest and the woman looked at her scalp.

"Tsk tsk tsk, we can't use this one. She's way too battered, and her fur is chappy. How about that red headed one? " Catra's eyes widened as the guard got up and dragged the other feline over. Treating them all like poultry animals.

"Ah, this one will do." Shadow Weaver glared at Catra, the feline surging forward and trying to speak through her muzzle.

"Where did you take Adora? " She growled through gritted teeth, she found it hard to open her mouth in this metal thing.

The witch's eyebrow raised momentarily, but then she seemed to have smiled, "oh, she's in a military camp. Nothing for your filthy little species to worry about. "

Moonshine clinged to Catra and cried harder, her muttering of Adora's name heard by the woman.

"Hmm, *Adora* means something to you rats... " Catra held Moonshine closer and avoided that ice cold stare. Shadow Weaver letting out a chuckle.

Later on they were dragged and thrown into cages, Moonshine forced to be separated from her mother, the witch inspecting the kitten. "Hmm, she'd make a nice backpack, " She smirked evilly and Catra snarled banging on the metal bars.

The place was hotter than they'd like it to be, their thick fur not cooperating with the heat of the new room. There were cauldrons near by, huge ones, and the smell was terrible. She almost wished she could claw out her own nose at the stench. It was metallic, rotten, fresh all at once and made her gag.

Shadow Weaver snapped her fingers and Jess, the red headed magicat, got dragged forward. She squirmed, tears running down her cheeks as she tried to fight them off but it was no use. Shadow Weaver grabbed the feline' face and yanked her head up.

"Hmm, I might just make an example of you. " She spoke coldly before grabbing one of the magicat's ears and pulling her towards the couldron. The feline helping in pain as her ear slightly tore. Catra grimaced her face holding both pain and anger.

Shadow Weaver got some gloves from a clone as grabbed a knife. Catra's eye widened and she turned to Moonshine.

"Moon! L-look at me okay? Don't turn away, everything's gonna be okay. " Catra tried to say through her muzzle, her speech slightly muffled, but Moon nodded, her tail puffed out in fear.

"Oh, the reassurance isn't going to work, she wouldn't need it when I'm done with this one. You should know better than to lie to a child. " Catra growled at this. Moonshine looking at her and never turning around even as Shadow Weaver's knife descended upon Jess's ear.

A scream filled the room as Shadow Weaver cut through the cartilage. Jess bawling as she tried to move her hands but they were tied behind her.

More screams echoed throughout the room and soft bones crunched softly as Moonshine's eyes watered and her pupils shrunk smaller than pinpricks. She shut her eyes and her breath stuttered. Catra found herself frozen in place, she wanted to look away but she couldn't, her ear pinned against her head as her claws unsheated. Catra gasped as a final scream pierced the air, Shadow Weaver successful in removing the feline's brown ear.

It went just like this for the other ear, a slow painful process, blood running down the other side of Jess's head. The crimson liquid starting to pool out onto her white shirt. When the other ear was removed, Jess was almost numb to the pain, her eyes watering, her head in so much pain, but her body weak from the blood loss. She was on the verge of passing out, but Shadow Weaver seemed a little bored at the lack of screaming. Even with Catra banging helplessly against the metal bars and bruising her hands.

She snapped her bloodied fingers and the clone came with a table with straps, tying the faint feline down onto it. Catra gulped, glancing at the shivering frame of her kitten, curled into a ball and hiding.

The thump and crack of a tool caught Catra's attention and she refused to look as the loudest scream tore through the thick air.

Jess panicking and plain out bawling.

"Shhh, it's okay. See? It's all disappearing. " Shadow Weaver spoke softly and Catra turned to see Jess's wrist severed from her hand and the clone with a knife to her throat. Her blood stifling her breathing and bubbling in her mouth. Catra let the tears flow, her vision growing blurry and her sobs drowning out the noise.

The noise of that filthy witch, *cutting* incisions into the feline, cutting off their wrists and feet, *skinning* her now lifeless body less than 10 feet away from Catra.

Catra retched into the dark corner, shivering and gagging uncontrollably. At least until she actually threw up and coughed.

Catra heard as the now De-fleshed pelt got thrown into one of the giant couldrons. She sobbed... No *grieved* for the life of the person who used to give Silver flowers every Saturday leading up to Moonshine's birth. She shook, tears gushing out of her eyes as she gripped at her hair.

"Tsk tsk tsk, such a messy thing. Maybe if you hadn't been so chapped up, you would've taken her place. But instead she had to pay the price. Such a pity. I almost didn't do it, but someone *had* to be an example. " Shadow Weaver came to the bars of Catra's cage, the feline spinning around and pressing her back against the wall. Tail tucked between her legs and her chest heaving for breath as the now recognizable scent of blood drafted into her space. Catra shuddered and made herself smaller, the witch smiling as the feisty feline no longer had any fight left in her. An eerie shadow cast over her as they had a small stare down.

"Hm, maybe tomorrow you'd like to cooperate. I got several other examples to make. " Catra shuddered as the woman walked away and threw away her blood stained gloves.

"Ugh, these rats got blood all over my new dress. I'll just have to make another-" her voice faded as her shadow retreated.

Catra slinked down into the cell, looked to where the pool of fresh blood was and felt herself growing dizzy, her ears ringing. She got up to go check on Moonshine but managed to grab onto the bars before seeing black.

Chapter End Notes

I think I might cry....

Chapter 22

Chapter Summary

Putting a narration piece into the notes section, hope you guys don't mind :)

Chapter Notes

Things weren't going too well for everyone. It's been a week and no one has thought of a foolproof plan yet. Bow and Glimmer we're definitely being kept close to a really tech obsessed hermit who always stayed in his sanctum. Adora was starting to realize how terrible this place was by the second, but she managed to make 1 or 2 friends in her squadron who were willing to help her. Catra couldn't say so for herself. She's been being brought food, and the delivery person wouldn't shut up about interrogating her. She was in hell and she missed her angel dearly.

CRACK

Bare forearms impacted the snow as Adora grimaced in pain, a whip slicing at her back. The sleeveless uniform T-shirt not helping with much of the cold. But it was a good thing as she would be overheating instead. Adora Grit her teeth and squeezed her eyes shut trying to bare through the pain. Her ears burned with the anger that consumed her. No matter their rank, as long as they stalled for a moment they got lashed. Insistent yelling could be heard behind her but her mind drowned it out. An entire week of this, and she could take it anymore! Several other cadets gasped as they passed by; Adora yelling as her fury took over her.

"AAAAAAAHHHHHH! "

Wrists made contact with metal and fangs bared, "Let us GO! " Catra shouted. Her glowing eyes piercing daggers into the guard before her.

"I'm sorry, little sister but I cannot. It is against my orders. " The clone responded monotonously. "You better let us out or I'm gonna break out of here and shove these metal bars up your-"

"Woah there kitten! I can take it from here sir. "

"Aren't you supposed to be tending to the barracks? " the clone inquired. The lizard-like person smirked, "If you should know, I'm assigned to both parties. To keep the captives in check. " They turned to Catra and winked. Catra groaned, she knew this stupid talkative idiot and she hated it.

As the clone left, Catra's irritation showed. "Huh, you don't have to be so disappointed, kitty cat. I'm just delivering a message. "

"A message? Nothing else, no interrogation today? What's the catch? " Catra tightened her grip on the metal bars.

"One from precious boot camp, but I'll only give it to you in exchange for something else. " Lizard-like eyes twinkled. Catra looked at them skeptically.

"If not? "

"Hmm, I can.... " They turned into a clone, "speed up your process. "

A shape shifter?

Catra looked to the bloody table away from them, then to Moonshine.

"Okay, I'll do it. What do you need? " Catra sighed.

"You need to stop being a heroic dumbass Adora! You could've gotten yourself killed out there! " Cadet Lonnie pinched her

temples pacing in their barracks. Adora winced as she kept the ice pack to her cheek. She'd gotten a gunbutt to her face and now she knew how much it hurt. She held her gaze downward in shame.

Rogelio grunted, supposedly speaking. At least it's what Kyle told her.

"He says, your stupid. " Adora chuckled, it's probably what Catra would say too. She'd probably hit her upside the head to back it up, but then kiss her to tell her it was all fun and games anyway. She really missed her.

Adora sighed as she thought and Lonnie kept going on about how much she could've died.

Giving her that Force Captain badge is almost like putting the world on her shoulders, she's definitely expected to do better than everyone here. Faster, stronger, less complacent, and someone who just bounces back from punishment. But she's not perfect. She's all but done any of those.

The guys always said that every new recruit gets the badge, but then get demoted within a week because they couldn't take it or either died somehow. (They'd never give details) Adora knew she wasn't someone to give up. If having this badge meant she had even some access to being able to talk with guards, she had to start thinking of a plan, she had Allies now. It should be easy enough.

"Hey! Are you even listening to me? " Lonnie folded her arms in irritation.

"Don't you think it's time we make a plan? "

"Yeah, but if anything goes wrong we blame it on Kyle. "

"Wha- you know what? Whatever... " Kyle groaned and Rogelio gave him a Pat on the back and growled.

"Wait-" Catra tried to keep her focus on the topic at hand. "You want in? " The shape shifter nodded. "That's all?! "

"Yeah this place is a dump not gonna lie. But I'm not gonna explain myself to you." They looked over their nails nonchalantly. It was a risky deal but Catra needed to know what this message thing was about.

"Fine, deal. Now tell me. " Catra folded her arms waiting.

"I know your girlfriend is in camp, and I know where your other 2 friends are being held. But first everyone's gonna need a plan and to cooperate. Understood? " Catra nodded. Did Adora figure it out already?

"I. Am a guard at the Horde camp, I can get information across to everyone, especially from here to your girlfriend. I can delay anything Shadow Weaver intends to do with you or your kitten if all goes well. "

Catra swallowed thickly, she felt like she was making a mistake risking everyone like this.

"Your Adora managed to get herself into trouble today. No doubt she'll be demoted soon. In the meantime however I shall offer my aid with the escape plan. "

"Why are you helping us? " Catra narrowed her eyes and flattened her ears.

"Because darling, " They grinned, "it came with a price. "

As the lizard-like person turned to leave, Catra stopped them, "hey what's your name? "

"You can call me, Double Trouble. " DT winked. Catra watched as DT shifted into a clone and two more came into a cell, dragging out a blonde, male magicat.

"*NOOOO! "*

Adora woke up panting, her throat dry and her skin wet from sweat. She had just had a nightmare, another one in fact. It's been happening a lot since she last saw her lover. This time it was unimaginable things being done to the feline. Adora shuddered at the memory of blood and screams. She turned in her cot and sighed, she really hoped Catra was okay. It was the only thing keeping her going. The hope.

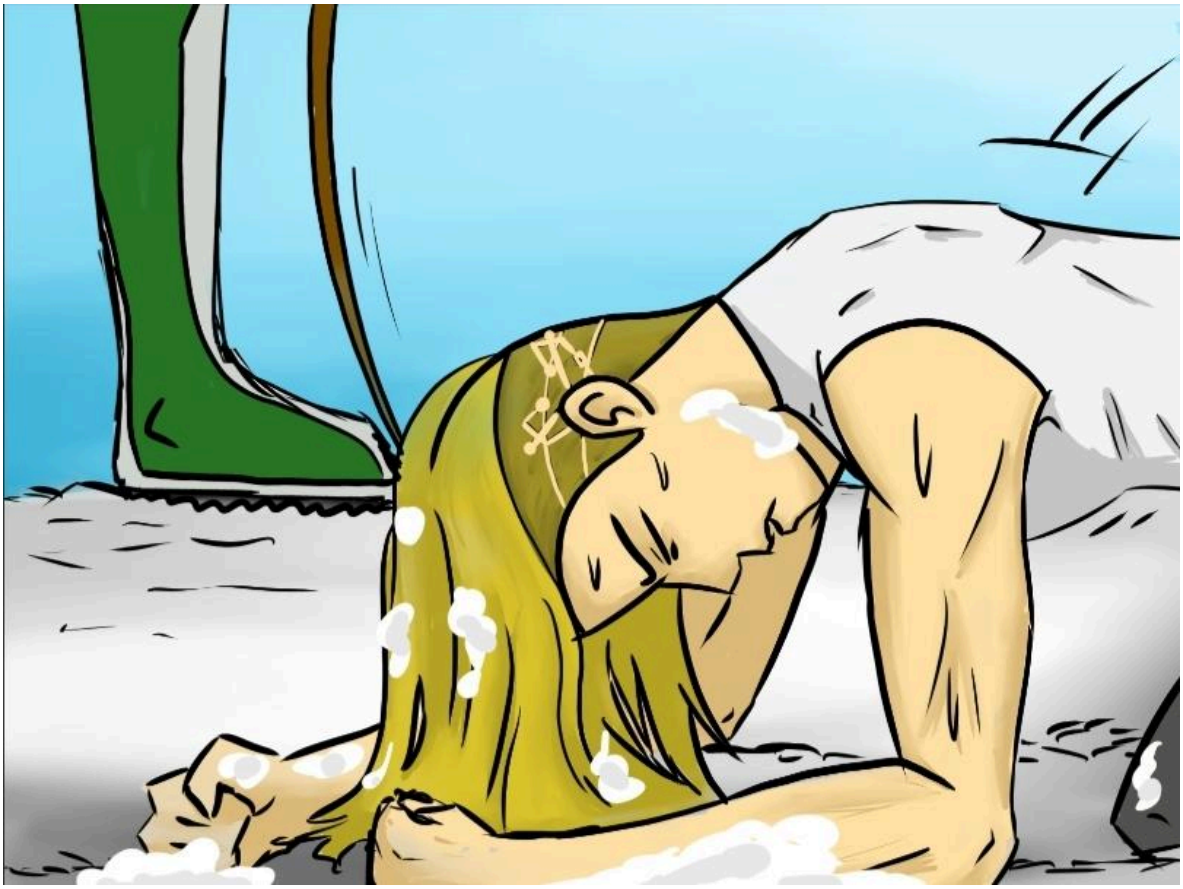
Adora gave another sad sigh as she hugged the pillow that was under her head. She missed hugging her, holding her. She was desperately worried about Moon- her kitten. *HER* kitten. She couldn't bear the thought of losing them. Losing her best friend, her sister. If only she knew where they were.

Lonnie had told them of a guard they can speak with but... She still had her doubts. Unlike what everyone thought, she wasn't gonna give up. Her last name wasn't Grayskull for nothing.

No one and she meant *no one,* was gonna get left behind.

Just some photos not a chapter





Chapter 23

Chapter Summary

> We all learn something new about our favorite characters... But how about a twist this time huh?

Chapter Notes

> I am putting the chapters the way I have bc the original chapter 23 you saw previously was not a chapter of this story but contained pictures.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It was a routine thing by now, Catra dreading it everyday because she knew exactly who she was doing it to, but had to believe it was not.

For Catra this wasn't fair, but a deal's a deal. And if she wanted to get out of there, she had to keep her word. Double Trouble didn't just want into the plan, to a better life out of the secret of what the Horde promised them.

They wanted a power source. One that powers their abilities.

At first they thought it was just hopeless wishes, but over time they realized it was the love of those people they captured. Whether it was hopeless love, love for their lost families, love for another cadet they couldn't admit, or just blocking out the negativity from their lives and loving each other in secret. But to their dismay, as time went on, that love became weaker. Turning into utter hopelessness and grief. Love grew weaker among the cadets, and DT's powers became weaker.

The only thing now powering them was Shadow Weaver's love for violence, her love for money. If you call it love.... It was clear evidence of greed. And it was just as weak yet useable.

Catra sighed as DT came marching in as a clone. Changing shifts, a usual excuse, but effective. Catra got up and Moonshine turned around, her ears flattening, she saw the first time and she hated it. She cried, she got betrayed. And Catra could understand, she felt like she was betraying Adora every single time. But she had to.

A tear fought to escape from Catra's eye but she blinked it away and held at the bars of the cell between her and the visitor. DT said they had other methods but this method was just cruel. So why use this one?

"Just get it over with." Catra sighed as they shifted into a familiar blonde. Some details a bit scratchy because of the weakness of their powers.

"I am truly sorry for all the trouble, Kitty but it's the easiest and fastest way. " DT spoke, their voice dripping with Adora's sound. Catra looked up, her eyes saddened all because it wasn't actually her.

"I know. Just do it. " Her ears flattened as Adora came closer, their eyes meeting. Catra sucked in a breath feeling her heart warming, but tensed a bit as Adora's hand came in contact with her jaw. "Relax kitten, it's okay. " Adora's eyes softened and she leaned down, Catra automatically leaning up to meet her.

That kiss. That dreaded kiss.

So soft, so warm, so familiar yet it's not. Catra could feel her chest warming with every slide against her lips. Her hands gripping the metal bars, claws slicing into it painfully. Adora reached her hands through the bars and ran her fingers against Catra's ears. Making her purr, but also calming her.

"It's okay. It's okay, almost done. " Adora's fingers started feeling identical, her scent returning, her jaw becoming fully smooth and her voice smoothening out. Catra buzzed, her fur stood on end, genuine feelings spiking tenfold. She missed Adora, she loved

her... No *loves* her. Adora chuckled against Catra's lips, feeling the feline craving.

But she pulled away as Catra made a move to deepen the kiss even more, Catra chasing the blonde, her head partly pertruding through the cage in attempt to get her back.

"Easy kitten. You're overflowing right now. You should save that for the real me. " Catra's heart broken in a split second. Reality crashing down on her after a long moment of bliss.

Catra's eyes burned, like they always do. Just as DT shifted back into themselves, she made a pained noise.

"I will admit... Your love is different, you're overflowing with it and it's delicious." They blinked their reptilian eyes and smirked. Catra growled, feeling the tears trickling down her cheeks and dripping to the floor.

"Nice doing work with you, ***Kitten***. " Their voice changed to Adora's at the nickname.

She sobbed, DT still with their satisfactory grin plastered onto their face as they shifted into a clone again and left her there. Her body shook, as she pressed her back against the cell and sobbed. Especially as she heard tiny sniffles from the kitten nearby. But she couldn't take it anymore.... She just couldn't, this time she was filled with devastation as she yelled and pounded at the metal bars.

"You know I have half a mind to skin you right now for the ruckus! " Shadow Weaver came walking past and Catra back up into the wall, her tail bushing with fear.

"But the screaming would only make my headache worse. Besides, there's nothing I could possibly do with you, you're filthy and useless." The witch peered closer and glared through her veil. "I guess we can only keep you locked up till you rot. It's just sad to see your kitten has been suffering the same fate. She clearly hasn't been cleaning herself. " Shadow Weaver clearly cringed.

Catra looked to the ground and blocked out anything the woman could've said afterwards.

Her heart was in pain and she just wanted everything to be over.

She curled up into a ball despite Shadow Weaver's attempts of calling her rude etc. She just wasn't feeling it today. All she could think of was Adora. Her bright smile, her flowing locks, that ridiculous poof.... She wished this was all some nightmare she would wake up from soon, panting as Adora held her and calmed her racing heart.

But tonight she was gonna dream of a better time. A time she wanted to go back to. And maybe pretend it was all okay again, right in her lover's arms with her kitten purring beside them.

Chapter End Notes

So what did you guys think about DT huh? Was it a nice idea?

Chapter 24

Chapter Summary

They need to get a move on!

Chapter Notes

I.... Seriously hate when I've been working on a chapter for an hour... Then I come back on my tab after checking something and it's all... GONE! Fuckity fuck fuck fuck fuck fuckkkkkkkkkkk.
Anyways hey, got some time to write today, so I'm fine don't worry!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra sighed, remembering what Shadow Weaver had said about Moonshine being scruffy. Glancing over to her sleeping kitten, she thought. It was late, probably midnight by now, but not like she could tell, being locked up for so long, only the whirring and clunking of machinery being heard. Catra couldn't sleep, with the noise and the stench of blood filling her senses. She could tell Moonshine was used to it by now, her chest rising and falling in her sleep.

She hated living in her own filth... They had no choice... No other ways to--

Catra groaned and curled her tail closer to herself. They designated a corner for that, thankfully. Trying to keep the rest of the cell as clean as possible for them to be able to sleep and prevent themselves from getting sick. Catra looked to her kitten and went over, she remembered the plan... And while her kitten was asleep, tried as best as she could to clean the feline through the bars. Taking the excess fur off of her tongue and placing it neatly elsewhere.

CRASH

Adora groaned and attempted to raise herself off the floor of the barracks with a low growl, a red droplet falling from her now busted lip. Lonnie and Rogelio confronted her attacker, making sure to use her title of being Force Captain. But the male only laughed, claiming that she was only weak, like the ones before who didn't want anything to do with such a high ranking.

But that remark made Lonnie's eyes widen and Rogelio grumbled under his breath.

"What did the lizard say? " He scoffed to the dark skinned woman beside him. Adora stood fully, her breathing even as she was still faced away from them. She wiped her lip and smirked, tilting her head towards him a bit. Lonnie and Rogelio smirked and parted the way.

"He said... *run.*" Adora yelled and charged at him.

BANG

Shadow Weaver came in with an entrance... As always. Catra feeling uneasy as the woman inspected Moonshine with a grin. "Much cleaner, such an improvement so soon shall be rewarded, don't you think? " Catra growled and the woman didn't even flinch.

"You on the other hand, should do the same. You're a filthy animal. " Catra felt a little self conscious. Her fur wasn't matted in any way. Just dirty. If anything she needed to brave water to wash it out, like a stray cat. She growled lowly and her pupils narrowed on the woman with the red veil.

It wasn't long before she left, DT disguised as a guard waltzing in with a purpose.

"are you here to...? " Catra started, looking down. DT chuckled, "no kitten. I'm actually here to inform you about the plan. " Catra for sure was expecting bad news, her ears drooping.

"Shadow Weaver intends on returning in an hour to take you precious kitten. New purse and all that. Very delighted in her being freshly cleaned. " Catra deflated. She made a mistake.

"Then stop her! " She suddenly charged at the metal bars, her nose close to theirs.

"I wouldn't be too panicked about it, the plan is still under way. " Catra searched their reptilian eyes for some ounce of a lie. But she had to trust this person if they were all to escape safely.

"So... You want me to just... Let her take my daughter?! " Catra whispered. DT smirked, "trust me, she'll be safe. "

"How can I trust you, Double Trouble? You're only talking about some plan but I don't see anything working. " Catra hissed and they chuckled. "I'm working in the shadows, you're stuck in here. Of course you won't see anything working. Your precious Adora seems to be buying her time beating up people so I won't say she's struggling much. She can handle herself, you on the other hand. Need me here most of the time. And I'm working. On. It. So be greatful and suck it up pussy cat or the deals off and you'll both be rugs and Adora getting a bullet to the head. " DT inhaled and slicked their hair back. Catra stunned and her throat bobbing with a loss for words.

She submitted, her tail curling into herself. "Okay... Just... Hurry up..... " she hesitated, "... Please... " Avoiding eye contact she pressed the top of her head to the cage. DT left, leaving without another word. She hoped they could work faster, she's not sure how long she could take again.

one hour later

Shadow Weaver made her signature entrance, hurting the sensitive ears of the Magicats inside the room. The woman grinned and opened the cage containing the blonde kitten, Moonshine skittering backwards in fear and Catra growling threateningly at her. She never wanted to let her kitten anymore than 3 feet away from her and was watching the woman's every movement like a predator.

"Leave her alone you witch! " Shadow Weaver managed to grab the kitten by her mane and dragged her out, Moonshine yelling in pain. "Let.Her.Go! " Catra snarled and banged against the metal bars. Shadow Weaver barely paid her any attention as she turned to leave, Moonshine crying, "mama!! "

"No... No no no no! Please! No! " Catra heaved, tears streaming from her eyes as she screamed and damaged her claws against the metal bars. Her claws were getting dull so it was useless. Her knuckles bled as she made more futile attempt to get out of her cell, shouting and begging.

She heard Moonshine's crying echoing as the door slam shut behind them, she was bawling now, her muscles tired and her heart aching, being squeezed. Sliding to her knees, she sobbed. If this plan failed she'd have lost everything. Catra's eye widened... No... No no no no.

See held her head and sobbed, curling into herself. She whimpered and looked out to the blood covered room. He looked to the bars and sobbed, trying to fit through them, trying to get her head through. But it wasn't any use. She sniffled and held at her head, hearing the absence of her daughters heartbeat in the cell across from her. Her mind flashing back to 7 years prior. A day she thought she had felt like she was in a cage, the only difference was the physical one she knelt in now.

7 years ago

Thunder roared, as the cold rain soaked through her fur. A soft hand laid onto her shoulder, reassuring yet... She didn't know

what. Her eyes were puffy as she looked down at the kitten in a sling on her chest. Sound asleep, shivering with the cold. How could she have done this to the kitten.... To herself...

Catra whimpered and focused all her warmth on her chest, trying to ease the kitten's burden. She had no one who was able to watch over Moonshine on a day like this. The entire village was here to see the Princess's wife get buried. Catra pressed her ears back and squeezed her eyes shut. The scent of rain and mildew filling her nose, and the lack of a heart beat in front of her. Her eyes watered, and her throat tightened. She didn't want to open her eyes again. Didn't want to... Re-confirm it... She closed her eyes hoping to block it all out in the first place.

She heard a small whimper against her chest and the kitten squirmed against her. Her wet fur likely bothering her. Catra put her hand to the kitten's body. Feeling the small heart beat, hear ears went down painfully, her tail between her legs.

Thump thump

thump thump

She felt the kitten's ears twitching, likely feeling her mother's distress. Catra ran her fingers over the kitten's head, holding her close and kissing her atop it. Her lips quivered, another sob about to shake her body once more. Jess's voice broke through her thoughts. "Hey, it's okay. You got Moonshine now. " The red head smiled to her as Catra dared to open her eyes. She didn't dare to look at the body in front of her though as she turned to her friend. She smiled a little but the smile faded. "I wish she was here... " She sniffled, "she deserved to meet Moonshine... Just once. "

Jess smiled reassuring her, "she did. " Catra looked up into green eyes.

"I was there... " Jess's eyes teared up as well, " Silver... She.... She got to see Moonshine. Got to hold her.... " Jess wiped her

eyes with the back of her hand. She then looked down to the kitten. "Your kitten, got to hear her last heartbeat, Catra. " Catra had tears running down her cheeks as Jess also cried. "Silver was so happy, even if she knew she was on the verge of passing, she was happy. Catra, she told me to tell you she loves you. No matter what. She loves you Catra, she loves the both of you, very much. " Jess sniffled and hugged Catra. The feline's eyes wide, but also very much crying. The brunette buried her face into her friend's shoulder and sobbed.

Catra sobbed into her knees, Jess's scream echoed in her ears and she shook. She wants all this to be over. She wants everything to go back the way they were. She wants Adora back. Catra sobbed.

Chapter End Notes

I am... Crying now... *sobs*

Chapter 25

Chapter Summary

Welp *eats a chip* let's see how this goes!

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Adora yells as she swings her arm toward a punching bag, the impact pushing the sack rather greatly. She swung, punch after punch. Her mind plaguing with what DT told her. What they did to Moonshine, to Catra.

To her... Her daughter.... Her wife....

She yelled. And struck again. That's how she thought of them now. That's basically what they were to her after all.

"Hey! Take it easy!" A buzzing reminded her that Lonnie was trying to trim her undercut. Even though she insisted she had to train. "You didn't have to do that now, Lon. " Adora swung again with a grunt.

"Well it's either now or it gets delayed for another week. After this session, Hordak wants to see all the cadets. I don't want you looking stupid. " Lonnie tried to hold Adora still. The blonde groaned, "fine." She sighed and sat on the nearby bench with a huff. The metallic buzz continued. Failing to soothe her from the idea of this meeting.

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Knees impacted the snow, and Adora was forced to stay at attention. Standing at the front because of her status. Now trained as a soldier but also trying so hard to stick with the stupid plan. Hordak came up to her and silently taunted her and inspected her. He turned to a gagged Bow and Glimmer and smirked turning back to unwavering blue-grey eyes.

On the inside however, Adora was angry. She was scared. What were they doing here? Why do they look so ragged and beat up? What. Had. He. Done?!

She was on the verge of clenching her jaw. But couldn't, there were clones with guns all around them, and with the safety off made it worse. She had to stay emotionless.

"Shoot them. " Hordak said with indifference, making Adora's toes curl in her boots. Her breathing subtly got faster.

'*what?! '*

A pair of clones raised their guns, Bow and Glimmer panicking and crying as she was forced to stay at attention or suffer with them. Before seeing the things Hordak could do, she would've. She would've put her life on the line without a doubt. But..... Things were way to complicated now.

Catra was who knows where, Moonshine too. Magicat citizens slaughtered. If she moves, Moonshine might die, Catra might die, her friends might die in front of her with the slightest emotion toward them. There was too many faults in any angle she looked at it. She had to trust the one behind it all. DT.

The fingers on the triggers started to squeeze and Adora wanted to close her eyes. She could feel the warnings from her fellow cadets behind her. All of them telling her not to move or she dies first and her friends next. Hordak smirked, almost like he was sadistically waiting for her to move.

The blurry figures in her peripheral shook as they squeezed their eyes shut in fear, huddling together.

BANG

****THUD****

Adora's breath shook slightly as she stood unwavering. Her friends gasped silently as the clone on their left fell to the ground. Everyone remaining silent and in shock. The clone on their right, smirked. Adora smirked at the General in her face. "Boom." She punched him square in the nose. All clones in the area started shooting, DT being equipped to take care of them all. Their aim tripping through each of their skulls in one full swoop. A few ducked as they shot, but they untied Adora's friends as quickly as possible.

"You guys know how to use a gun? Great. " DT didn't wait for an answer but handed them two shot guns. They looked to each other before taking down a few clones.

Adora ducked a swing from Hordak, sweeping his legs out from under him. The mistake he had made was training an already skilled fighter. She just got better.--

Adora groaned as she collected a kick to her abdomen. Hordak getting back up but getting blocked from landing another hit from her face. Bring her hands back down she grabbed at the general's coat and yanked him into a headbutt. He groaned and held his head, stumbling backwards momentarily.

"For a general, I didn't think you'd be such a pathetic fighter. " Adora smirked and Hordak growled. He advanced forward and Adora cracked her neck ready for another try. Hordak's hand travelled to his coat pocket and her eyes widened, she leapt at him as he pulled out a gun. Knocking it out of his hand and kicking it far away from them. Before he could do anything else she kneed him in his crotch and he doubled over, tears in his eyes.

Adora soccer punched Hordak across the jaw and he fell limp.

Rather easy fight if you asked her.

Gunshots rang out and she ducked, remembering the commotion elsewhere. She fumbled over to the pistol she had just kicked away and cocked it. Helping DT with a few other Clones on their tail. A clone fell to the snow behind Adora and she gasped, Lonnie not far away, giving her a thumbs up. Adora saluted and ran over to Double Trouble and her friends.

BANG

"AH shit! " The blonde groaned and held her side. Removing her hand, blood leaked onto her fingers and her shirt. "Shit shit shit. " She cursed and looked up, finding her shooter and serving him right between the eyes.

"Fucker." Adora groaned and hissed continuing her journey.

"Hey Blondie, you got a souvenir, nice. " DT smirked and fired a few more shots.

"Shut up Double Trouble. We need to get moving, now!"

"Adora! " Glimmer gasped and rushed to her, Bow and DT covering for them. Adora's eyes teared up.

"It's okay, I'm fine. I'm not important right now. We need to go get the others before more clones start filtering in. Or before Hordak wakes up. " Adora glanced over to her previous spot. Hordak was gone.

"Shit. We gotta go. Now! " DT nodded and they helped get them to the keeps, firing at oncoming clones as they got in. Glimmer looked to the dash. She didn't know what to do. DT groaned.

They handed Glimmer the rifle and hopped into the front seat. "You shoot, I drive. " Glimmer stammered out an OK but did just that. Bow's turn to look after Adora. The blonde groaned as her

shirt got more soaked in blood. The tires of the Jeep kicking up snow as they were off.

"Adora, what happened back there? what- it's been so long--" Bow sniffles.

"I know, I know. I'm sorry." She attempted to hug the dark skinned boy. Adora looked back at the camp site. She hoped the others would be okay. She squinted as she swore she saw Kyle giving out a battle cry, with two rifles in his arms as he stood back to back with Rogelio who held a much larger gun as well. She chuckled. They'll be fine.

Adora grimaced and Bow noticed, Glimmer stopped shooting as they were finally out of sight. "Adora, we need to fix this. At least before we get to Catra." Glimmer pleaded.

"You'll have enough time, Blondie. It just wouldn't be a smooth ride. " DT proved a point as they drove over a bump. Adora hissed. "We'll risk it. Bow, see if you can find a medical kit on this thing. There just has to be one."

After some time of rummaging, "we don't got all day, Crop-top," DT drawled.

"i... I can't find anything! Only old cloths!" Bow fretted. Adora groaned. "Fine, we're doing it the hard way then" She proceeded to remove her shirt, her hand shaking. As they drove over another bump she grimaced again, sucked up the pain and pressed two fingers into the wound on her right side with a shout. Tears came to her eyes as she felt for the bullet and took it between her fingers. Gritting her teeth tightly as she pulled it out.

Bow tore an old cloth and rushed to wrap her sides as Adora threw the bullet away. She painted as tears slipped through her eyes, Glimmer looking at her.

"What have you been through...? "

"Nothing close to what the others have been through, I'm sure. " Double Trouble looks to the trio through the rearview mirror. "That's right, Adora. And I hope we're not too late. If Shadow Weaver gets word about what happened here. She'll delay no further. "

Chapter End Notes

The plan is finally in motion. I know. Lolz

Chapter 26

Chapter Summary

> Don't blame me, love made me crazy, if it doesn't you ain't doin' it right. Oh Lord save me, my drug is my baby, I be usin' for the rest of my life.

Chapter Notes

> I guess I'll leave a song or something for y'all today. :)
> And you guys can probably tell I'm confusing myself with how technology progresses but, let's just say it's all Entrapta's doings kay?

See the end of the chapter for more notes

https://youtu.be/Eh0p1h3NS84

Adora's ponytail bounced as they hit another bump, her arms folded from the blistering cold and soft snow blowing into her face. She looked down and shivered. Her friends hugging each other for warmth. They offered but she didn't want to crush them. She definitely put on muscle within the time they were missing, but in turn, they have also lost it. They looked frail and she was scared of hurting them. So she settled for freezing. She glanced over to Glimmer and Bow, thought in her eyes.

A small smile crept onto her face. But just like that it faded and she looked down again. Double Trouble driving over some more rough terrain and making her side spike with pain. She winced. She was so glad to have them back. But she wanted to get Catra herself. They looked too weak to fight anymore than they have already.

Double Trouble looked into the rear view mirror, transforming into a better figure, their usual form. Reptilian eyes studying the

blonde closely.

"Now what's going on in your head, Blondie? " All eyes turned to Adora and she held her breath. She felt caught. She looked out the window and put her hands around her right knee.

"I'm... " She didn't know. She looked out at the soft snow. Her eyes and throat burned but everyone let her take her time. The silence spoke volumes from Glimmer perspective. She couldn't imagine being separated from Bow. Being away from her mother was already hurting her so much.

Adora took a shuddering breath before she spoke.

"I'm going alone. "

All eyes widened and DT drove over a bump.

"You what?!/What?! / That's suicide blondie! "

DT looked back at her again. "You don't know where to go, you don't know if Shadow Weaver is there! Who's working the shift, nothing! You are NOT going in there alone. "

"W-well yeah obviously, I just don't want Glimmer and Bow getting hurt at least! " Adora looked to them and they looked down. Glimmer nudged Bow with her elbow and he sighed. "We can stay behind if it makes you feel better. We don't have anymore energy left anyways. " Adora she shoulders visibly relaxed and she smiled scooching over to them and pressing her head against theirs.

"Thank you. " She exhaled. Glimmer wrapping her arms around the blonde tightly, getting a long deserved hug. Adora melted into the embrace, Bow joining in.

"Sorry to break up... Whatever that is but, " The Jeep stopped, "we're here. " DT opened their door and hopped out onto the snow laiden ground. Adora shared glances with the pair in her arms and noogied them.

"I'll be right back, okay? Anyone comes, hide. Or run. Right DT? " Adora called over her shoulder. DT nodded and pointed to the woods. "You'd be able to lose them in the woods, just don't get lost yourself. If anything we can have Catra or Moonshine track you. " DT dug under the driver's seat for a gun and attempted to shift.

Adora gave them a court nod and got out to put on a coat DT threw at her.

"Considering you don't have pneumonia by now, you should save your fingers from falling off. "

"Hehe, thanks. " Adora shuffled the cloth onto her body, wincing as her side pulled with frozen blood.

Adora noticed DT's form flickered.

"Hey... You okay? "

"I'm fine, it wouldn't be too much of a problem. Now come on, we have to blend in. Hopefully there's not much clones there."

Adora nodded and put her hands behind her back as DT escorted her inside. Their footsteps echoing.

All the corridors were like a maze. All the same yet DT seemed to have seen a difference. When they came to their 4th corridor though, it seemed too easy. No one was here it seems. But DT still tested the air. Shadow Weaver's scent was stale. She hadn't been there in a while. Adora felt uneasy as DT let their guard down a bit and ushered her on.

But as they ventured on a smell hit her nose and she gagged. DT chuckled a moment and tried to push her forward. "I guess I forgot to warn you about the smell. "

"What kind of place is this?! "

DT kept pushing her, "its where your girlfriend lives. " a sudden set of heavy footsteps came from behind them and they hid around a corner.

"Who's there? " DT eyed the clone, he had a ring of keys on his belt. Good. It would make picking the lock much easier. Adora however was lost in thought, her mind racing and her stomach urning from the stench of blood. Seeing the look on her face DT smirked, "would you like to do the honors? " Adora scowled as the clone passed by.

The clone having thought he caught the trespassers, was immediately against the floor unconscious as Adora swung a punch to his face. She scoffed, "these clones are pathetic I swear. " She took the ring of keys from his belt and jingled them looking to DT with a smug expression. DT took them and headed to the end of the corridor, opening the large metal door. Adora in tow with her thoughts speaking volumes. What kind of sick place was this?! She gagged and tried to keep her breakfast down.

DT stopped as the door made a small creak. "Stay out here for now, I'll call when I need you. Besides the smell is worse inside. " Adora nodded as they left the door a little open. More of the scent of dried blood and who knew what else flowed out of the room and Adora cursed, covering her mouth as she stifled tears. How could they do such a thing to her? Catra, was here?! Her head couldn't processes it at all. How could they...

Catra heard light footsteps enter the room, but she didn't move. She curled into herself tighter as another tear slipped down her cheek.

"Hey kitten. "

"Go away... " her weak voice rasped. She didn't want to see the form DT was currently shifting to.

Catra was curled onto her side close to Moonshine's side of her cell. Her hair was jagged and abused, an after effect of last night. She'd cried her throat raw last night, pleaded with whatever gods there were for everything to go back the way they once were.

She also stayed emotionless and neutral, a single tear continuing it's journey. Her ears flattened more and she felt hair against her tail. Right, her hair. She clawed it off. It made her think that, the weight on her shoulders felt...lighter, somehow. Yet the only source of comfort was Silver sitting on the opposite end of her cell. Her insanity.

The only part of her they hadn't taken from her.

She sobbed and curled into herself tighter. She lost everything, she lost Moonshine.... Adora.... Everything that made her happy. Her body shook.

She gave up. DT could see it. Her sobs amplified it in every sense. There was no point trying to get their magic from her alone. But... She gave up. That made DT's heart tighten. They sighed and walked back to the door.

"Hey, come on, she needs you. " They whispered to Adora and the blonde wiped her teary eyes and nodded, her brows furrowed.

DT was right. The smell was worse on the inside.

Her throat tightened as she attempted to cover her mouth and look around. Her eyes widened though, at the large expanse of the room. But what was stationed inside it, made her insides churn. There were metal tables with straps along them and an axe and other tools on another table, sparkly cleaned yet cloths dyed in blood next to them.

She gulped as she saw the array of couldrons, filled with dirty water and hoped those were pieces of plastic and not teeth in them. Her eyes slowly scanned the area, hands shaking and breathing ragged. There was blood and more all over the floors,

and so many cages. Adora whimpered softly as her eyes burned. Her eyes blurred and she tried so hard to keep her food down.

Her boot stepped onto something and she stopped in her tracks, fearfully looking down as she moved her foot, eyes dilated to pinpricks. Upon seeing the object she noticed it was a clawed finger and her breath stuttered. Looking in the direction it was pointing on instinct, she sawmagicat sized pelts spread across the walls like trophies. Brushes and more care stuff next to them. She stepped back in a panic. DT coming up to her trying to snap her out of it.

"Hey, hey hey I'm here. You're good. Look at me. Look. At. Me" DT tried but Adora's hands shook as she looked at everything. Her mind racing and fear locking her in place. What kind of place was this? She panted and DT motioned to her again, "hey Catra needs you right now, come back to us. " Catra...

Looking past DT Adora saw a cage with a magicat in it. Draped in white rags and curled up against herself. Her ears flicked in acknowledgment to her name.

She pushed the shape shifter out of the way and stumbled over to the feline. "Catra... " she whimpered but the feline flattened her ears. "I said go away ... Whatever you're trying to do DT, just stop.... Please... Please just... Stop... I've already lost everything.... " Catra sobbed, her nose clogged and unable to smell her lover. Adora saw how messy, cramped and dark her cage was, she let a few tears fall as she stuck a hand in to touch the feline's hair.

"Catra... Please.. It's me...we have to go find Moonshine. " Adora's voice shook.

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"Yeah, it's not me, kitten. " DT came over with the keys and stuck it into the lock. Catra ears lifted a bit and she rushed herself up right, eyes wide as she held onto Adora's hand hoping that it was real. DT got the door open, the room instantly felt 50 times wider as she stared at Adora.

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"Adora... " Catra rasped, unsure. "I'm here, Catra. I'm here. Glimmer and Bow are outside waiting too. " Adora buried her face into Catra's shoulder as she held her tightly, sobbing as Catra stilled in her arms. Catra's eyes widened, Adora pulling back to look at them. Those circled eyes have seen so much but this, this was definitely the last thing she thought they'd see. Catra finally let herself go, sobbing and gripping her dull claws into Adora's new jacket. The both of them holding onto each other tightly. Catra started bawling like a kitten, her throat going raw as she held Adora tighter. "I missed you, Catra. So SO much. " The blonde sniffled as they hugged each other on the floor. Adora leaned her head against Catra's and the feline held her tighter, holding onto her as if she was going to disappear at any moment. She was shaking in her embrace, soaking the Blondie's clothes in tears. They both were. Adora sniffled as DT felt their magic returning fully. Their clone disguise repairing by the second.

These two were like love machines, wow! DT didn't want to break up the moment so they took a seat on a stool.

Adora ran her fingers through Catra's coarse and now short brown mane. She mustered up a shaky breath.

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"You cut your hair. " her hand shook a little, refusing to open her eyes or else she'd see what Catra had to endure for weeks. Catra sniffled and nodded nuzzling into Adora hard.

"I missed you so much... " Adora finally let go and Catra held her just as she did only second ago even if she was weak and her own sobs shook her all the same.

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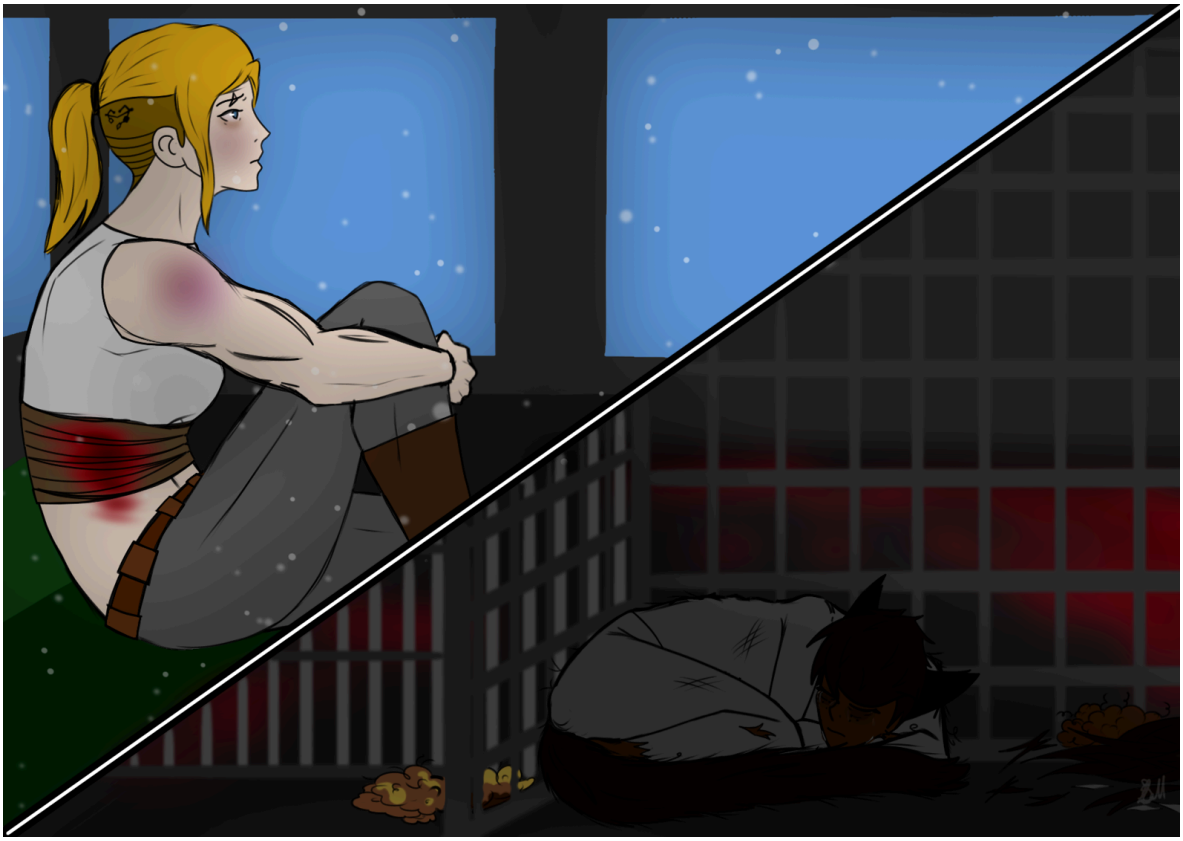
"I missed you, so much..... " Adora sobbed. "Me too. " Catra shook in her arms.

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Chapter End Notes

Sobs like a bitch, I had such a good ending. It got lost.... I hate being an author sometimes!!

Chapter 27

Chapter Summary

If you're crying, I'm (ノ^ヘ^ 00)sorry. But, the show must go on.

Chapter Notes

New music for ya!

https://youtu.be/f6MinONmdX0

Adora and Catra knelt on the dirty floor. Embracing each other and rocking a bit as their tears ceased to flow anymore than they have. Adora's hand supported Catra's head against her shoulder, the feline sitting in her lap and holding on.

Catra's throat hurt, yet she wanted to speak. She tried to open her mouth making a whimper instead.

"Sshh, take your time. I'm right here. " Adora carresed her hair and spoke softly.

"A-adora.... I'm... " Catra tried to move a little, the blonde letting her. But Catra pulled back and looked away.

"I'm filthy Adora. You shouldn't... " Catra coughed a little, "you shouldn't be doing this. " her voice turned hoarse. Adora looked down and closed her eyes, inhaling and regretting it.

"Uh yeah I know I just,... Okay. We should start moving now anyways. " Adora attempted to stand, her legs cramping, the feeling of tiny pins pricking her legs and making them want to give way. Catra had no choice but to hold her up as she stumbled. DT clasped their hands together. "Well my patience has run dry. We. Need to get moving and there's no telling if that clone woke

up by now and has called for back up. " They walked off and Adora glanced down at Catra.

She looked weak and tired. She could even be sick and didn't want to show it. As the blonde got her balance back she stood fully, to follow DT, only to realize Catra didn't move from her spot much. The feline looked down and hugged herself, ears down and tail flicking wildly.

"Hey, you okay? " Adora sauntered back over, glancing over her own shoulder to be sure DT didn't leave them behind. The shape shifter tapping their foot at the entrance impatiently.

Catra shuddered, a sudden tingle going down her spine. She looked up at Adora pleading silently as her legs shook. The woman's eyes widened, "you can't walk? " her voice cracked with emotion. Catra shook her head and sat back down before she could collapse and embarrass herself. Adora chewed her lip and sighed before coming up with a decision and kneeling.

"I'll carry you. Come on. " Catra flattened her ears. All this stalling could get them in serious trouble if they didn't hurry.

"It's okay. " Adora attempted a small smile and Catra looked up into her eyes, she sighed and let Adora lift her with a single nod.

The larger woman lifted the feline into her arms bridal style and walked over to DT. They scowled. "You guys could get us killed you know. Let's just hope your friends are okay in the snow. " Catra looked around and sniffled. Her nose still reeked of blood and waste. She couldn't smell anything else. She really wanted Adora's scent to fill her nose and calm her. She needed it. Her tail wrapped around the woman's torso and Adora winced.

Catra cast a worried glanced to her lover, but Adora pushed on after DT as though nothing happened.

As they exited the rather quiet building, of which didn't hold a knocked out guard anymore, Adora gasped at how heavy the snow had gotten. She looked down at the Jeep and relaxed seeing

her friends huddled together. But then she glanced down to Catra who had tears in her eyes and was looking out to the trees and the fluffy snow falling from the sky.

Adora made her way down to the Jeep holding Catra as close as possible for warmth. Her boots sinking into the white mud as DT opened the back door for them. Glimmer and Bow excitedly greeted the pair but recoiled at the scent.

"We know you guys don't have to remind me. " Catra rasped out and hugged herself in a corner. Adora taking off her jacket despite the snow blowing in through the windowless vehicle.

"Adora what're you--" The blonde draped the jacket around the feline to keep her warm but Catra didn't stop in surprise. She stopped when she saw the blood stained piece of cloth wrapped around her side. It was almost soaked through, red crystals being formed bc of the cold. Her skin mildly blue at the wound.

"Adora! " Bow looked at it.

"It's fine, it's okay. It doesn't hurt as much. "

"Adora, no. That could get infected so easily. What was that from? " Catra croaked out and backed away more. DT finally managing to pull out from the yard.

"It's... It's from a gun shot. I got the bullet out but it's fine. I promise. " Adora tried to reassure her and pulled the jacket snug around the feline, rubbing her hair and ears to warm her up as much as she possibly could.

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The silence went on for most of the ride. Well, other than Adora explaining to the others where Catra was kept and how horrible it was. Catra hadn't told her about Jess. But maybe she should. After all, Moonshine....

Moonshine went through everything too...

"Adora... " Catra sniffled and kept her eyes out the window. She hasn't seen light in so long. Hasn't seen, snow, the sky. She felt her eyes watering a little, her eyelashes frosting bc of the cold and tears.

The blonde turned to her, watching how the brunette's new hairstyle made her look smaller. She wrapped a hand around her and hugged her a little. Catra looked so... Amazed by the world. Like she was longing to be away from all this. She missed it so much. She gave the Magi cat's ear a soft kiss and Catra warmed up. She missed that too.

"Moonshine went through this as well... " Catra finally spoke her tail curling around Adora's leg.

The Blondi's eyes welled up almost instantly. Her lip quivered as she looked out at nothing in particular. Even Glimmer and Bow fell silent. DT just kept driving, not butting into the conversation where they weren't needed. Adora felt a pair of hands intertwine with hers and she looked to it. Glimmer and Bow and both held her other hand, their expressions both trying to be as reassuring as possible for her. Her gaze was blurred and distant. She couldn't imagine what such a young kit must be feeling right now. Catra leaned her head against Adora's shoulder, she could feel the emotions radiating off of the blonde, how much what she said affected her. She really wished she didn't have to tell her. But she had to remind her that, Moonshine was in fact there with her too.

When they got home they could cry how ever much they needed, not now. They needed their heads in the game to deal with

Shadow Weaver.

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It wasn't long before the Jeep slowed down and Catra shivered in her fur. Her winter coat seemed to have prematurely grown in because of how she got locked up. Or she's probably just sick. The feline felt her for head and neck. She didn't have a fever. Did she?

Catra reached out for Adora's hand and put bit to her neck and head. Adora gasped. "Are you okay? "

"I don't know... My winter coat is supposed to have grown in. But it didn't. "

"You're probably just sick Catra. When we get back home we can have the healers look at you, if anything you just need rest and some medicine. " Glimmer gave a side smile to the feline and she nodded slowly.

"The book said it's like heats, if you didn't get enough rest and nourishment your coat wouldn't grow in nice and fluffy. You'll be okay when this is all over. " Adora gave a Catra a little scritch behind her ears. Catra missed that.

"Promise you'll be okay? " Catra sounded so small.

"I promise. " Adora exhaled and got out to follow DT. She turned back and whimpered, "I might need my jacket though.. " Catra chuckled and threw the jacket at the blonde. "You're such an idiot. Be careful dummy. " Adora winked at her and left, her boots crunching in the snow as she jogged away.

Inside the strangely fancy building was chilly, not as cold, but she still needed her jacket to manage the wound at her side. Adora clasped her hands together and breathed into them to warm them up. Her fingers were getting pretty numb.

"My fingers might still fall off you know? I need gloves more than a jacket. " She whisper shouted to DT who chuckled. Glad you finally figured that out. But sadly I don't got spares. "They showed off their gloves making the woman roll her eyes.

DT led her into another set of corridors, but this one was a fork. Could this get any worse?

As if fate decided to test her limits, a gun cocked.

"Well, well, well, we meet again. Force Captain. " Hordak sneered with a cocky smirk aiming his gun at Adora. Adora growled in her throat.

"And you, clone. What's your business here? " DT turned slightly.

"Escorting her to Shadow Weaver, Brother. I found her attempting to break into the warehouse. " Hordak hummed in thought. "Is that so?"

"Do you not believe me Brother? " DT turned their head a little more.

Hordak huffed.

"Clone 467 step forward. " A clone from behind the general stood forward.

"Yes, Lord Hordak? "

"Report."

The clone's eyes shine white for a second. "Clone 12 is not a registered asset, sir. " DT Tensed. They thought they bypassed the registration. Adora rolled her eyes. A minute more and it's a minute lost. Just get this shit over with.

The blonde groaned and spun around, eyes immediately targeted at Hordak. His gun clicked and shot, Adora barely ducking in time as it hit the wall behind her. She grabbed his gun and kneed him in the stomach. Hordak coughed and curled into myself. DT rushed at the other clone and fought, Adora trying g her best to hold off the general once more. "I guess this is round 2 , huh Hordak? Ready to go again? " She squared her shoulders as he got up.

He chuckled and stood, cracking his neck. Adora spotted a staff in a holster on his leg and smirked to herself. He swung and she blocked his fist, relaying and uppercut and slipping from reach as he tried to maneuver around to grab at her. The blonde ducked and grabbed at his uniform, throwing him against the wall. "Come on Hordak, put up more of a fight! " She scoffed, but the general swept her legs from under her. Her head hitting the metal floor with a thud. "ah shit! " she hissed and held behind her head, Hordak grabbing a hold of her jacket and lifting her up. Adora twisted his arm and kicked him away, grabbing his staff and opening it as he surged forward. She blocked his fists and he reached for his gun.

"Oh no you don't. DT! " DT shape shifted out of a headlock with a snake like smirk and grabbed the gun, shooting the clone in the head and pointing at a now frozen war Lord's if you could even call him that. Adora pinned his back down with her new staff and smirked.

"I can't believe you set up an entire camp full of cadets and can't even win at hand to hand combat. Your first instinct is always the gun." Adora chuckled. "For a warlord, that's pathetic. " Hordak

growled and tried to get up but Adora pressed her staff at his spine and he shouted in pain.

She gave a disgusted look at him, "after everything you've done to us, I have half a mind to watch you slowly suffer. " Hordak chuckled up at her. "Then why do you stall--?"

"Because....I'm not like you." Adora snarled, "and if you think conquering land is going to make you wealthier, old man. Listen up. This world belongs to those who will do anything to protect it. And you, you have torn apart my family, tortured us, threatened and starved us till we couldn't fight back. But we're not going to just sit by and let you take that and the lives of innocents! So let this be your final lesson. " she gave the nod to DT and they pulled the trigger with a loud bang. Hordak collapsed to the ground and Adora turned away retracting her staff and hooking it into her belt,

"We're taking the revenge of all the magicats who died at their hands. Too many have suffered because of their greed. " DT put a hand to the blonde's shoulder, giving it a pat "that's admirable Blondie. " they smirked and led the way once more. Adora clenched her fist around her heart. She would risk anything to keep her family safe.

..

Anything.

Chapter 28

Chapter Summary

Oho boy... I'm sorry....

https://youtu.be/wUlJPVheBq4

Catra shivered remembering how things were before... Well... Everything. She growled and Glimmer glanced to her.

"Don't look at me like that! This is a death sentence and you know it! " Catra hissed, her worry for Adora growing. Glimmer flinched but sighed. "Yeah, but we have no choice. We can't fight. "

"So you're going to settle for freezing to death while Adora gets herself killed? " Catra attempted to get up but her legs shook under her. She made a noise of effort as she got out of the vehicle. "I'm not gonna just stay here and freeze to death while my girlfriend and kid is at death's doorstep. "

"But Catra--"

"I don't want to hear it Sparkles, I'm going. " Glimmer looked up at Bow. He wore a saddened look but didn't intervene.

Catra limped through the cold snow. The ice nipping at her skin and the frost testing her short fur. She shivered in her ragged clothes. She was lucky they gave her long sleeves clothing for the winter at least. It helped. As she managed to trudge into the building she was greeted by warmth, her lungs thanking her as they felt like they were thawing. Catra shivered and limped on, holding onto the walls for leverage. She listened, the corridors getting confusing.

Her nose was still congested so scent tracking wasn't going to work this time. He looked to the floor hoping to find something.

And she did. Melted snow from a few pairs of boots left a trail to follow, for how long, she was unsure.

~

Coming up to a forked corridor she let out an uneasy breath, sitting and leaning against a wall for a while. A pool of crimson made the feline gasp. Her blue and yellow eyes flickering over the body before her. She swallowed and mentally breathed a sigh of relief as she realized it was no one she recognized. Adora and DT seemed to have met up some trouble. He looked around the room and also took notice of one of her old guards was shot through the head.

Why did she come on this stupid chase? All she's gonna see is more bloodshed and it wasn't helping her resolve. Catra held her head into her knees and tried to block it out for a moment, clear her head from the screams. Her body shuddered with the cold ground, all the warmth disappearing from the room. She swallowed thickly and held her breath.

She needed to move. She needed to find Adora and Moonshine and get the fuck out of this Hellhole.

The magicat crawled across the floor towards a bloody footprint. Two pairs leading down the left corridor, rather dark but her night vision would help. She stood once more, holding herself up against the wall, giving a shaky breath before walking.

~~

Adora had a firm gaze, so much so that DT was nervous to speak. They swallowed and Adora clenched her fist. She was angry. She had to go through so much of this shit for her family. It shouldn't be so. The blonde gritted her teeth as they stepped into a dimly lit room.

It seemed innocent enough. Like a simple room with many rolls of cloth laid around. But to know where this 'cloth' came from, Adora was furious.

"We're almost there, it's on the other side of this room. The office. "

"*Office?* That's what she calls it? " Adora growled.

DT nodded but led the way. "It doesn't exactly looks like one but she calls it that. "

"Of course. " She scoffed.

As they passed the many arrays of fur. Adora felt tears prick at her eyes. There was so much. So much colors, so much patterns. It was cruel. Utterly cruel.

DT pushed the metal door open and it jammed. They looked to the blonde, "ready? " She nodded and walked past them into the other room.

More cages, more torture devices, more racks of fur. Yet less blood and remains. It's as though she wanted it to remain cleaner. There were still a few cauldrons though.

Who turns a factory into an office?! This witch!

Adora scanned the room only to find Shadow Weaver leaning against a particular cage quite some distance away.

"Hm, look who finally decided to show up? I was wondering if my cameras needed fixing. " The woman sipped some wine glancing to some monitors.

Being a high tech industry these guys had so many advantages against them. But like that was gonna stop them. Right?

"Adora! " Moonshine whimpered in the cage the witch leaned on. It made the blonde's blood boil.

"Look, Shadow Weaver, no one has to get hurt. Just hand her over. " DT came to a stand beside the ex Commander.

Shadow Weaver laughed heartily. "As if no one didn't get hurt already." She swirled her wine, "I suspect you've rescued your rat already." Shaking some keys and letting down her drink Shadow Weaver unlocked Moonshine' cage and grabbed her by her scruff before anyone could move, dangling the kitten over a pot of boiling water.

"Move and I drop her. "

Adora widened her eyes. Her breathing stopped.

She.... Didn't know what to do for once. They didn't have a plan for this outcome. She wouldn't be able to get to her in time. Much less reach for her gun before she drops her.

Shadow Weaver lifted her own gun and pointed it at the pair.

"Mom! " Moonshine cried out and whimpered looking down. She was begging under her voice but the rest of her body couldn't move

The gun went off and DT groaned holding their stomach against the floor. Adora's eyes widened. She couldn't have come this far to be put in a situation like this. Her stomach turned when she heard a familiar voice at the doorway.

"DT! No! " Catra whimpered and fumbled up to them. DT groaned.

"Adora why are you just standing there?" Catra tried seeing Adora's hands raised and away from her gun at her waist band.

"If I move, she drops her. " Adora's voice shook. "I can't... " She whimpered. Catra looked to the woman smirking under her veil, her daughter dangling over a steaming cauldron. Her ears flattened, they're cornered.

It all happened so fast. A net ensnared Shadow Weaver another one wrappitn around Moonshine and throwing her off to the side. Adora grabbed her gun and tried to shoot at the woman but she cut herself out of the net and shot back, Adora grabbed Catra and DT and hid behind a desk.

"What the fuck just happened? " Catra shrieked and Adora panted looking to the doorway.

Angella also hid behind a fallen desk with a few guards beside her. The blonde's eyes widened and she chuckled, "Took you guys long enough. " Angella chuckled a little too, looking back at the red laiden woman. "Sorry for the delay dear, finding this place has been a hassle. " She cocked a different gun and aimed.

"Get Moonshine, I'll cover you. "

"Damn, your mom is awesome. " Catra snickered but held DT close.

Adora gave a court nod and held her pistol, searching for the other two occupants. Shadow Weaver was about to pick up Moonshine's net when she got a shot extremely close to her hand. Angella shouted, "go! Go! " Adora got up and ran, A few clones filtered in and Angella's guards tried their best to fend them off. Shadow Weaver reached for a metal rod and attempted to hook the net again, Moonshine squirming in her binds.

"Stop squirming you little--" Adora punched the woman across the face.

"Get away from her!" Shadow Weaver made a large thud against the floor with a groan.

A few clones grabbed the blonde and she fought against their grip.

Angella fired shots at the clones, their grips ceasing as they fell away.

Catra's ears flattened as she tried to block it all out. She felt helpless, useless. She couldn't do anything.

Shadow Weaver grimaces at the woman behind the desk shooting at her henchmen. She raised her own gun and aimed at her.

Adora's eyes widened seeing this and she tugged at their grips harder. "***Angella***!! "

Bang!!

Catra's ears rang as she felt the room pause. Looking across from her she saw Angella on the floor, her eyes dilated to pinpricks at the sight. "No... "

Adora had the same halt in time, tears brimmed her eyes and she yelled in grief. She shook the clones off and fought them off, hitting them hard and kicking them into the boiling cauldron, their screams filling the noisy room. More of them came at her and she shouted, gripping her hands into their uniforms and throwing them into the metal cages with loud clangs.

Moonshine hid her face and pinned her ears back, her body shaking in fear.

As the guards fended off the other clones, filtering how many came at Adora. (Which seemed to be a lot) The blonde kicked the gun out of Shadow Weaver's petty grip and grapped her by her clothing lifting her.

She walked over to the cauldron, clones fighting to get out of the boiling water as their flesh melted off.

"No please! no! " Shadow Weaver gripped at Adora's forearm looking down.

"Someone like you deservee far worse than boiling water. " Adora said through gritted teeth.

"Don't you think you have enough blood on your hands? " Shadow Weaver attempted an Innocent chuckled.

"Don't you? I've seen what you've done. The trophies you collect. You don't deserve to live. " The blonde's grip grew tighter but Shadow Weaver's eyes seemed to have grown wider behind her veil.

"No! No! Please, I'll do anything! "

Adora let go. A splash and the witch's screams erupting from below. Clones pushing her down in their own attempt to flee. Adora took a few steps back, her breathing shaky as she rushed over to Moonshine, grabbed her in her net and headed for Catra. "We need to move, Now!" Catra nodded and Adora helped her up, the guards staying at her back.

DT strained as they limped over to a control panel and typed. The monitors turning red and beeping.

"Mom... " Adora looked down at Angella's still body and whimpered.

"Adora we have to go, this place is about to blow. " DT attempted to push her but faultered. Catra scraped her and got her attention. The blonde nodding and leading the way, covering Moonshine's ears as they escaped.

As they exited into a snow covered world. Glimmer's head popped up from the Jeep. They all scrambled to enter the vehicles, Adora being forced to drive with the shape shifter's injury.

"Where's mom?!" Glimmer took notice as they sped away. Adora sobbed, her eyes blurry as she tried to see her way. Catra cut her daughter out of the net and Moon hugged her tightly, Catra's eyes widened before she hugged her daughter back just as tightly sobbing and shaking.

"She's gone Glimmer... " Adora sniffles and Glimmer's eyes searched the blonde for a lie. She buried her face in Bow's chest,

the boy also breaking down in sobs with her.

There was a loud explosion far behind them as they all flinched and looked to one another. Their eyes filled with sorrow and exhaustion.

Chapter 29

Chapter Summary

Finally it's over....

Chapter Notes

Not the story though lol
Also panic attack warning. I tired for that part ngl, even googled it, I'm usually left alone with my anxiety attacks so idk how it usually goes.

Finally, it's over.

Catra curled into Adora's nape, her kitten tucked into her arms. Adora smiled sadly down at them. They were all walking towards the nearest village. The guards leading the way and tracking. Bow and Glimmer not far behind with DT limping with them.

Adora sighed as she felt the cold air against her skin and shivered. She hoped they weren't far.

About 15 minutes later they entered a clearing, it took a moment for Adora to recognize the area. It was the magicat village. A smile curled at her lips, and she turned back to her friends. Smoke billowing in the air behind them, making her heart calm down. They destroyed it, and hopefully there was nothing left, there didn't seem to be anyone else to rescue. The place was flooded with clones but no one else. Adora's fellow cadets crossed her mind and she hoped they got away safely.

But right now, she didn't want to think about the past few weeks.

A magicat came through the snow to them, stopping as he saw the group. The guards went up to him and they spoke. Adora's

legs shook, she looked to the felines in her arms and knelt with them. Catra's eyes opening slowly.

"Adora." The blonde's hold shook, she was exhausted. Glimmer and Bow came up to the woman and carefully extracted her loved ones from her grasp. "Adora? " Catra's voice cracked as she strained to reach her lover. Adora's body shook and she looked to the sky finally letting herself sob. Catra crawling up to her and hugging her as villagers started coming out of their huts to help.

They were all given huts to stay in whilst they recovered. Food and water provided to them if ever they should need it.

Adora stayed in Catra's hut and the others got a spare one. The pair in question, laid in the feline's bed, sleeping, Moonshine between them and curled into a tight ball. A day later Adora woke, the morning sunlight filtering onto her face and warming her cold body. Catra laid across her chest and Moon wasn't there. It took the blonde a moment to remember that they were in the magicat village and safe, her adrenaline spiking in worry only to calm down as she heard a soft purr coming from the feline laying on her.

The woman pressed a kiss to the feline's ear. They needed a loong shower. Maybe she should wake her? One long cuddle won't hurt right? Adora flipped them on to her side, holding the feline close, earning a tired noise as she squeezed. "Mmfora." Adora let up on her grip a little and Catra yawned. "Good morning you idiot. " Catra stretched, having been woken up from the tight hug she flopped back down and curled on her other side.

"Good morning, kitten. " Adora kissed her shoulder and held her once more. "I missed you. " She buried her nose into the feline's short mane.

"Adoraaaa. Stahhhp. " Catra felt hands trailing up her shirt. "Why? "

"I'm still dirty... " Catra trailed off, her ears pinning slightly. She couldn't believe it was over. She expected to wake up and the rescue would've been a dream. She's home.

She turned around to face the blonde and looked into her eyes. "I'm home? "

"You're home. " Adora pulled her close and gave a brief squeeze. Catra's eyes teared up as she hugged her back. "I'm home. " she sniffled. Adora let her have a minute to process before she spoke up. "Hey--"

"Where's Moon? " Catra interrupted her. "She wasn't here when I woke up. " Catra bolted up right immediately.

"Why didn't you wake me? "

"I assumed she was safe, since we're in the village-"

"Still." Catra got out of bed and exited the bedroom. Adora groaning as she dragged herself out of bed as well. The blonde ran her hand through her untied hair an followed the brunette.

"I'm sure she's fine, Catra. "

"Moon! " The feline mildly panicking as she searched the rooms. Adora went over to a covered window and lifted the cloth, "Catra." She called but the feline ransacked the house. "Catra! " The feline snapped, "what? "

"She's right there. " Adora pointed with her chin, Catra coming over to see her daughter playing with her grandfather. Catra let out a sigh of relief but her ears flattened in embarrassment. "Sorry, for yelling. " Adora chuckled, "it's okay. Now come on, I think we should take a long deserved bath. " Catra sighed but led the way to her bathroom.

Her shower was rarely used but on extremely grimy days where she needed it, only then it would be used. As she was about to turn it on she remembered the weather and cursed.

"What's the matter? " Adora asked from her seat on the bed.

"It's winter, the river's frozen, we won't get water, if we do, it'd be ice cold. " Catra flattened her ears, but just as she walked out to the blonde a woman entered.

"Oh! You're awake! Hi, I'm Stella, the chief would be glad to hear you're awake. " Stella turned to leave again, but stopped. " is there anything you both need before I leave? "

Catra looked to Adora who shrugged, "we need to take baths if you can get the water to warm up that'd be neat. " Stella chuckled nervously at Catra's tone.

"Yeah, sure. On it. " She left the air turning less tense. Adora giggled, "did you have to be so rude about it? "

"It wasn't 'rude'. It's called sarcasm sweet heart. And I don't want to stay filthy nor turn a block of ice by trying. "

Catra went over to the window and saw the magicat conversing with her father. She narrowed her eyes before he turned to the hut and saw her, waving a little, Moonshine scampering off into another hut. Oak nodded before he sent Stella elsewhere.

Stella came back ten minutes later and Catra raised an eyebrow. "Okay, so water situation solved. Last week we found a hot spring, the chief said you guys can head down there, and has ordered everyone to not visit for as long as you may stay. " Catra's eyes widened.

"You guys found a hot spring? It's not frozen over? " Adora stood and stood beside Catra.

"No the water is completely melted even at this time of the year."

"Huh, how convenient. " Catra chuckled to herself and went into her bathroom. Stella chuckled.

"Thank you. Catra has been.... Snappy since everything. It's gonna take a while for her to let her guard down again. " Adora looked to the bathroom and back at the Raven woman before her. Her green eyes crinkled, "it's okay. I think we're all used to her snappy nature by now. Just haven't seen it in a while. "

Adora hummed and thanked her again. She looked at the woman's winter coat and remembered Catra's, pursing her lips, Catra's own didn't grow in properly for sure.

"I'd lead you guys to the spring and be on my way don't worry. " Adora smiled as she got taken out of her thoughts.

Catra exited the bathroom with two towels, "ready." Adora took hers and wrapped it around her shoulders and they were off.

The spring was beautiful. Steam rising from the water and warmth emitting from the area.

"Thanks again, Stella. "

"No worries, have fun! " The magicat left and Adora turned back to the spring to see Catra already bare and descending into the warm water, her tail spiking as she hissed. Adora's face warmed and she put her towel down next to Catra's and started stripping.

"Someone's excited~ " Catra purred glancing back at the blonde fumbling with her clothing.

"You started without me! " Adora huffed and finally got her shirt off.

Catra chuckled as she waded into the warm water, purring as she melted into it. It was nice, bearable. Adora finally got herself together and descended into the spring with a satisfied groan. "Damn, I haven't seen a face like that in ages. " Catra teased and Adora blushed wildly. "Oh shut up. " The blonde leaned against the bank and Catra took a dip, coming back to the surface and wiping her face.

She took a minute to wash herself before she took in the silence the woman across from her emitted. "Adora, what's the problem? " Adora ripped her eyes away from her lover. "I uh... It's been a while. That's all. "

"oh so that's it? You're nervous because you haven't seen me naked in a long time? " Catra smirked and Adora sputtered. She looked away embarrassed. Catra swam over and pressed her body against Adora's. She gasped and looked at the lidded eyes piercing into hers.

"Kiss me. "

"What? "

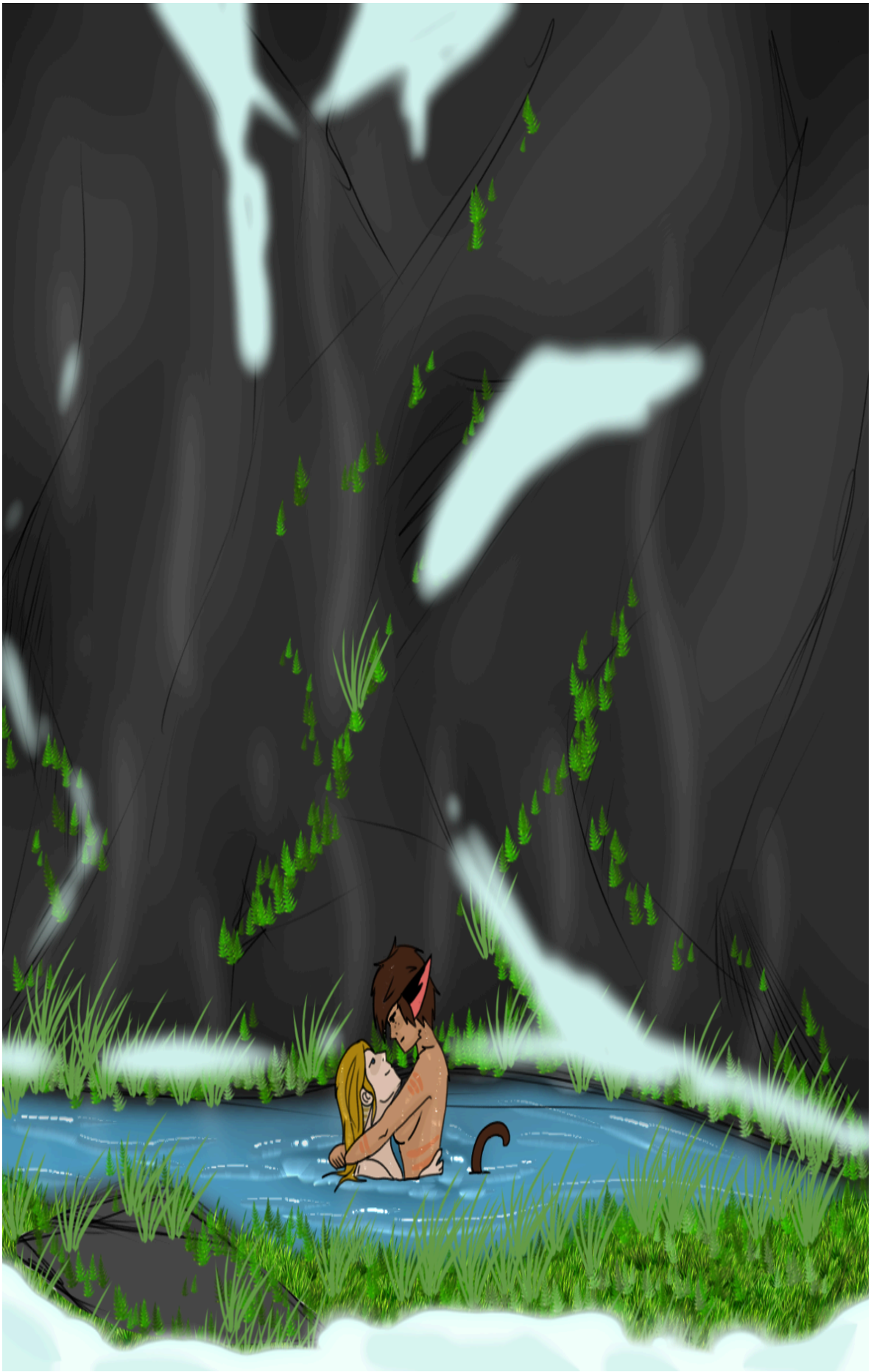
"You know you want to. " Adora swallowed and held the magicat, joining their lips in a long overdo kiss. They melted into each other. Catra sighed and held onto the bank behind her lover, keeping her as close as possible. But Adora had other plans and she forgot they were in a spring, pushing the feline backwards and into the center. "Adora.. " She didn't let her speak, hooking her arms around her body and cupping her face bringing her closer.

Catra trailed her tail against Adora's thigh and got the blonde to yelp separating the kiss in an attempt to hide her crimson face.

Catra laughed and the blonde grumbled into her palms, splashing the feline as revenge. Catra hissed as the water hit her, some going into her mouth, she spat. " You jerk! " She grinned and tousled the woman. Fighting in the water around them. Their laughs loud and contagious as they played. Catra ducked under the water and grabbed Adora's hips pulling her down under with her. Bubbles erupted around them as Adora held her breath and gave a dirty glare to the woman.

Catra blew a few bubbles as she floated besides her, Adora about to swim back to the surface for air. The brunette getting an excuse to pull the taller woman towards her and join their lips

together, blowing some of her air into the blonde's mouth. Adora's eyes widened and she melted into it. Catra pulled back and swam back up, gasping for air as she broke the surface. Adora appeared between her arms, holding her and slightly lifting her as she gave a smug smirk.



"What? " Catra chuckled and wrapped her arms around her shoulders. "What was that? "

"What was what? "

"The kiss... Under water? "

"Uh... " Catra blushed. "I-It was nothing. Just a kiss. "

"Naw, it was magical. " Adora wiggled her eyebrows.

"Pfft, you're such an idiot. " Catra's tail splashed behind her as she snickered. Adora laid her head on the feline's breasts as the floated together. "I love you. " Catra nuzzled the mark on her shoulder.

"I love you too dummy. " Catra purred against her touch. "Huh... I wonder if my dad would like you, since we're here. "

"What?! "

"The chief is my dad, Adora. " Adora paused and pulled back from the magicat looking at her. "WHAT?! " her voice echoed. Catra laughed but then it died down as Adora's shocked expression turns into a smug one. "So when Tom called you 'princess he wasn't kidding HAHAHAHA! "

"Aaaand I'm ready to leave. " Catra pushed Adora's face away and the woman snorted and pouted, "noooooooooo."

"My princess is abandoning me in the treacherous sea. I am *drowning* oh dearest Princess, save your mate. " Adora cackled and splashed in the water as Catra climbed out.

"Nope, I'll leave you to die. Now just--" Catra's eyes shrunk to pinpricks and she got flashbacks to days prior.

"Catra? " Adora stopped seeing how Catra froze, her tail starting to spike. "Catra? You okay? " Adora swam closer, upon seeing her panicked gaze towards nothing in particular and panting, she

scrambled out of the water and stood in front of her, "hey, Cat. Hey, hey hey, it's okay. I'm okay. I'm here. " Adora carefully held her lover and rocked them as Catra shaking held her back. "I'm okay, I'm here. We're at the spring, we're home. We're okay. " Adora ran her hands through the feline's wet mane as her breathing refused to even out.

"Listen to my heart beat okay, slow deep breaths. " Catra's breath shuddered as she tired to mirror Adora's. "It's a panic attack, it'll go away. I promise. It'll stop. Just mirror what I'm doing, okay. " Catra held her tightly trying. Catra's hands shook and Adora decided to bring herself lower to the ground, sitting with the feline's ear to her chest. "Look around, look at where we are. Tell me what you see. Take your time. "

"... Snow... " her eyes flickered around and she held onto the woman, "grass.... Trees..... " Catra took a breath and nuzzled deeply into Adora's chest, her heart in her ears.

"What about smell, tell me. "

"I.... " she swallowed and closed her eyes, " Tom's cooking, "she smiled a little, and Adora did too, " that's it.. " Catra started calling down. "Hear, "

Catra listened, "your heart beat... " Adora hummed. "Moonshine playing. Glimmer laughing. "

"Can you move your tail for me? " Catra' tail twitched then curled closer to them.

"Good, that's it. We're all okay now. We got away, we're safe. " Catra nodded and her breathing calmed down, her grip releasing as she held her lover. "T-thank you. "

"Anytime, Cat. Anytime. " Adora released her. She looked her over and kissed her ear.

"We should get back now, it's been long enough. " She gave a small smile and got the feline's clothes for her. Catra nodded and

stayed sitting while Adora helped her patiently.

Chapter 30

Chapter Notes

> Ngl, this story has been going on a very long time, i'm trying so hard to figure out how to end it.
> Short last chapter then.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

~Some years later~

"Come on Kyle! Move it!" A familiar feline shouted, her hair up in a medium length ponytail. She huffed and looked through her checklist, a ring shimmering on her finger. Her stripes and fur healthy and shining in the sun. An armless uniform designed by her lover she wore with matching black and red leggings and an assortment of belts and pockets.

Adora was out with Moonshine, the two taking some time from Catra as she packed. Adora had recently decided that she would rather be a stay at home mother, to keep the family safe from the inside and because she loved being able to let her guard down. Catra felt little hands on her leg and chuckled looking down. Someone seemed to have run off again.
"Yes Finn I know. Uncle Kyle's being a pain in the butt," she tucked the checklist onto her belt clip and reached down for her 1 year old kitten. He sucked on his pacifier and smiled reaching to her face. Catra smiled and kissed his head. Her mismatched eyes softened at his little coos, "don't worry, mama's gonna be here soon. Considering you made it to me safely. I'll try not to kill her when i see her."

As if right on cue, Adora came running in a highly panicked state, Moonshine not far behind. "Catra, I lost--" She panted as she kicked up some dust. The brunette raised a brow and turned around the kitten already in hand and a disappointed glare on her

face. It's not the first time. Adora stood tall and rubbed behind her neck.
"Sorry, he's slippery. How does he keep finding you? Jeez."
"I'm his mother, you are too and you're supposed to keep an eye on him at all times, he's still a curious little kit. He could wander into the forest following a butterfly." Catra scoffed and looked around at her village. At least there were enough people around who would've seen a little kitten wandering around.

"You're lucky we're visiting Brightmoon, Glimmer and Bow will occupy him till he drops. He won't be in the way of the new machinery. Have you spoken with Entrapta?"

"uh yes, I have. It took some convincing but she baby proofed everything." Catra's ear flicked.
"And she's not going to experiment on him." The feline smiled and handed Moonshine her baby brother. Finn grabbed and tried to climb her head, his little tufts of blonde hair blowing in the wind. Little blue eyes looked up at his feline mother.

Kyle came over and cleared his throat, "Everything's packed guys." Rogelio came over holding a toddler of their own and Catra gave the little guy a fist bump. "Nice getting papa to do his job, Squirt." The little boy smiled and his reptilian eyes sparkled. Rogelio chuckled and Kyle sank into himself as Catra walked past to inspect the job.

It truly took some years for everyone to heal from the events they've been through. If anything they were still healing inside. Adora sat to rest her legs and sighed, she was tired. Going home would be so relaxing. She looked over to Catra fixing some stuff on a small vehicle Entrapta helped organise. The locals weren't happy with the technology but they welcomed a little bit of helpful resources, like plumbing treatment, and some medicine. The change in technology was....weird but Adora was a fast learner as long as Entrapta hung around long enough to demonstrate effectively. The blonde looked over to Moonshine and opened her arms for a hug. They were finally a family and safe, and it felt that

way as soon as they held each other close. Angella would've loved to meet Finn.

Finn squeaked and Adora let her grip loosen with a chuckle, "sorry. I'm just so happy."

Catra's father came by to wish them well, and she almost teared up. "We'll be back dad, don't worry. Everything is planned out just fine."
"And i thought i was the order freak." Adora smirked on the soft grass, chin in hand.
"shut up idiot, you've rubbed off on me in more ways than one."
"Same here kitten." Catra rolled her eyes and went over to them.
"Okay, how about one more run before we go, hm?"
"Yes yes yes yes pleaseeeeeee." Moon begged and the feline took Finn and gave him to his grandfather.
"aw," Adora pouted.
"You too, blondie. i didn't teach you this for nothing." Adora perked up and rushed over to a bag to grab her gloves.

Catra smiled and ruffled Moon's hair, "mom's coming with us?"
"Yeah, she deserves it. Besides it might be a bit funny, just watch."

"You remember what to do?" Adora came back, fastening her custom gloves.
"quadrobics isn't that hard."

Catra smirk, "Let's see you do it then~" Running off on all fours, Moonshine followed laughing. Adora ran after them normally at first to catch up, but eventually she tried it, trying to remember what her wife taught her.

Catra laughed as she watched back, Adora was definitely slower but it was nice that she wanted to learn and try. If anything she felt part of the family that way. Catra pounced into a tree and waited. Adora was athletic sure but she needed time to master

running on all fours like this. it was strange seeing her do it. Catra chuckled and jumped onto her.
"You look so stupid running like that,"
"Shhhhhh, i just need time."
"You don't have time you oldy."
"Shhhhhhhhhhh i can't hear youuuu." Adora covered her ears and Catra laughed, kissing the love of her life. Moonshine tackles them from a berry bush.

Old things, new things, many new things, but it didn't matter, they were as safe as they could be as long as they had each other. It's all that mattered to them. In the end, they were meant to meet and have a beautiful family like they do now. Catra was thankful for opening her heart again like Silver told her. If she didn't she wouldn't have been this happy. And her kits could finally have a better life.
Who knows, all their fallen friends and family have probably already met the kids, and are up there guiding them forward. Their sacrifices were never in vain and in the end, their experiences made them stronger.

Chapter End Notes

Finn was just a baby so pronouns haven't mattered to them yet.

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